[MDT] MicroDexed-touch

microDexed

Build Guide & User Manual

Version 0.20 - September 2024

https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch

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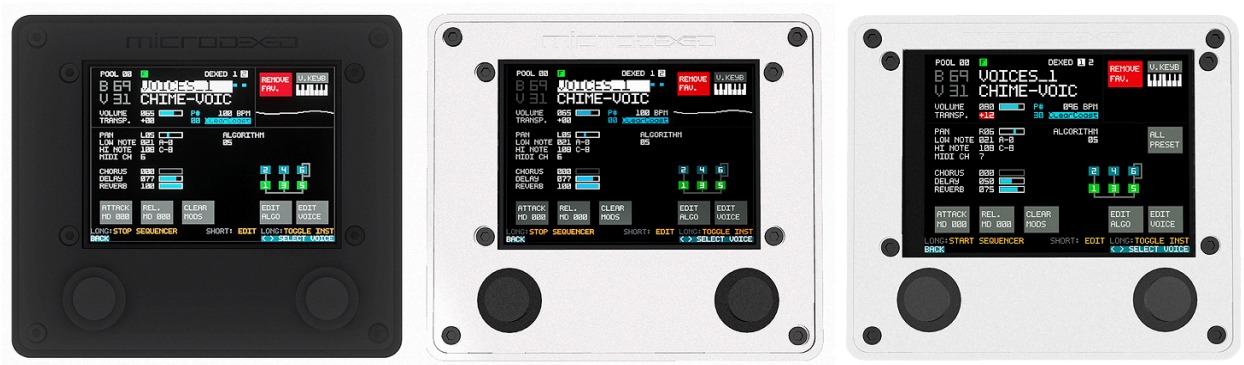
NOTE: Microdexed-touch is capable of generating audio with a large dynamic range, the extremes of which can cause damage to loudspeakers or other components, and also to your hearing. Please be especially careful when activating the MultiBand Compressor. Depending on its settings, this easily can increase the perceived output loudness by 10x or even more.

Overview

What is MDT ?



(SLA PRINTED ENCLOSURE, DISPLAY SIZE LEFT: 2.8", MIDDLE: 2,8" and RIGHT: 3.2")

(PCB BASED FRONT/BACK PANEL, DISPLAY SIZE LEFT 2.8" and RIGHT 3.2")

METAL (ALUMINIUM), 3.2” DISPLAY only

MDT is a multitimbral MIDI expander / Synthesizer with 6 Operator FM-Synthesis, "Virtual Analog" or "Chip Tune" Synthesis, Chromatic Sample and Drum Sample Playback, a version of MDA ePiano, a polyphonic synth, based on Mutable Instruments Braids Oscillator, with 8 instances and filters, a LSDJ style Sequencer with Patterns, Chains and Song mode, an Arpeggiator with common, simple and Euclidean style Patterns and much more.

In addition there is a second sequencer - called LIVESEQUENCER with a more musician style of approach - behaving similar to a multitrack tape machine with mute-automation. It brings its own arsenal of features, quantisation, arpeggios, shuffle/swing and much more. Both sequencers can be used at the same time and can address internal as well as external (MIDI) devices.

MDT can be remote controlled by your PC/MAC via several USB Protocols like USB AUDIO, USB MIDI and MIDI SERIAL.
Stable File Transfer between PC and MDT (for Samples and other data) is work in progress. It currently is best working on a Windows PC.

Open your browser and go to the webpage: https://positionhigh.codeberg.page/

and connect your MDT via the USB MICRO port on the Teensy to a USB Port of your PC. The most suggested browser is Google Chrome, Firefox currently works partially.

Usage Scenarios

- MDT can be used as a live instrument, played by a MIDI or USB MIDI device.
- MDT can be used as a multitimbral MIDI expander, from any other MIDI Device or your DAW.
- MDT can be used as an all-in-one Groovebox with multiple instruments and samples on 8 tracks.
- A mixture of the above - It is really up to you what parts you like to use stand-alone or together with other equipment.

Since Summer 2024, it is possible to use your own custom samples and even replace the stock samples easily by using one or two PSRAM chips on the Teensy. One chip has a capacity of 8MB and 2 chips can be soldered to the Teensy for a total of 16MB.

It is possible to acquire a Teensy with pre soldered PSRAM from protosupplies.com

The previously used chip for using custom samples was the external SPI Flash chip, which was very easy to add since pre-build modules were and are available at a very low cost. That is the main reason why that was the supposed solution for sample playback with MDT for some time.

However, even after putting a lot of effort into this approach, this unfortunately never turned out to be fully stable.

So the SPI Flash chip is now considered to be depreciated and replaced by the PSRAM chip(s).

The slot on the MDT PCB for SPI Flash will stay on the PCB design for now. It is possible the now fully optional Flash chip will find a new or other purpose to fulfill.

Features and MDT History

This is MicroDexed with TFT Touch Display, graphic UI and sequencer

This build requires a Teensy 4.1, PCM5102 Audio Board, 320x240 ILI9341 SPI Display with Capacitive Touchscreen, a serial Flash Chip (and a PSRAM Chip for custom samples).

MicroDexed started as a Teensy based, 6-operator-FM-synthesizer. The first generation is still maintained at: https://codeberg.org/dcoredump/MicroDexed

Compared to the first generation, MicroDexed-touch offers a lot of new features/improvements:

- The Flash Chip is pre soldered on a small PCB attachment for <2$.
- "Large" Graphical Interface, view and edit multiple Parameters in one Screen
- Use external MIDI gear over USB or Mini TRS Jacks (DIN MIDI with adaptor) from 2 x 16 MIDI Channels in the Sequencer
- Map MIDI CC to external MIDI Devices to control Input/Parameters
- Global plate reverb, 2 global delay effects (500ms, with added PSRAM chip 60 seconds or even more)
- Loading, playing and editing multi-sampled instruments or layered instruments in a "live" mode or played by the sequencer. Auto detection sample zones but also can be edited manually. This is early work in progress and currently not stable when using pitch shifting and polyphony
- 2 instances of "Virtual Analog" Monosynths with one OSC, PWM, Multimode Filter and Noise. A lot of useful new sound possibilities.
- 8 voice polyphonic Oscillator, based on the code of Mutable Instruments - Braids. No wavetables but added individual envelopes and multimode filters for all voices
- Much improved Sequencer with 8 Tracks, 16 Step Patterns, 16 Step Pattern Chains, up to 16384 Song Steps, Arpeggiator with 1/8 - 1/64 Steps, Arp Patterns including Euclidean settings, Pitched Drum- and Instrument Sample playback
- The sequencer can also play chords of various types, stacked up to 7 notes, using only a single sequencer track
- Global Mixer View with all Channels
- Multiband Master Compressor with 4 bands
- Sample Management from SD-CARD and SPI FLASH/PSRAM, samples can be loaded from SD-CARD to PSRAM during runtime.
- Touch Mute Matrix for live / real time performance
- Tracker View (Editor) - work in progress
- Track Print/Recording - work in progress
- Remote control in web-based 1:1 UI with added features (file manager,file transfer, screenshots etc.) Work in progress - connected to PC via Teensy MicroUSB Connector

Contributing

This project lives from the contributions of C++ developers, testers, reviewers. Please check https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/issues to help in open topics or add your own Issue or Feature Request.

Buttons / Encoders

A quick guide how the push Encoders are working:

Encoder left will be referred to as **ENC_L** and encoder right will be referred to as **ENC_R**.

[SHORT PUSH] means a simple, momentary push on the encoder.

[LONG PUSH] means a push and hold down of the encoder for about 2 seconds.

Usually [SHORT PUSH] **ENC_L** brings you back to the main menu or closer to the main menu one step.

Usually [SHORT PUSH] **ENC_R** selects or confirms an input/menu item/goes deeper into this item.

In the microsynth page and in the dexed voice page, [LONG PUSH] **ENC_R**, switches between their 2 Instances.

In Menus that need 2 Encoders for navigation, **ENC_R** controls Y movement and **ENC_L** controls X movement (for example in Song mode)

[LONG PUSH] **ENC_L** starts and stops the sequencer in most pages.

ENC_L in Main menu and most pages:

Turn left/right: Change the volume. The volume change screen appears when turning the knob and disappears after a short time and you return where you left off.

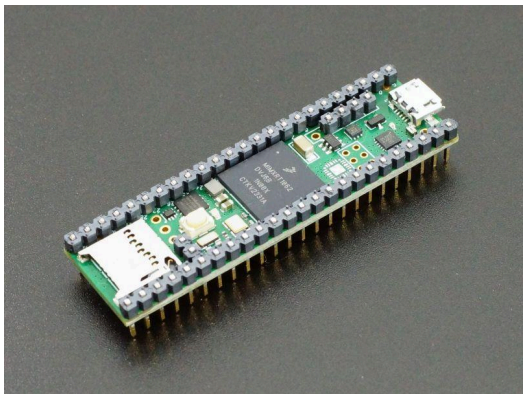
BOM

This BOM is currently changing a lot while being in development. However, using the components listed here at any time should lead to more or less the same functionality, but the "look" might change here and there.

Quantity	Item	Weblink	Comments
1	Teensy 4.1 Microcontroller	web link pjrc store web link protosupplies (with 8 or 16MB PSRAM)	You do not need to buy it directly from PJRC but it is a good choice. If you do not want to solder the Teensy pins by yourself, or the (optional) PSRAM chip, you now can order it from https://protosupplies.com/product/teensy-41-microdexed/ fully soldered and tested, specially for MDT. It is offered in two configurations with either 8 or 16 MB of PSRAM. MDT Development is focused/using only the 1 chip version with 8MB. However if you want to use longer custom audio samples than we do, it is probably a good idea to get the 16MB version. It is only a 3$ price difference.
1	PCM5102 Module	web link aliexpress	Other I2S DACs could also work but the PCB and Case are designed for this type.
1	2,8" OR 3.2" ILI9341 TFT with capacitive touch	ILI9341 TFT with capacitive touch web link or web link or web link ebay Make sure you pick the version with touchscreen, the default option is the screen without touch! Some vendors on AliExpress make the version selection for touch or touchless by selecting a specific "color".	MDT original screen size was 2.8" Since Summer 2024 front-panel/lids for the 3.2" display are available as SLA print and also an optional, pcb-based front panel. So now both screen sizes, 2.8" and 3.2" are ready to be used for MDT. The newer **3.2"** display is the **new default**. Both case/enclosure types are not interchangeable. You can either go with the front/back part for 3D printed SLA or both pcb-based. Double check the front part is matching your display size and type. The **3.5" Display** that often is listed on the same vendor page, will **NOT work** at all since it is using a **different resolution AND different chipset.**
1	PSRAM Chip	web link pjrc weblink www.berrybase.de weblink nettigo.pl	PS RAM Chip for Custom Samples and better audio effect times You will get much higher audio delay effect times when having this chip. Further, since 8/2024 it allows for loading custom samples in performances, even during runtime in a stable manner. This is the replacement for the previously used serial flash chip. The serial flash now is considered optional but it might become useful in the future again for different purposes.
3	Mini Audio Jack 3,5mm	https://www.reichelt.de/klinkeneinbaubuchse-3-5-mm-stereo-ebs-35-p7301.html?&nbc=1 Alternate (unverified sources): https://www.amazon.com/dp/B077D1NY4T/ref=redir_mobile_desktop/142-8043513-8620365?_encoding=UTF8&psc=1&ref=ppx_pop_mob_b_asin_title https://www.aliexpress.com/item/33004214640.html	for audio line out and midi in/out
2	generic rotary encoder with push function and threaded screw connection/ nut	https://www.ebay.de/itm/353276506071?hash=item5240ebafd7:g:YIAAAOSw-EJZ3z6h or https://www.tinytronics.nl/shop/en/switches/manual-switches/rotary-encoders/rotary-encoder-module or https://www.mouser.de/ProductDetail/858-EN11-HSM1BF20	The first example sells 3 pieces at once, you only need 2 encoders. The second link includes plastic knobs. Any generic rotary encoder from any brand should work, but make sure that they have a push button function. Also verify that the encoders have a threaded screw connection that can be fastened with a nut from the opposite enclosure side. If the encoders have pull-up resistors added, it needs to be tested but in general it is suggested to remove them when used in MDT
2	24 pin header	https://www.reichelt.de/stiftleisten-2-54-mm-1x24-gerade-mpe-087-1-024-p119889.html?&nbc=1	for Teensy to connect to pin socket - turn the long pin side down (to socket on main PCB), the short side will be snipped off. Please order

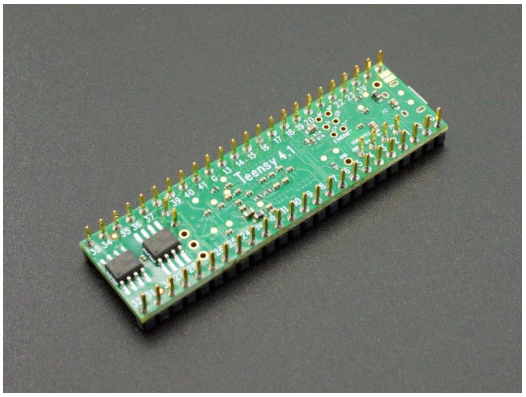
			1-2 extra pieces so you have some parts ready for other jumper pins or when something goes wrong with the pin cutting.
2	14 pin header	https://www.reichelt.de/us/en/pin-header-2-54mm-1x14-h-10-8-straight-bkl-10120912-p262776.html	for Audio to connect to pin socket - turn the long pin side down (to socket on main PCB), the short side will be snipped off
2	4 pin header, 90 degree	https://www.reichelt.de/fr/de/stiftleiste-rm-2-54mm-gewinkelt-1-reihig-4-polig-w-p-946-144-p330984.html	Encoder Header
1	low height 5 pin socket	https://www.reichelt.de/buchsenleiste-2-54mm-1x5-gerade-bkl-10120967-p266692.html?&nbc=1	USB HOST socket - The black plastic part is 3,9mm, the total height incl. pins is 7,5mm
2	low height 24 pin socket	https://www.reichelt.de/buchsenleiste-2-54mm-1x32-gerade-bkl-10120976-p266700.html?&nbc=1	for Teensy - you need only 24 pins not 32 - however since the availability seems poor, it is no problem to cut it to any shorter length - The black plastic part is 3,9mm, the total height incl. pins is 7,5mm
2	low height 14 pin socket	https://www.reichelt.de/buchsenleiste-2-54mm-1x14-gerade-bkl-10120972-p266697.html?&nbc=1	Socket for Audio - The black plastic part is 3,9mm, the total height incl. pins is 7,5mm
1	low height 6 pin socket	https://www.reichelt.de/fr/de/buchsenleiste-2-54mm-1x6-gerade-bkl-10120968-p266693.html?&nbc=1	Socket for SPI Chip Module - The black plastic part is 3,9mm, the total height incl. pins is 7,5mm
1	IC Socket	https://www.reichelt.de/praezisionsfassung-8-polig-rm-2-54-mpe-001-1-008-3-p213777.html?&nbc=1 or https://www.reichelt.de/fr/en/ic-socket-8-pin-double-spring-contact-gs-8-p8230.html	for 6N138 - you can go with the socket type above, use a socket with round (precision pins) or a spring contact socket for this IC.If you ordered the IC and don't know what contacts it has, it is probably safer to use the spring contact socket.
1	USB HOST Connector	https://www.reichelt.de/usb-einbaubuchse-serie-a-gew-print montage-usb-aw-p22184.html?&nbc=1	USB HOST Connector
2	Audio and USB HOST Connector	https://www.reichelt.de/buchsenleiste-2-54mm-1x4-gerade-bkl-10120966-p266691.html?&nbc=1	
1	6N138	https://www.reichelt.de/optokoppler-6n-138-p2859.html?&nbc=1	for midi in/out
1	resistor 470ohm	https://www.reichelt.de/widerstand-metallschicht-470-ohm-0207-0-6-w-1--metall-470-p11826.html?&nbc=1	for midi in/out
2	resistor 47ohm	https://www.reichelt.de/widerstand-metalloxyd-47-ohm-axial-250-mw-5--rnd-0w4j0470a50-p205030.html?&nbc=1	for midi in/out
1	resistor 220ohm	https://www.reichelt.de/widerstand-metallschicht-220-ohm-0207-0-6-0-1--mpr-220-p12875.html?&nbc=1	for midi in/out
2	resistor 27Kohm	https://www.reichelt.de/widerstand-kohleschicht-27-kohm-0207-250-mw-5--1-4w-27k-p1392.html	For headphone amplifiers. These values are currently approximated. Depending on your headphones, these should be better scaled higher or lower - will be discussed on discord chat
1	diode	https://www.reichelt.de/schalt-diode-100-v-150-ma-do-35-1n-4148-p1730.html?&nbc=1	for midi in/out
1	Connector from PCB to Display	web link reichelt.de	We do need only 14 of the 20 pins but I can't find the matching pin count. Double check that the height is 8.5 mm.
1	Encoder 4 pin cable + connector	https://www.reichelt.de/de/en/developer-boards-8211-cable-4-pin-dupon-20-cm-debo-dupon-4pin-p282689.html?&nbc=1	only 1 peace needed since you can cut it at half length and still have more than enough long cables
1	MDT PCB	weblink - pcbway.com weblink - elecrow.com	While it is possible to build most of Microdexed-touch without a PCB, it makes it much easier. PCBWAY is the first choice since working with them since the beginning of the project. Since 08/2024 ELECROW is added as a manufacturer for the MDT PCB.They produce the PCBs in advance so it is possible to buy a

			single PCB from them (compared to PCBWAY which always build to order - a minimum of 5 pieces, 1$ each)
1	DIY 3d printed Case	STL files are available in the build instructions: https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/wiki/Build-Instructions or order them from: https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/MicroDexed_Capacitive_Touch_64970fee.html The download/order links are at the bottom of the page.	Make sure you pick the correct size for your selected display. As an alternate solution there is also a PCB-based (non-printed) back and front plate available, see item below
1	pcb-based Case (optional)	Available from pcbway: Bottom part: https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/mdt_pcb_enclosure_bottom_plane_39654ff7.html Front part (2.8" Display): https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/W424985ASE20_pcb_enclosure_front_plane_c17b035e.html Front part (3.2" Display): https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/mdt_pcb_enclosure_front_3_2_DISPLAY_96ddfb78.html	This is a more cost effective solution to the self printed or SLA printed case above. It is just 2 (empty) pcbs that are connected by M3 screws/extensions and M3 nuts. The MDT PCB is attached with M2 screws and M2 nuts.
1	Headphone Amplifier	web link aliexpress or web link Amazon	Warning: The audio headphone amplifier is just thought for what the name implies, it is a louder/stronger output for headphones. The audio quality is not as clean as it is directly from the DAC - but it is louder. The direct output of the DAC is identical to the last version of MDT and is a good source for making audio recordings. The best possible output for recording you will get is with the digital S/PDIF output. (If you do have recording equipment that supports it.)
2	angled push button	web link aliexpress	optional buttons The linked item has options to select various push-lengths. It is suggested to use the shortest or one of the shorter ones since otherwise it can get more complicated to fit the pcb into the new default enclosure. If you can not find the linked item but others, from aliexpress or other sources, that are longer, it is not a big issue to shorten the length by snipping it off with a cutter tool. But you can avoid that by getting one of the shorter ones in the first place.
8	Jumper	web link reichelt.de	just in case you do not have any standard PC jumpers - used for MIDI Mode selection and other options on the PCB. One piece it at 0.02 €



If you do not want to solder the Teensy pins by yourself, or the (optional) PSRAM chip, you now can order it from:

https://protosupplies.com/product/teensy-41-microdexed/ fully soldered and tested, specially for MDT. (with 8 or 16 MB PSRAM)



Build Guide

If you have already build a MDT in the past:

- The first MDT Version(s) used a resistive touch screen. This is still (Summer 2024) supported and every firmware will include firmware for this configuration.
  However, it is strongly suggested to not build new units with this display type since the newer, capacitive touch screen is superior in every aspect.

- If you have previously built an MDT with a capacitive touch display, it is possible to modify the MDT PCB to adapt to the newer display.

  However this requires cutting 2 traces that are below the display connector of the MDT PCB. It is not suggested making this modification if you don't have at least medium skill and experience in desoldering and soldering components with multiple pins.

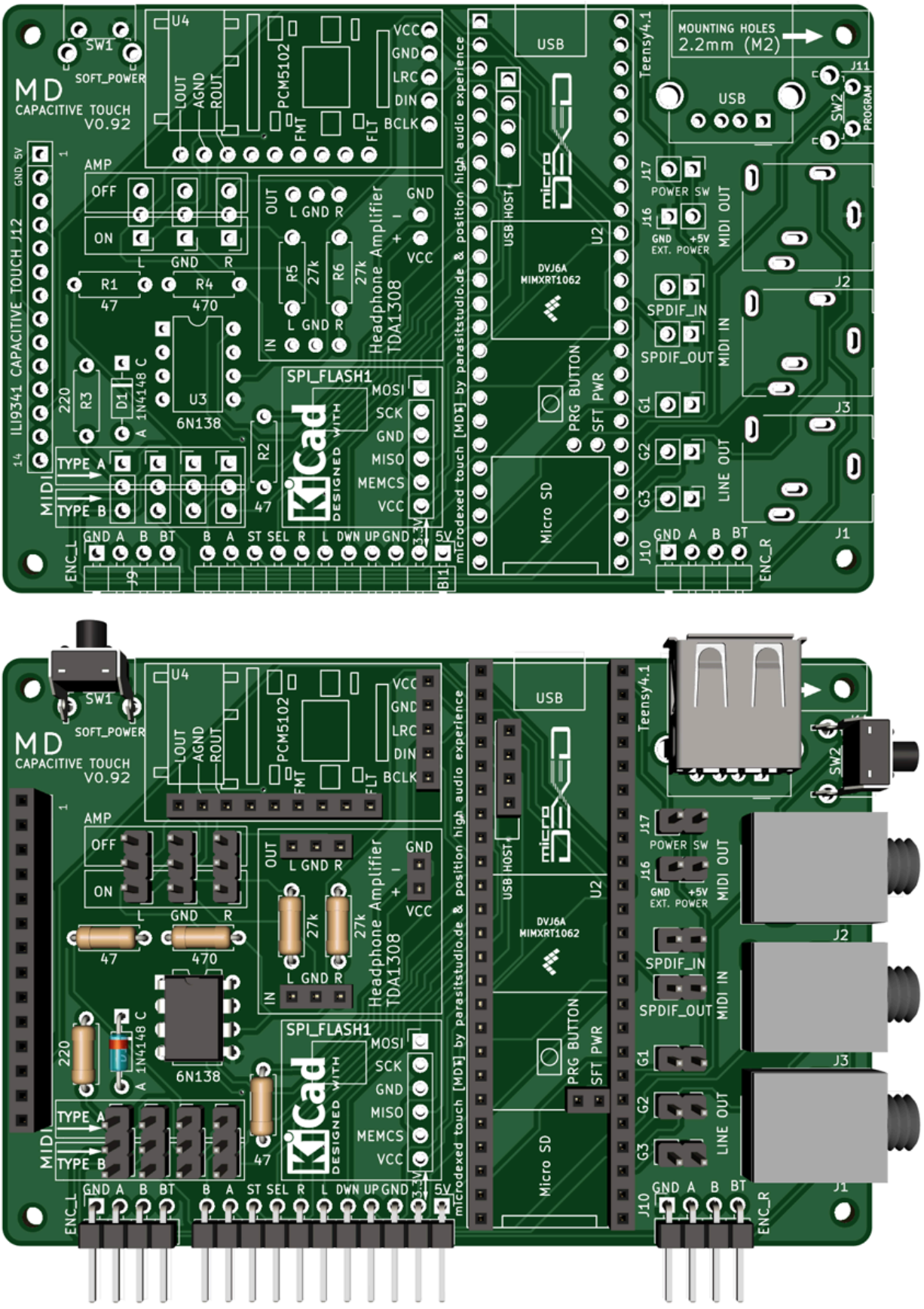
If you are new to MDT and want to build one:

- You can build MDT with a 2.8" or a 3.2" capacitive touch display. The Firmware for both is identical, the only difference is the physical size of the display (and the enclosure top, “Lid-Part”).

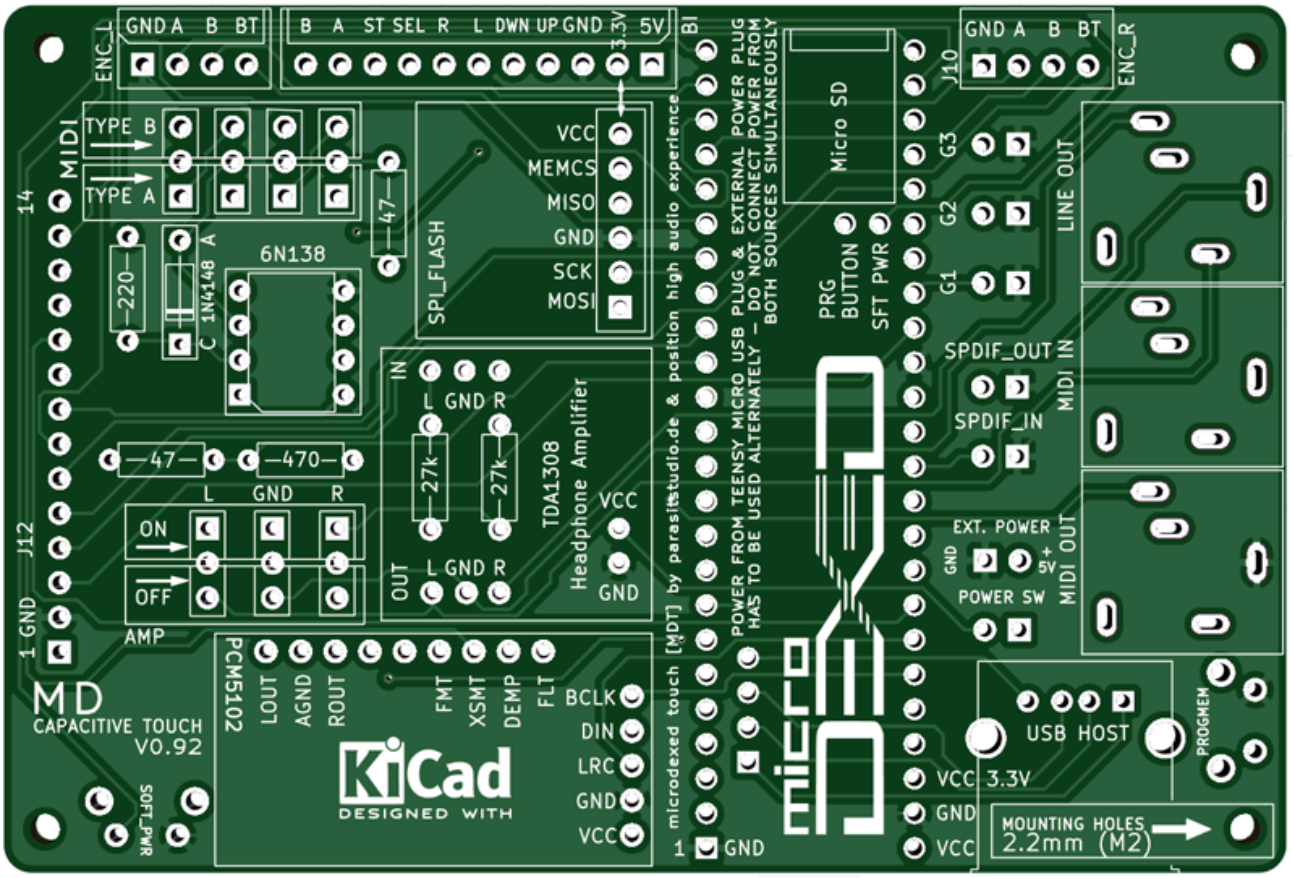
  Since Summer 2024, the suggested **default display size is 3.2”**.
  The contrast might be a bit weaker but it is overall a much better experience.

  It is no longer required or recommended to use the external SPI Flash. Instead, ideally go for 1 or 2 PSRAM chips that need to be soldered to the Teensy bottom side.

PCB Front/Back



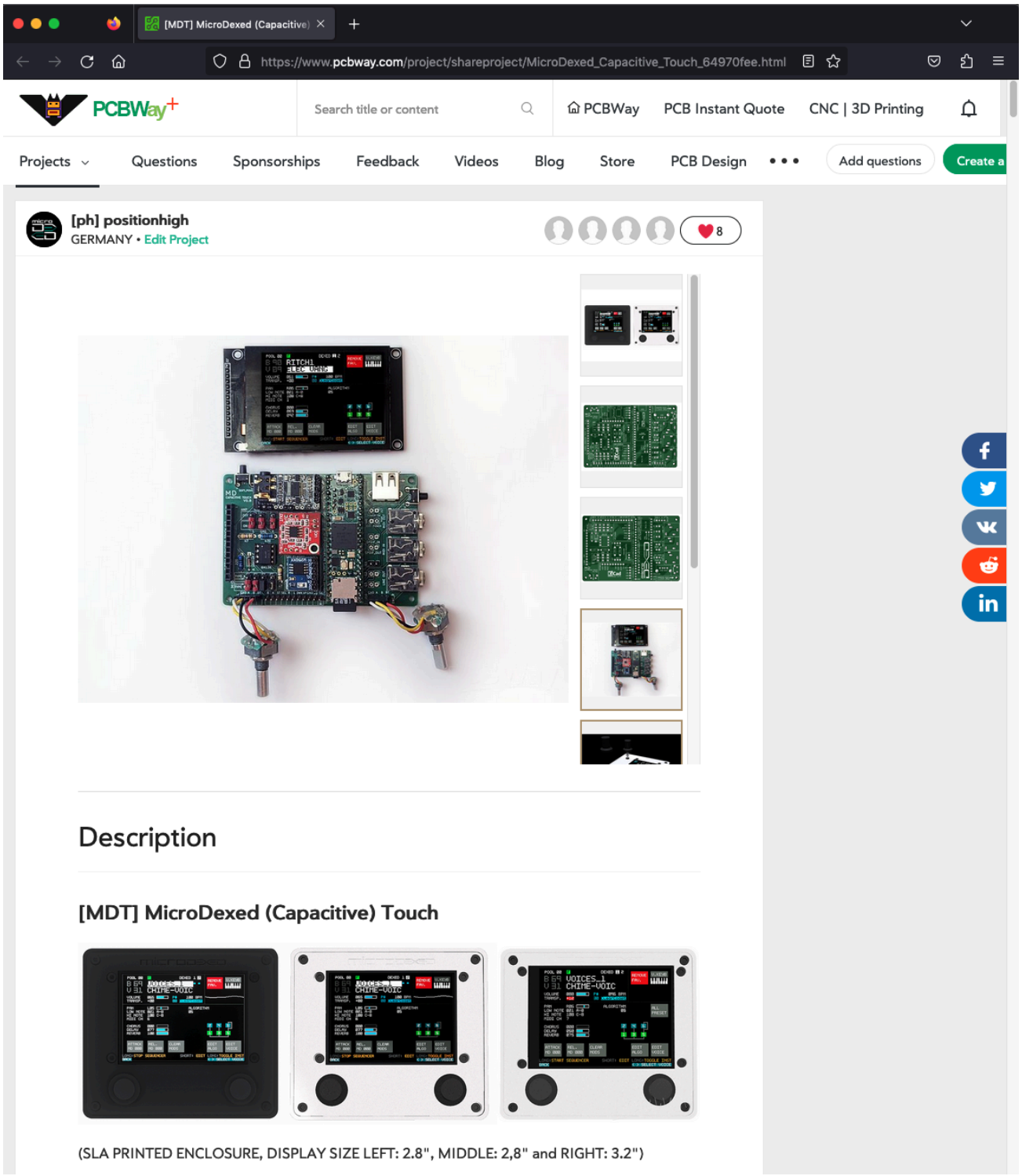
PCB Front plain and with components/sockets


ENC_L
GND A B BT
B A ST SEL R L DWN UP GND 3.3V 5V
ENC_R
GND A B BT
MIDI
TYPE B
TYPE A
14
1 GND
J12
220
1N4148
6N138
47
SPI_FLASH
VCC
MEMCS
MISO
GND
SCK
MOSI
Micro SD
J10
G3
G2
G1
LINE OUT
PRG BUTTON
SFT PWR
SPDIF_OUT
SPDIF_IN
MIDI IN
IN
L GND R
27k
27k
TDA1308
Headphone Amplifier
VCC
GND
OUT
L GND R
47
470
L GND R
ON
OFF
AMP
EXT. POWER
GND
+5V
POWER SW
MIDI OUT
POWER FROM TEENSY MICRO USB PLUG & EXTERNAL POWER PLUG
HAS TO BE USED ALTERNATELY — DO NOT CONNECT POWER FROM
BOTH SOURCES SIMULTANEOUSLY
microdexed touch [MDT] by parasitstudio.de & position high audio experience
MD
CAPACITIVE TOUCH
V0.92
SOFT_PWR
PCM5102
LOUT
AGND
ROUT
FMT
XSMT
DEMP
FLT
BCLK
DIN
LRC
GND
VCC
KiCad
DESIGNED WITH
USB HOST
PROGMEM
VCC 3.3V
GND
VCC
1 GND
MOUNTING HOLES
2.2mm (M2)

PCB Back

Buying the MDT PCB

The MDT PCB is currently available from PCBWAY and ELECROW.

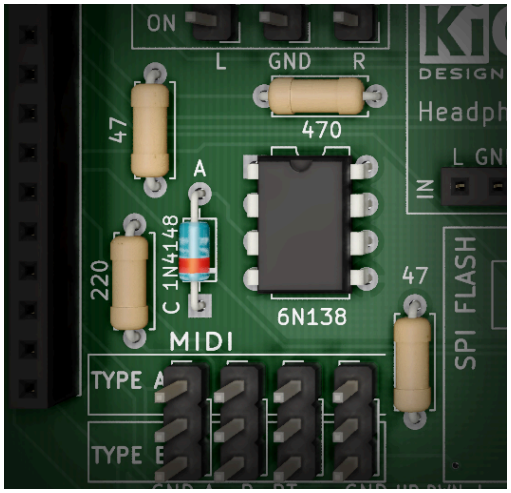


If you register and pay as a new user at PCBWAY with this Invite link, you should get a $5 "New User Free Credit" - so you can order 5 PCB pieces for "free", except shipping and customs cost etc.

https://www.pcbway.com/setinvite.aspx?inviteid=565384

Resistors and Diode

Let's begin with the resistors. You need 4 resistors, the values are printed on the board and are also listed in the BOM. 2x 47 Ohm, 1x 220 Ohm, 1x470 Ohm. For resistors, it does not matter which direction you put them in. Then put in the 1N4148 diode. Make sure the **cathode** is pointing to the "**C**" side label on the MDT MCB.



This chip in the center of the left picture is the 6n138 Optocoupler for MIDI IN.

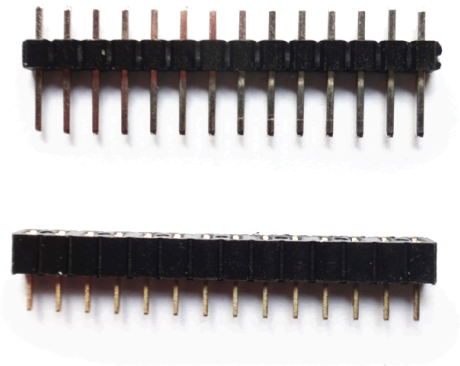
Make sure pin 1 is on the top left. Your chip will either have a notch at the top side or a circle mark at the first pin.

You can use an old-school IC socket, solder it in directly or use a socket with (round) precision pins.

All of these 3 methods should work fine.

NOTE: The location of the resistors, the diode and jumper blocks are slightly different on the newer capacitive touch PCB compared to the previous version. Otherwise, most instructions are valid for all versions.

Main PIN Header / Sockets



For the Teensy, the PCM 5102 DAC and the (optional) external Flash Chip, we will use pin rows and socket rows (and no IC sockets). The (low height) sockets will be soldered to the MDT PCB and all components will be attached to it with pin rows.

As the counterpart to the (low height) sockets, we will use traditional rows of pin headers with the pins of the short side of the plastic spacer snipped off.

We keep only the side with the longer pins.
Since the top side of Teensy will be blocked by the plastic spacers, you solder the pins onto the bottom side of Teensy.

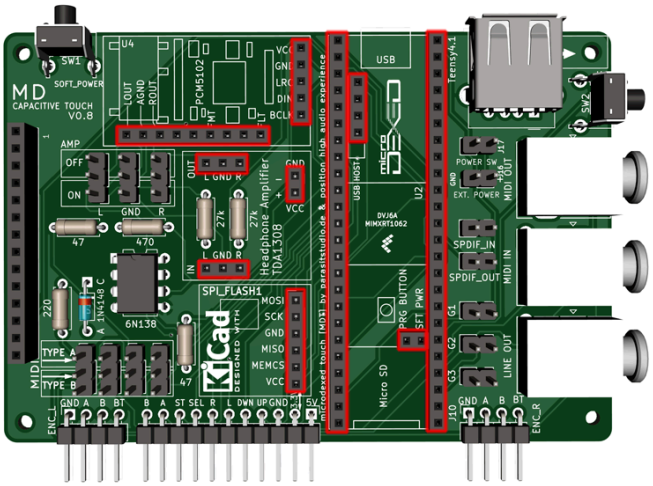
This is the reason why the pins are seemingly 2-3mm longer than they need to be for the sockets but the soldering will take up (some) of this extra space.It is possible to solder the parts the other way around. However for this guide, the above method is the suggested way.

For the Teensy we need 2 pieces of 24 pins.

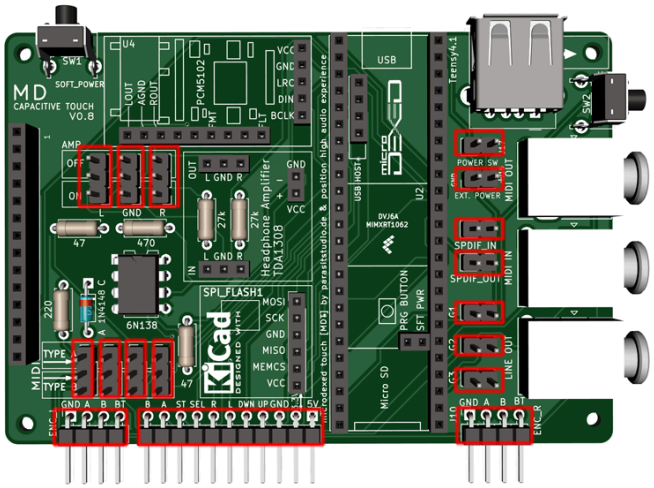
So for both rows, leave the plastic spacers exactly where they are from the factory and snip off the short pin side, directly above the plastic spacer.

This is a bit tedious. Take your time and take breaks when necessary.

Please take care to not hurt yourself or others while you snip the pins. These pins are sharp when cut and will fly off unpredictably if you are not careful.
Place yourself so that the cut pins will not fly in your direct direction and use eye protection so nothing can happen in this process to you, others around you or your pets 🐈 🙂

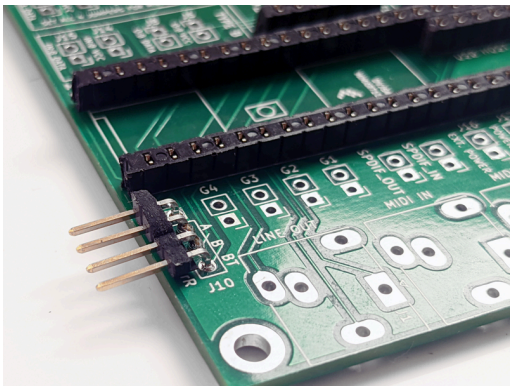


After the 2 long rows are cut like in the pictures above, we will do the same procedure to a much smaller row for the flash board, 2 for the PCM5102 and the USB Host Connector.
Note that we are not connecting the SCK pin for the PCM5102 so no pin/header is required there.



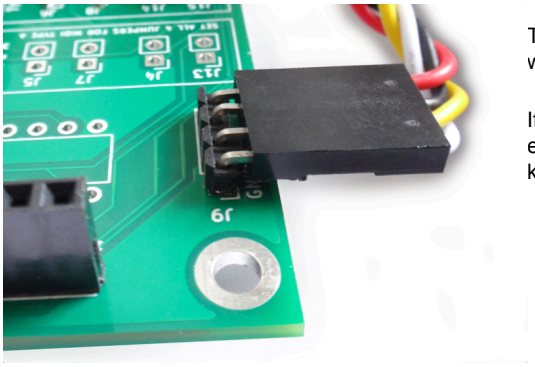
The 14 pin Display connector at the left side uses a **normal height** connector, **DO NOT** solder in a **low/half height row socket** there.

All the remaining headers/jumpers are regular pin headers, you do not have to cut anything or do anything unusual here. These are all regular jumper sockets/pins like on a Computer/PC Mainboard.



For the 2 encoder connections, it is advised to use vertical pin headers.

Also, depending on your encoders, if they come with a small PCB on their bottom to connect the pins instead directly to the decoder, it might be a good idea to solder the pin headers very lowly as seen in this image or even better to remove the attached tiny PCB from the encoders.



This way they will use the free space "above" the encoder's PCBs and won't collide with them.

If the encoders come with some resistors on the backside, it also is suggested to either remove the resistors (by force or by desoldering) - These resistors are known to cause issues in encoder direction processing and push events.

Encoders

Use standard dupont connectors for the encoders. 1 pin is ground, then the 2 encoder pins, then the last pin is for the push button.
If you are using encoders that come on a small PCB with resistors located at the bottom side and you experience unwanted "button push" events or other wrong encoder behavior, try to remove any resistors from the PCBs.

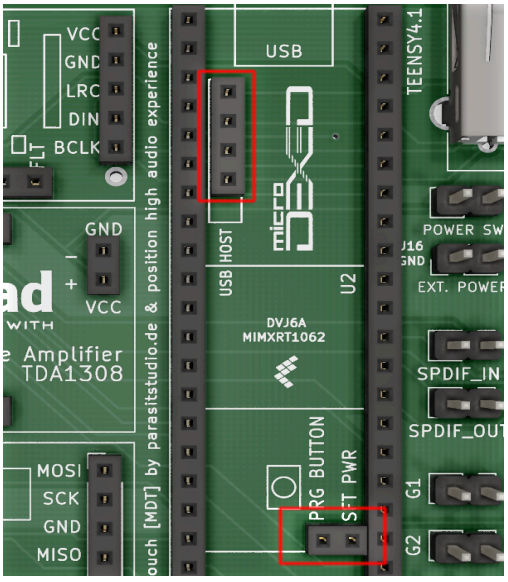
In fact it would be even better to remove the whole PCB and just use the bare encoders alone. This will prevent any collision with the SD Card in the Teensy, located very closely when you do not remove the small PCB.

The resistors on the encoder PCBs aren't necessary since debouncing is done in software and if you keep them, they are known to cause more problems than they help.

When your encoder does not have a common ground (GND) pin for encoder + button function but has separate GND pins for them, you can bridge both GND pins directly at the encoder.

This way you only have to connect one GND pin to the MDT PCB from each encoder.

Teensy Additional Sockets



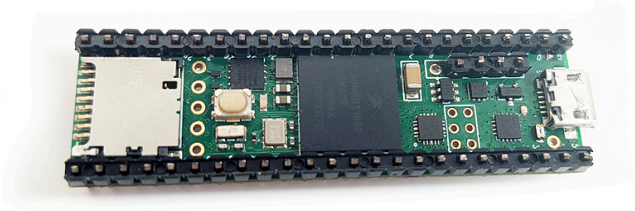
The small 4 pin row between the 2 large Teensy pin rows is for **USB MIDI HOST**. Do not forget to put in the socket and also the counterpart pin headers on the Teensy.

Put in the sockets on the PCB and test fit with the Teensy if everything lines up before you solder the sockets and pin rows.

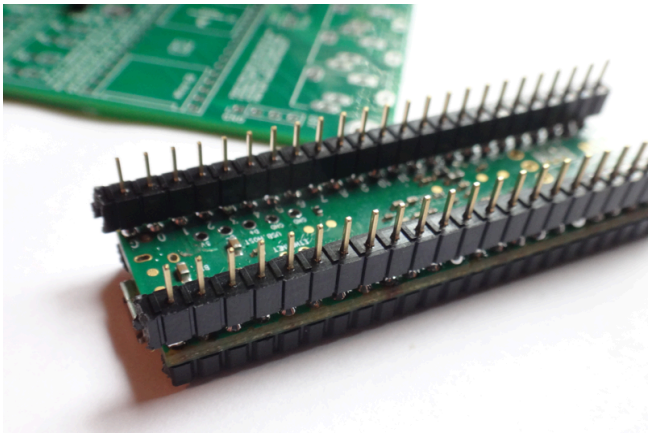
It is a suggestion to solder only the first and last pin, then every 4-5 pin of every row, test if it fits and then solder all remaining pins.

The capacitive touch PCB has an option to add buttons for **soft-power** and a **program-button**.
The **program-button** really is only required when something during firmware flashing goes wrong.

In this case it is more convenient that the button is reachable without opening the enclosure.
The **soft-power** function is mainly useful when using MDT with an optional battery.



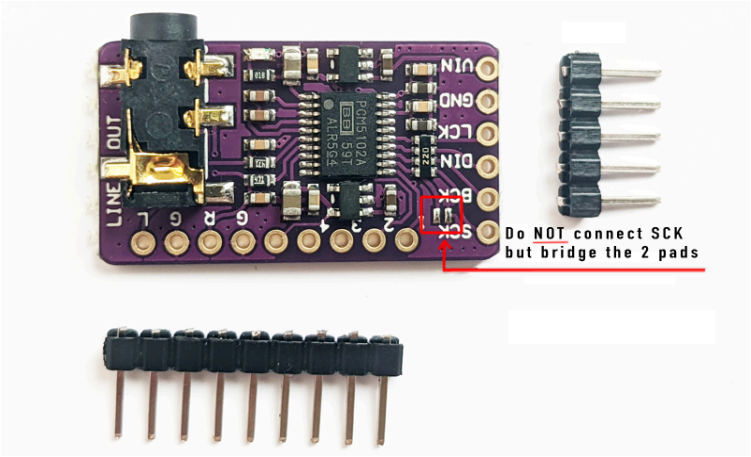
Teensy with pin headers



Teensy with pin headers and sockets, loosely attached to it to test fit.

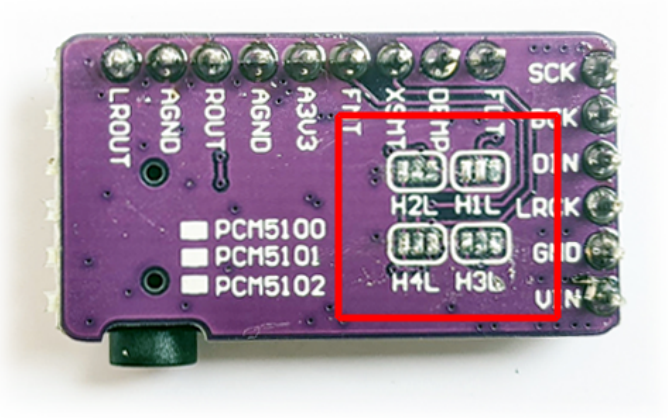
Audio (DAC)

Do the same kind of connector for the PCM5102 DAC Board. Snip of the short side of the header pins.



Do no connection for the SCK pin to the MDT PCB. Instead, close the 2 small pads on the top side to force SCK to ground.

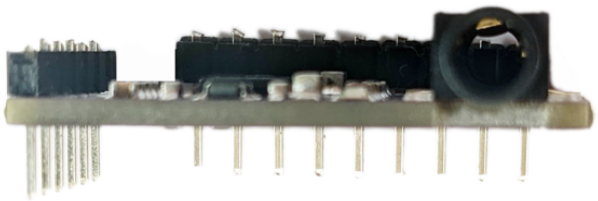
This will tell the PCM5102 to run its own, internal clock signal.



If any of the solder bridge pads on the backside come closed by the factory, remove all of them with a desoldering wick or your preferred desoldering tool/method.

If you get distorted/garbled audio, try to solder the bridges 1,2,4 to LOW , middle pad + right side and leave pin 3 without connection to LOW or HIGH.

Pin 3 will be controlled by the Teensy for audio muting control.



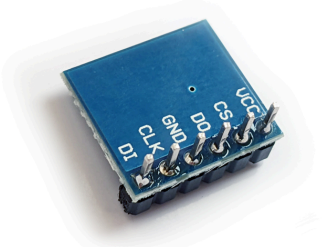
Front view with pin headers attached

SPI FLASH board (currently no longer used - depreciated)

Instead of manually soldering the Flash Chip to the Teensy Audio Board as we did in the previous generation, we go for this plug-and-play, 2$ board that already has a Flash Chip soldered on by factory.

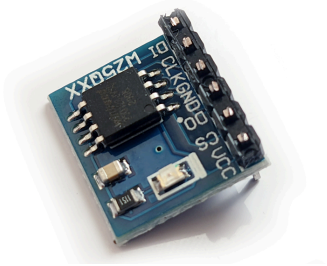
So you only need to solder standard size pins/connectors.

Do the same procedure as for the Teensy for the connection to the main PCB. Use pin headers, leave the plastic spacers exactly where they are at the factory and snip off the short pin side, directly above the plastic spacer.



Flash board with pin headers soldered, backside

Flash board with pin headers soldered, frontside

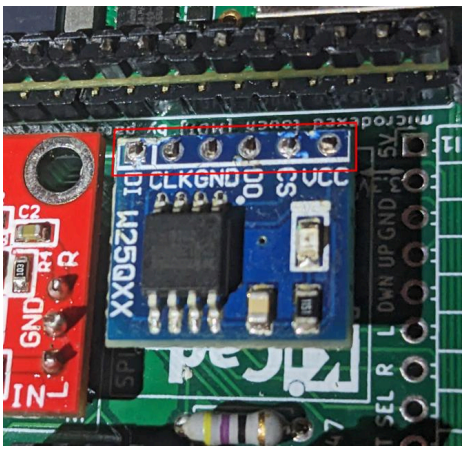


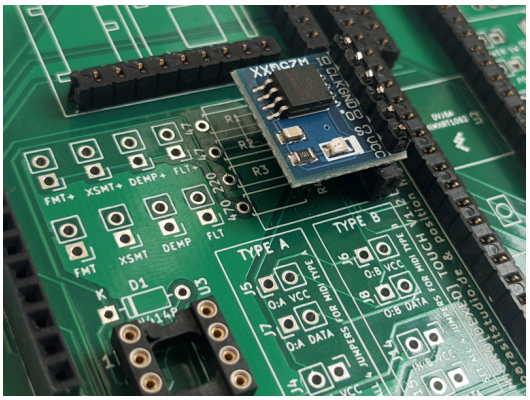
Flash board with pin headers soldered, frontside

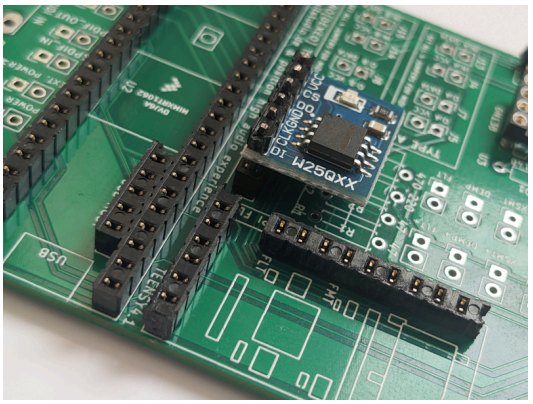
If you use the 3.2” Screen: Please remove the plastic spacer from the top of the SPI FLASH after soldering the pins from the bottom side.

You can force the plastic spacer off with a screwdriver or pick it up with small pliers. The reason to remove it, is that the display backside of the 3.2” Screen will have a connector sticking out and the pin row of the Flash board is the point where it will be touching first. So if you remove the plastic spacer, you have 2-4mm more room for display level height adjustments.

Another way is to take out the SPI Flash module out since its previous function is now replaced by the **PSRAM** chip (if you do have installed one)

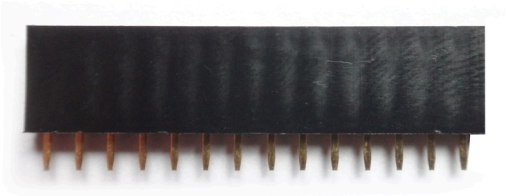


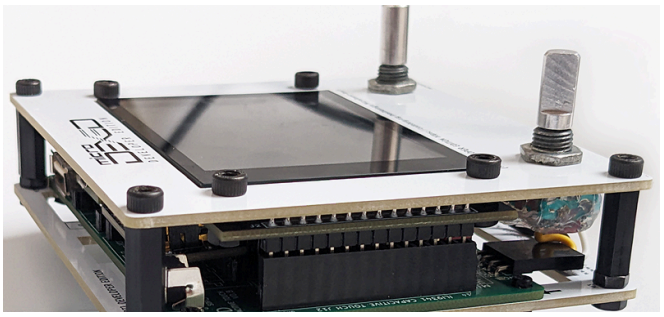




Display

The display connector used in MDT is a standard size connector (**8.5mm tall**), not the half height connectors used in the previous steps. The connector should match up with the pin header that the display comes with by factory default.

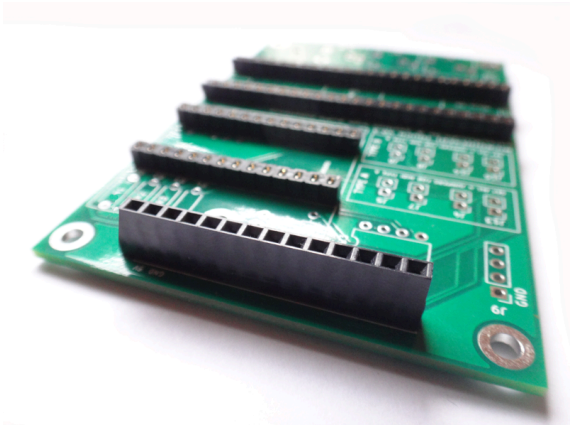




It should not matter if there is a small gap between the lid + display and the pin socket, when fully assembled. The connection is still stable when the gap is not getting much bigger than in this example picture.

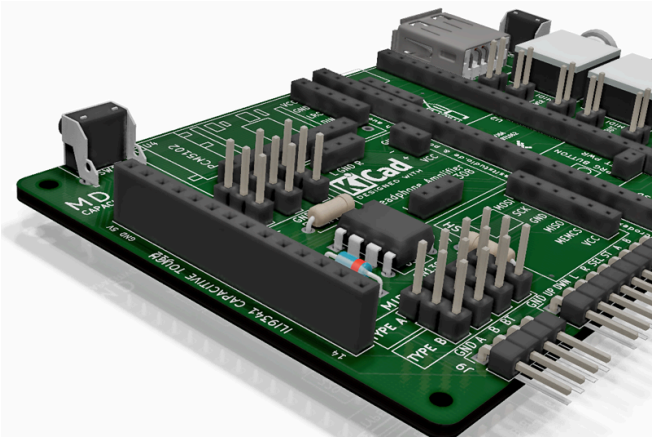
The gap depends on your 3D print, how much solder you have used, on the audio board pin rows etc - it will also be influenced by how tight you screw on the display to the lid, and with which spacers, in a later step.

There are various versions/kinds of this display on the market so there might be some unknown tolerances.



If the display turns out to be to high in the top shelf when fully assembled, the gap between the connector pins and socket on the MDT PCB allows for putting spacers to the **4 display holding screws** + nuts, so you can adjust the position a bit to make it flush to the device top faceplate.
If nuts are too big for any adjustment, washers, or small pieces of thick tape might help in this situation, placed at the corners of the display on the backside of the lid part.

If your display is working but your touch screen input is reversed/mirrored in one or both directions, you can change it in **SYSTEM - SYSTEM SETTINGS**.



Generic advice for the Display

Regardless of which display is used (2.8", 3.2", capacitive or resistive):

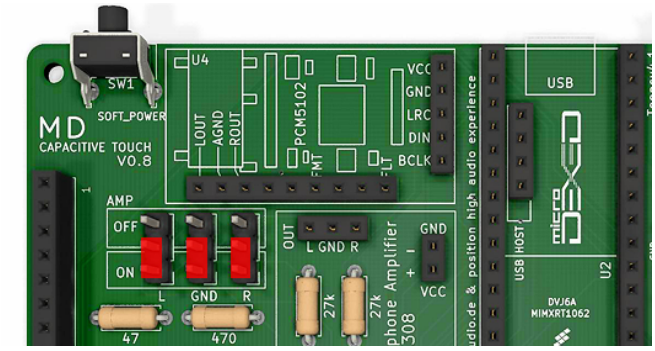
Take off the metal lid from the SD card reader on the TFT backside. These larger types of SD card are outdated and we already have a MICRO SD Card reader available on Teensy.
If you are sure you do not need it in the future, you can quickly snip it off at its 4 holding / soldering pads with a small cutting tool.

To avoid any unwanted electrical contact on the bottom side of the TFT to the teensy pin headers, you should put a non conductive layer between them. Kapton (Polyamide) or Electrical tape, 1-2 layers, should be sufficient.

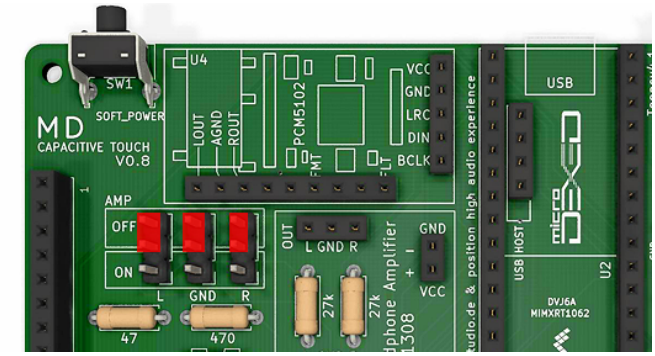
Before complete assembly, visually check that none of the components on the MDT board are touching the bottom of the display board. There should be sufficient clearance from all components when the SD reader is removed from the bottom of the display.

MIDI and AUDIO AMP Jumpers

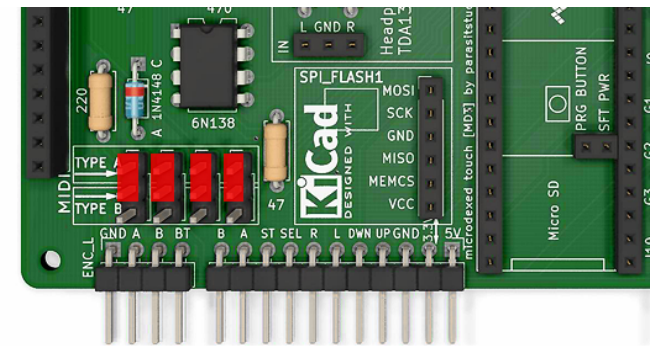
The **AUDIO AMP** jumpers apply to **MDT Capacitive Touch**, only.



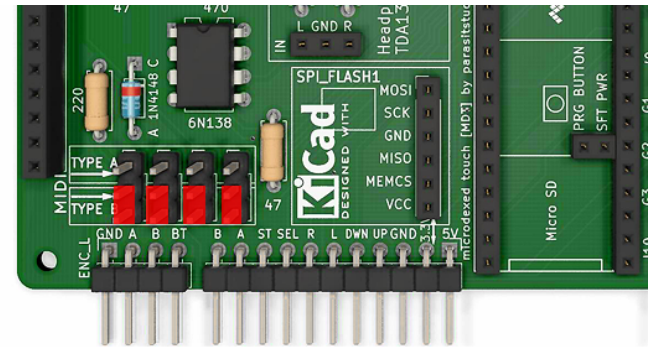
If you have added the optional Headphone Amplifier, set the 3 AMP Jumpers to the ON position.



If you have not added the optional Headphone Amplifier, or want to bypass it, set the 3 AMP Jumpers to the OFF position.

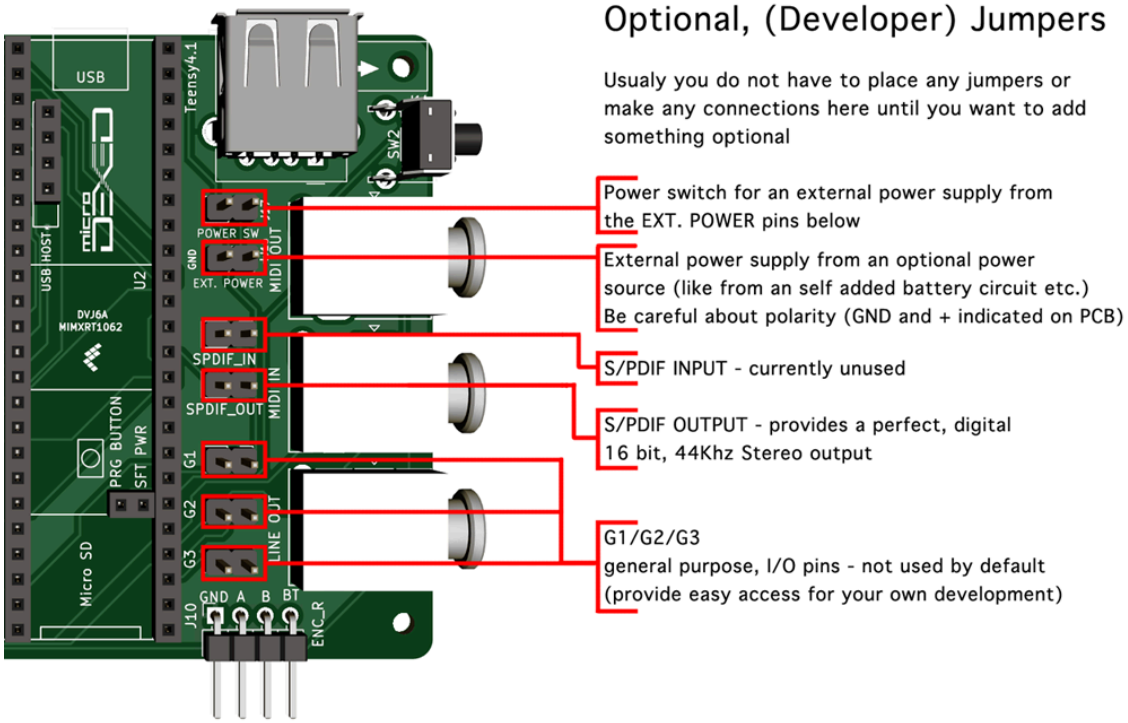


If you want to use TRS JACK TYPE A MIDI devices on Input and Output, place jumpers to the A position.



If you want to use TRS JACK TYPE B MIDI devices on Input and Output, place jumpers to the B position.

Optional Pins / Connectors on the right side of MDT PCB



Usually you do not have to place any jumpers here and do not have to make any connections. Consider this jumper block as optional when you want to add any customized code, external rechargeable battery board etc.

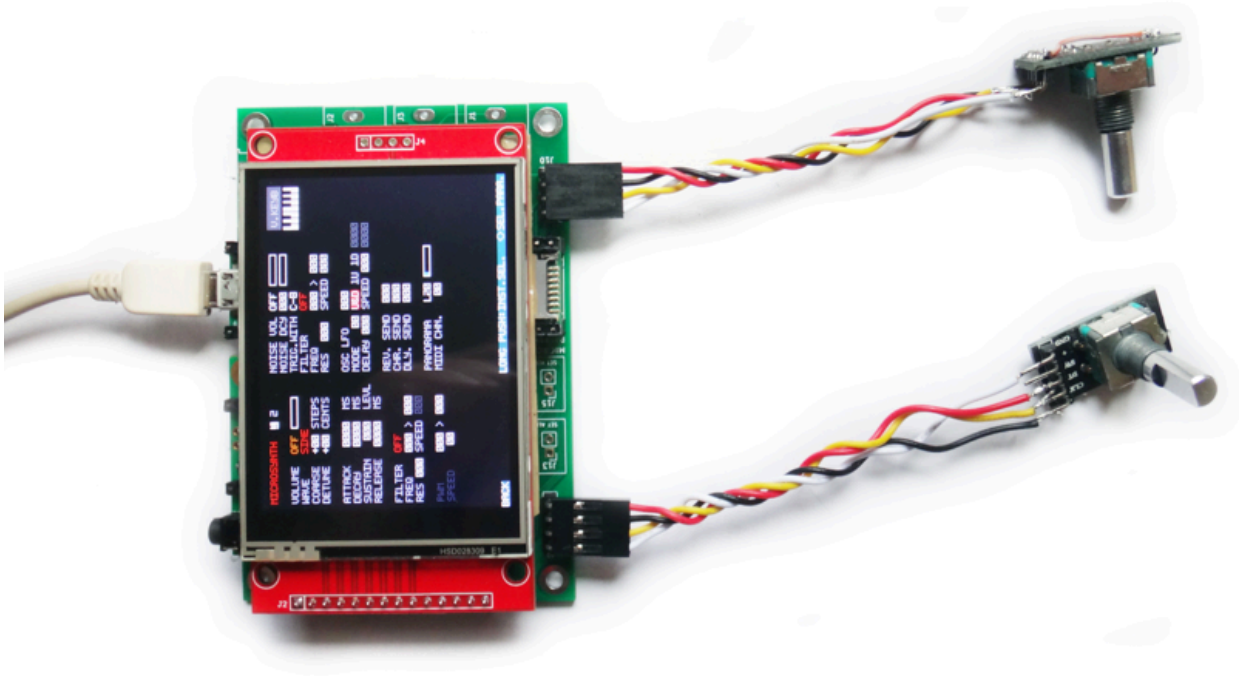
If you do have any S/PDIF outboard equipment, you might want to use the digital output S/PDIF pins to connect to your digital mixer or other digital input device to get a perfect, digital clear 16bit, 44Khz stereo output from MDT master output.

S/PDIF OUTPUT is known and tested to be fully working, S/PDIF is currently unused/untested.

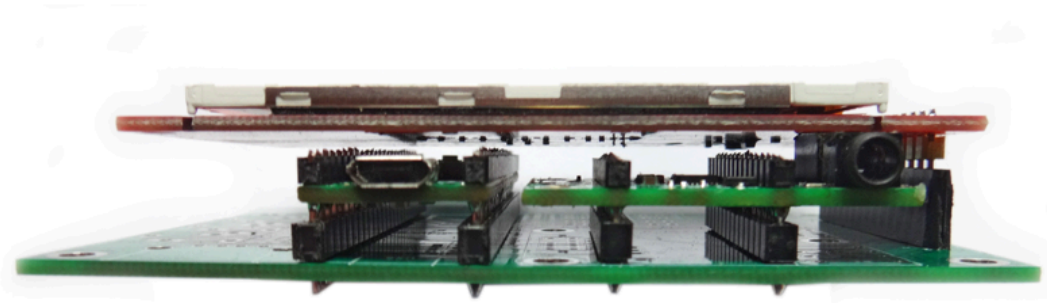
First Test

At this stage, it should be possible to do a first test.

You do not need to put in a SD CARD with the preset files copied to it. MicroDexed should at least boot up and the **menu/encoders** can be tested in the menu - however it will take a few more seconds than usual to start up, if there is no SD CARD with valid files present.



MDT (first generation with resistive touch)



Case/Enclosure(s)

There are several different versions provided for self printing or to be bought.
A simple case for MicroDexed (or you can use your favorite 3d printing service to do that) is shown here.

Also you can order a printed SLA case (and other options) from PCBWAY.

You can get SLA printed parts from PCBWAY with excellent quality.

The shopping and download links are at the bottom of this main page at PCBWAY:

https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/MicroDexed_Capacitive_Touch_64970fee.html

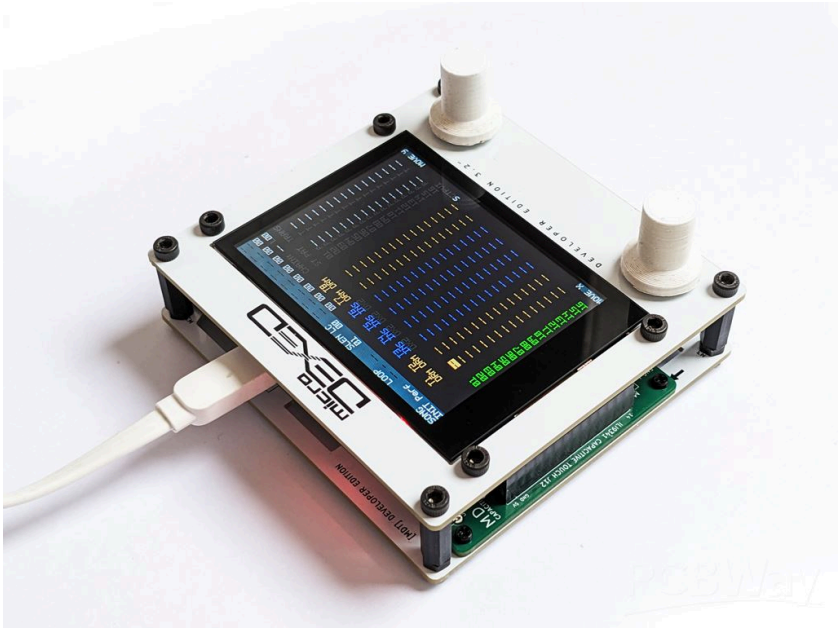
Print quality is much higher, of what you can expect from a homemade FDM or SLA, DIY print.

Since **SLA Prints can not be melted by a hot iron**, this version has some special modification that will perfectly fit M3 threaded inserts to be superglued in, with 1-2 drops.

The SLA version also has some extra details that are not possible to print by a FDM printer, like the MDT Logo.

MDT Developer Edition (PCB Based Enclosure)

If you do not want to use a printed enclosure, there is an alternative solution available from PCBWAY that consists of 2 bare PCBs as a top and bottom part that is screwed together with M2 + M3 screws, extenders and some lock nuts.



This is referred as the **MDT DEVELOPER EDITION**

Similar as for the printed case, this option is also available for the 3.2" display. In both cases, only the top plate/ top lid needs a different part to fit the display. The bottom part is identical for the 2.8" and the 3.2" screen, no matter if it is printed or the PCB based alternative.

The following video demonstrates how this is intended to work.

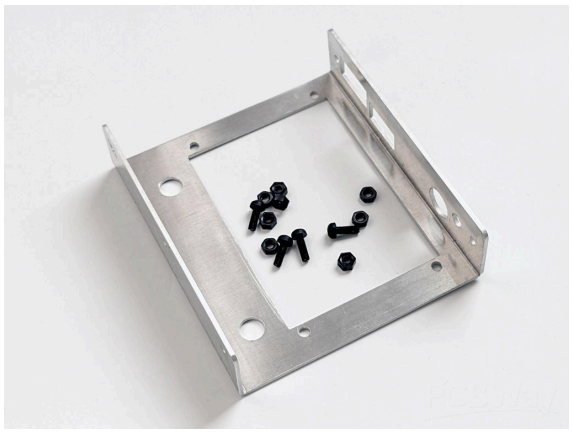
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sjoiCc8XJiM

Here are the links for the PCB-based enclosure:

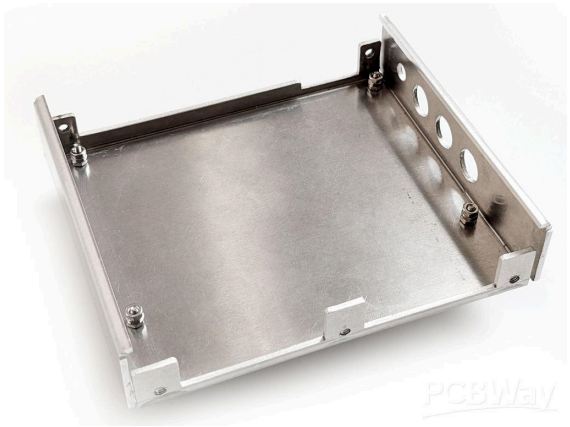
Front:
https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/W424985ASE20_pcb_enclosure_front_plane_c17b035e.html

Back:
https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/mdt_pcb_enclosure_bottom_plane_39654ff7.html

Metal (Aluminium) Case:



Metal Front Part



Metal Back Part

More Case Options

The first case option described here is the improved DIY print version, featuring threaded inserts for M3 screws. This makes the overall stability and handling much better since you can open/close the device as many times as you like, without having to rely only on the printed snap-in clips to hold it together.

Since it is easier to build the previous version with the snap-in clips only, that is still available as an option further down this page.

It is however recommended to build the threaded version, even though it needs some more parts and also more effort to put together but it is well worth it.

To make the instructions less confusing, photos on this page showing a black case are for the snap-case, the photos with the white case are for the improved, threaded inserts version.

Threaded Inserts Case

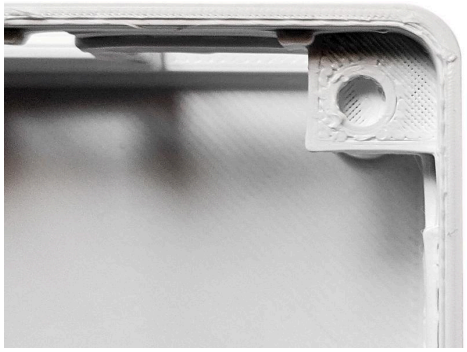
This page is about a self-printed (FDM) 3d print. It is also available from PCBWAY as a **SLA PRINT** that looks very similar but has minor differences, for example the holes for the following screw inserts are a little bigger since the inserts need to be glued in, not melted in as described here.

The reason for this is that SLA (resin) prints can not be melted.

This case has 4 mounting posts, 1 at each corner of the device.

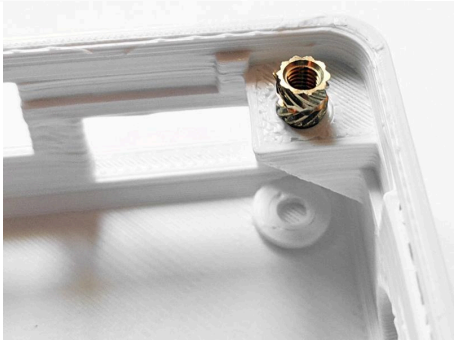
These are the inserts we are using, the M3 x 5.7 x 4.6

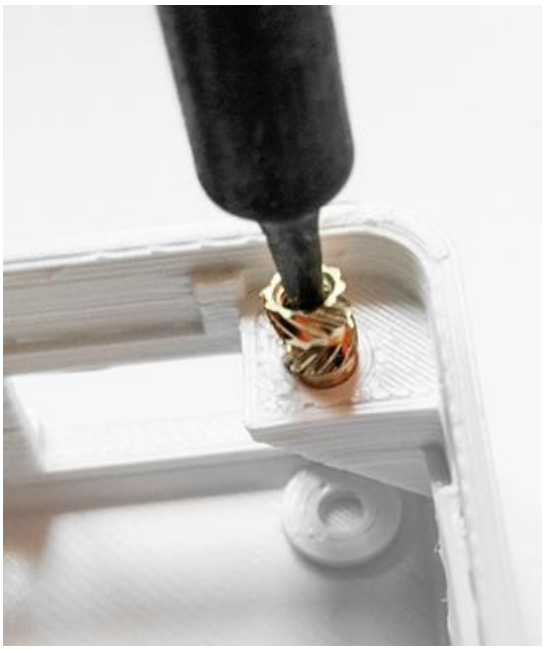
Maybe it is possible you can get a smaller amount of them (since you only need 4 pieces) but it might be easier to get a full set like this from Amazon, ebay etc.
If you do any kind of 3d printing, this is a package you can use for a lot of other projects, too.
I will add links to a set like this in the BOM.



Close up mounting post

Each insert has 3 "zones". The zone with the smallest diameter will fit into the case like this.





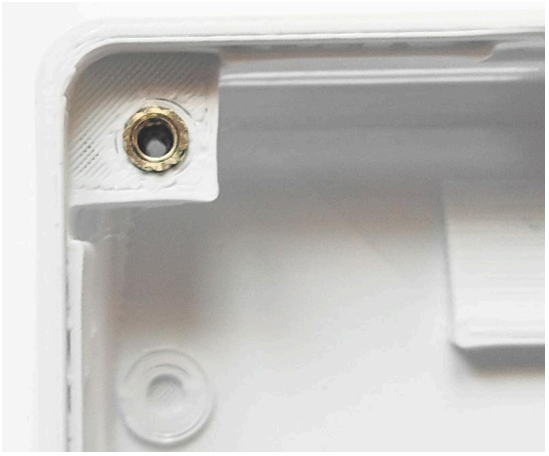
To drive the insert into the case, you basically heat up your soldering iron to 175-180 degree celsius.

If there is left residue of solder on your iron, heat it up to your usual soldering temperature first, and clean the iron tip as good as possible. It must be avoided that you put solder inside of the inserts, by accident. When the soldering iron tip is clean of solder, switch down to a temperature of 175-180 degree celsius and give it enough time to "cool off". Then push in the insert slowly with the tip of the iron.

This is a matter of maybe 4-5 seconds. Do not push it in too deeply - it should be flush with the top surface of the mounting post.

It should be possible to make some corrections by re-heating but if you haven't any experience with this procedure, it is recommended to practice with at least 1 other printed 3d part (maybe you have some failed prints or test prints from this or another project).

The printing time of the bottom case for Microdexed is around 4 hours. So it is a good idea, to have some practice on another print object, first.



The insert should look similar to this after melting it in.

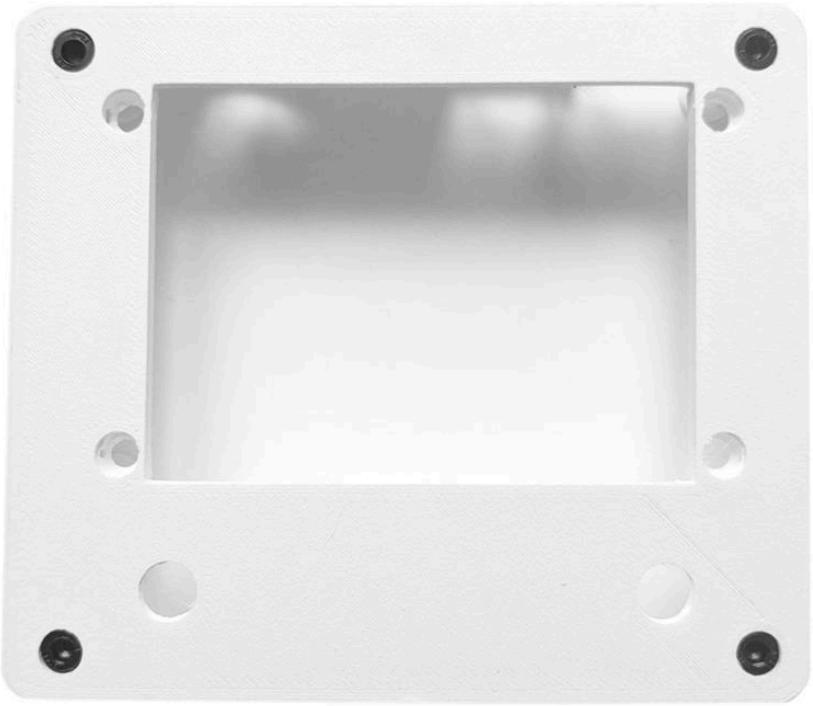
This is the case with all 4 inserts fitted.

For the screw part you can use M3 x 4 or M3 x 5 screws. It is possible to even use much longer M3 screws - but that only makes sense if you have such already available in front of you -

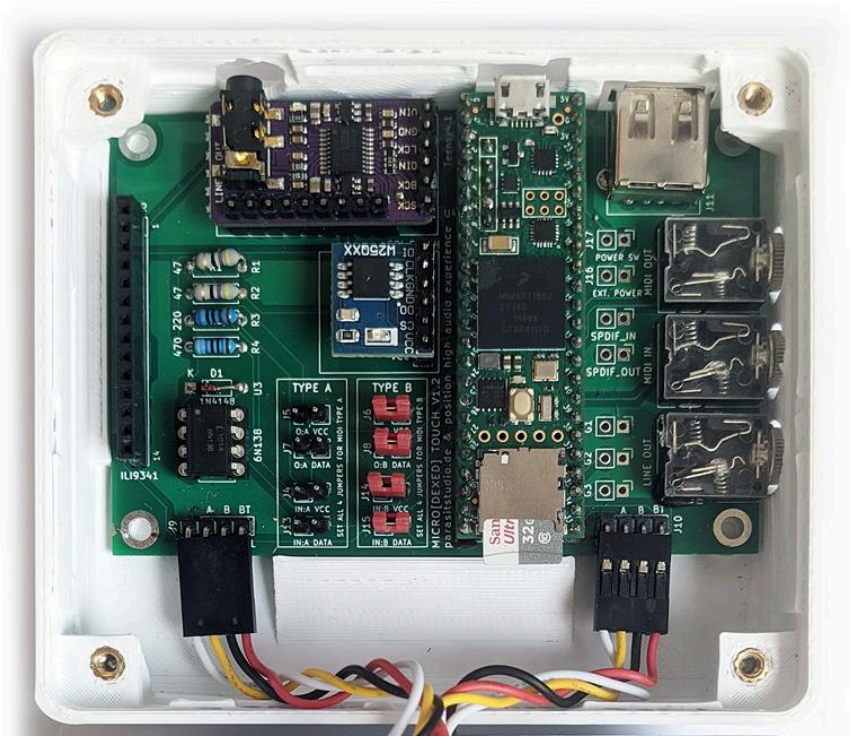
otherwise it is better to go with the M3 x 4. As a side topic, for the screen attachment, we will use the M3 x 6.

Various M3 screws from x4 - x24 as a kit from Amazon.

The head part of the M3 should be flush with the top of the device, after screwing in.



In the image, all 4 case screws in place



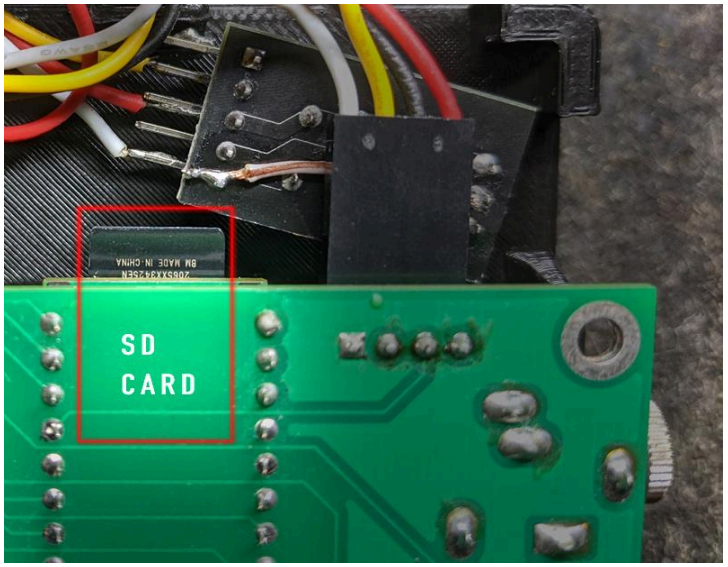
This is the PCB inside the threaded inserts case.

Notice that the 2 encoders used in the picture had to be rotated a bit, to make space for the mounting posts.

Depending on the Encoders you are using, this might be necessary, or not.
If it seems not to fit, even by rotating: If they come with a small attached PCB, like in the picture, it might be an idea to saw off some empty space from it or remove the small PCB below the Encoder altogether.

If you decide to saw off something, carefully check if there are traces on the top or bottom side that are required. In the sample picture, I have manually connected a ground wire since i saw off part of its pcb trace.

Check SD CARD and Encoder Collision

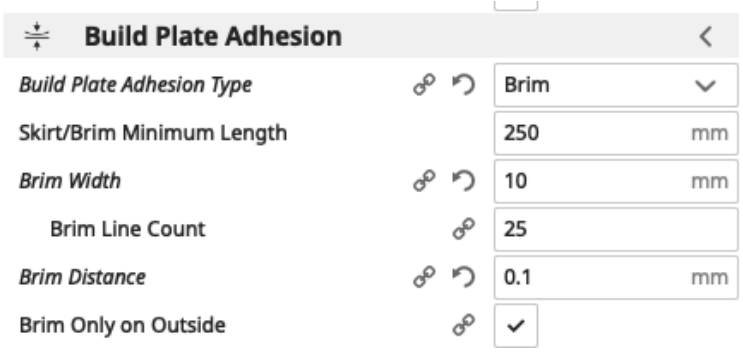


If you have encoders that have a small PCB attached at the bottom, check that there is no overlap or collision with the SD CARD of the Teensy.
If they do overlap, you might be able to cut/saw the PCBs a bit or just rotate them a few degrees away, like in the picture above.

Observe that nothing touches the SD CARD when you put everything together.
Do not put any mechanical stress on your SD CARD or sooner or later it will get a fracture and then become unreliable or will stop working completely.

3D PRINTING TIPS - Valid for both case home printing

If the case dimensions do not fit 100%, check if your slicer has an option as in the screen shown above.



If you have problems with the case parts coming off the build plate during print, it is recommended to print a brim around each part. This helps a lot to not get any lift-ups during the print, even without any build plate heating.

All STL Files, for FDM, will print **without any support structures**.

STL Files for self printed case

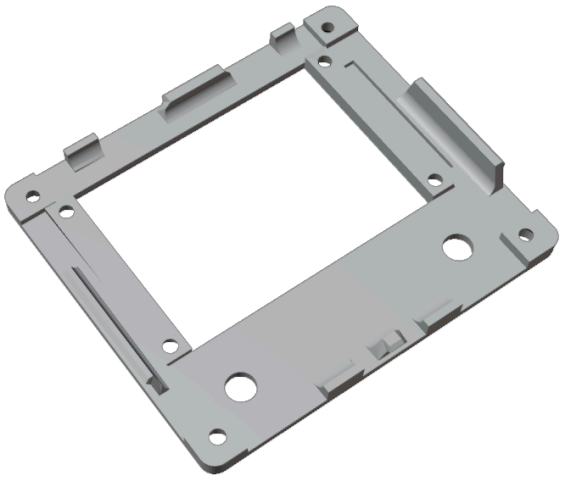
You can grab (or order) the latest file versions for the SLA Enclosure at the PCBWAY site at the BOTTOM of the webpage.

STL - CASE BOTTOM (threaded insert version):

https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-BOTTOM-Threaded-Inserts.stl

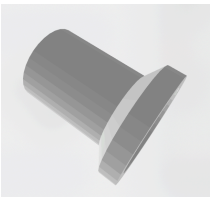
STL - CASE LID (threaded insert version):

https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-LID-Threaded-Inserts.stl



STL - KNOB (you will use two of them or bring your own encoder caps):

https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-KNOB.stl



Case Modification (For easy SD CARD access)

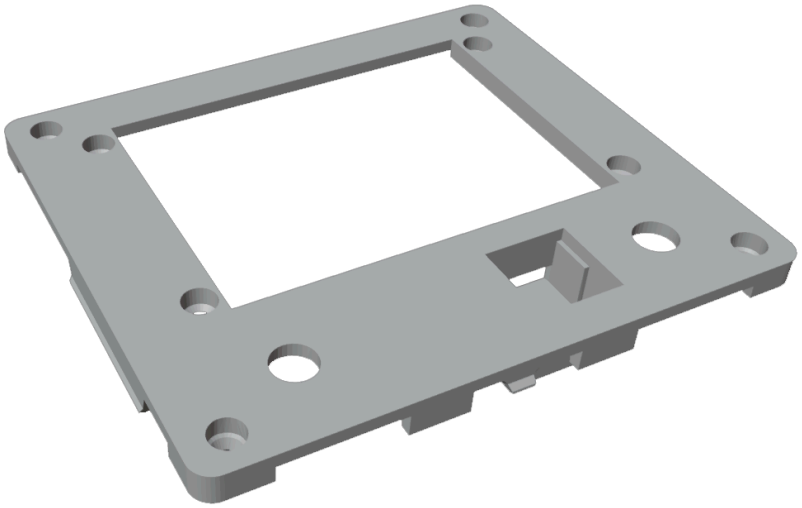
This section is about a modified LID part, there is no change required for the bottom part of the enclosure.

This modification looks a bit hacked and it is, however it has been tested for several months now and if you do not care so much about the design or looks, this hack is very useful. There is about no reason to open the enclosure ever again, if you use this lid.

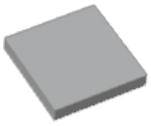
On our youtube playlist you find a video covering this topic at:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yFXT1o5kOMk

There is about 1-2 mm tolerance about the bottom position of the card slot entry. This is by design since we do not know exactly about the total height your teensy is in the low profile socket. That really depends on your soldering style.

If you find the bottom position to be too high or low in general, you can edit the .stl file for example with blender to fit your unit. Or let us know in discord chat what you need and we will provide some additional version with maybe 1 or 2 mm height adjustments.

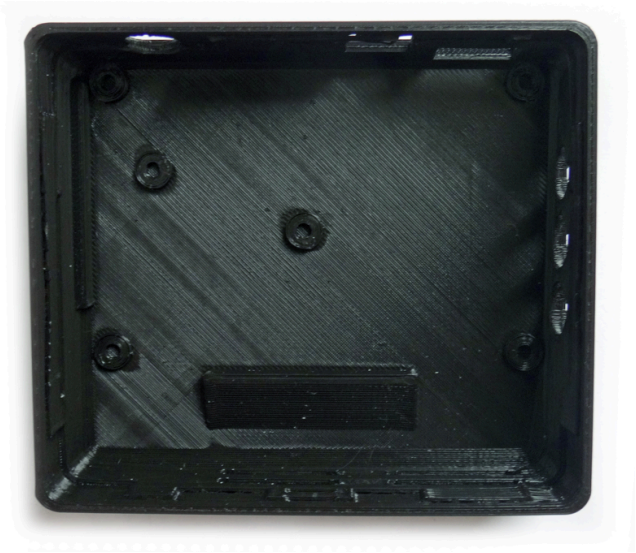


https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-SDMOD-LID.stl



https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-SDMOD-LID-COVER.stl

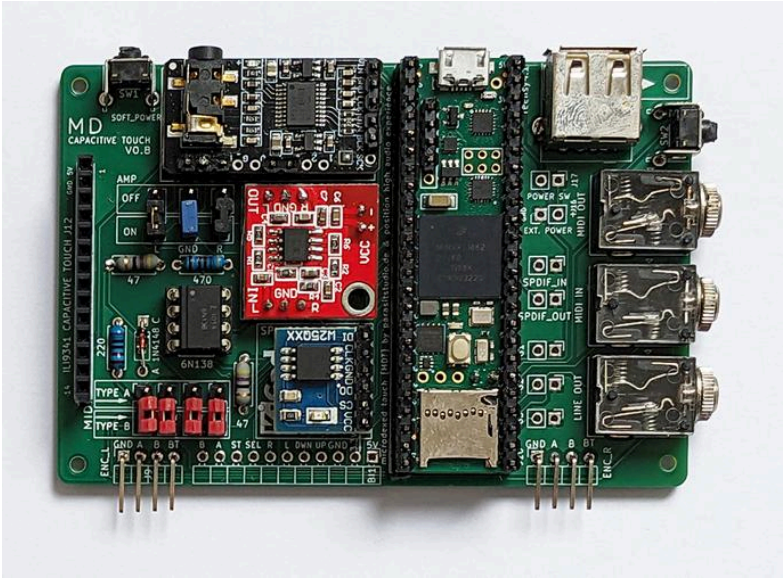
Old Case (without Threaded Inserts, deprecated)



This is the bare bottom case. With the spacers of the case itself and the height matching the display's the PCB should not move in any direction when put together.

3D print (STL) files:
https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-BOTTOM.stl
https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-LID.stl
https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/raw/branch/main/doc/Build_InstructionsV2/CASE-KNOB.stl

Slide the PCB+Teensy assembly in the lower case. You might have to tilt a bit to the right side of the audio/midi connectors.



PCB with all on board components ready

Final Assembly (depreciated first case version)

Final Assembly (Threaded Inserts Case)

Synthesizer Engines

dexed / MicroDexed

Dexed is a FM-type softsynth developed by Pascal Gauthier of Digital Suburban. It is an ideal application for importing, playing and editing/managing sysex patches from both the classic Yamaha DX7 synthesizer and the TX7.

Dexed includes six operators, faithful to DX structure. Each operator has a level indicator. The operators can be arranged in various algorithms, indicated by the green boxes. Patch banks are called "cartridges" and there are many (about 32) included in the installation package. Selecting a cartridge loads the patches in the relative bank.

Dexed can be configured to use some of the original math limitations of a DX synthesizer. This does not only apply to the DAC, it also involves the bit resolution of the sine waves and the way that the amplitude is applied to each operator. Since all of this is experimental, multiple engines will be available to be able to compare them easily.

Dexed comes with 3 engine types:

- **Modern:** this is the original 24-bit music-synthesizer-for-android implementation.
- **Mark I:** Based on the OPL Series but at a higher resolution (LUT are 10-bits). The target of this engine is to be closest to the real DX7.
- **OPL Series:** this is an experimental implementation of the reversed engineered OPL family chips. 8-bit. Keep in mind that the envelopes still needs tuning.

Features:

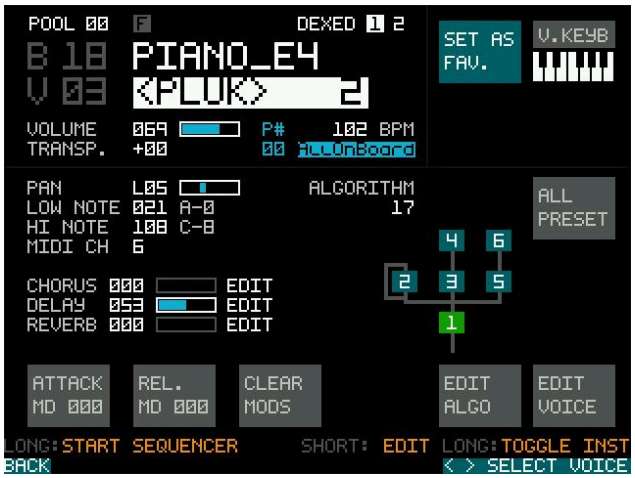
- Multi platform (OS X, Windows or Linux) and multi format (VST, AU, LV2)
- The sound engine music-synthesizer-for-android is closely modeled on the original DX7 characteristics
- 144 DAW automatable DX7 parameters available from one single panel
- Fully supports DX7 input and output Sysex messages; including controller change. This means that you can use this with a native DX7/TX7 as a patch editor and sysex manager
- Each operator have a realtime VU meter to know which one is active
- Can load/save any DX7/TX7 sysex programs. It is also possible to save a single program into a different sysex file.

MicroDexed is a conversion of **dexed** to the **Teensy platform**. Most of the above features are identical, including the engine types.

MicroDexed features 2 instances of **dexed**, meaning you can play / address 2 different voices/sounds at the same time with a polyphony of 16 notes, each.

A full featured patch / voice editor is available on device.

Further, you can add chorus, delay and reverb effects to both instances individually.



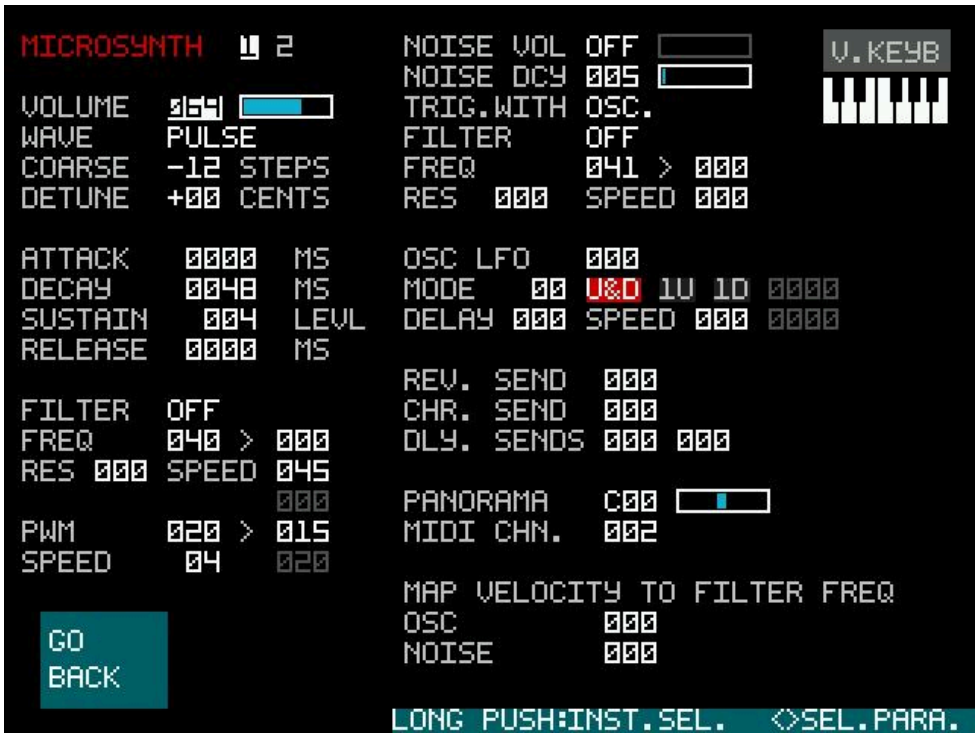
microsynth

Microsynth is a monophonic, 1 OSC synthesizer, based on the building blocks the Teensy audio library provides with some extensions. Since, like in dexed, you have 2 instances, both can be layered so you can get a 2 Oscillator Synth out of it or use them seperately as 2 individual instruments.

The available waveforms are very basic and exist in a full spectrum and in a spectrum-limited version.
Further, each instance has a dedicated noise generator that can be triggered together with the Oscillator or independently.

The Oscillators and the noise generators come with their individual, multimode filters. The strength of the filter cutoff can be adapted in real time by velocity information.

Microsynths strengths are short, percussive sound and also bass sounds, especially when using the filter(s).



ePiano

MDA ePiano is a simple but good Electric Piano virtual instrument. It emulates quite nicely the warm sound of a Fender Rhodes, while consuming very little resources. It has a few options only, but it's all you need. Simplicity is beauty.

Back in the 20th century, plugins from Maxim Digital Audio (mda) were among the early VST plugins available for Windows. They have a reputation for being high quality with low CPU usage.

Features:

- Based around 12 carefully sampled and mastered Rhodes Piano samples.
- 1-32 voice polyphony
- Unique width control
- Decay, Release
- Stereo Width
- Velocity sensitivity
- muffle and hardness amount adjustable
- Gentle muffling filter

MDT adds the option for reverb and delay effects to ePiano.

Braids

(by Mutable Instruments)

Two rows of mostly Mutable Instruments Eurorack format modules.

Mutable Instruments (**MI**) based in France is a manufacturer of Eurorack synthesizer modules, founded in 2009 selling DIY kits and owned by the designer/engineer Émilie Gillet. All MI products are are fully open source hardware under a CC-BY-SA license.[1]

The Braids is a digital macro-oscillator. It´s sound engine outclasses any VCO by far because the sounds are very complex and only two controls are used to affect several timbre parameters simultaneously. Braids is capable of different synthesis forms like FM, wavetable, vocal sound creation, analog emulation, noise, digital synthesis and even physical modeling. And it sounds awesome!

Braids is a voltage controlled digital oscillator that features 33 synthesis algorithms from 8 categories:

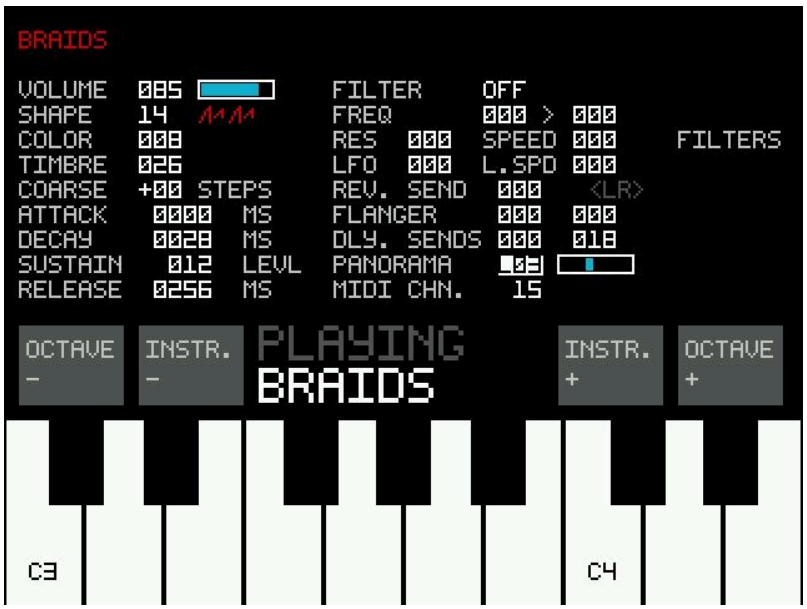
- Emulations of analog VCOs with morphing, double pulses ,wave multipliers etc.
- digital synthesis: ring modulated sine waves ,"super saws", digitally filtered waves, electronic toy sounds
- vocal- and formant synthesis, also in a nice 80ies home computer style
- two-Operator FM
- Physical Modeling: Simulations of bells, tubes and strings with pressure control.
- Wavetable-Synthese. 2x 256 wave forms
- Filtered, colored and pitched noise, granular noise, particle system simulation

In addition you`ll find a note quantizer for the input CV. The sample rate and bit rate are adjustable (up to 96kHz sample rate), A trigger at the according input fires an AD envelope to modulate the timbre.

The VCO has controls for coarse and fine tune as well as for the voltage controlled complex parameters TIMBRE and COLOR. Timbre has a polarizer for adjusting modulation depth. A FM input with polarizer is available too.

MDT features:

- Instead of 1 Braids oscillator, you get 8 of them. So MDT is a software equivalent of 8 braids modules, combined together.
- MDT adds a multimode filter to every single instance. Meaning you can play braids like a polyphonic instrument, with filters.
- MDT adds a reverb and 2 delay effects to the combined output.



MSP

MultiSamplePlayer (MSP) was created to allow usage of custom samples and even custom multi-samples, meaning samples of an instrument at different pitches, to allow for a more realistic sounding instrument, based on sample technology.

MSP also can be used to play just single drum samples with direct access to pitch, panorama, volume and reverb send.
Further details can be set in the DRUMS page.

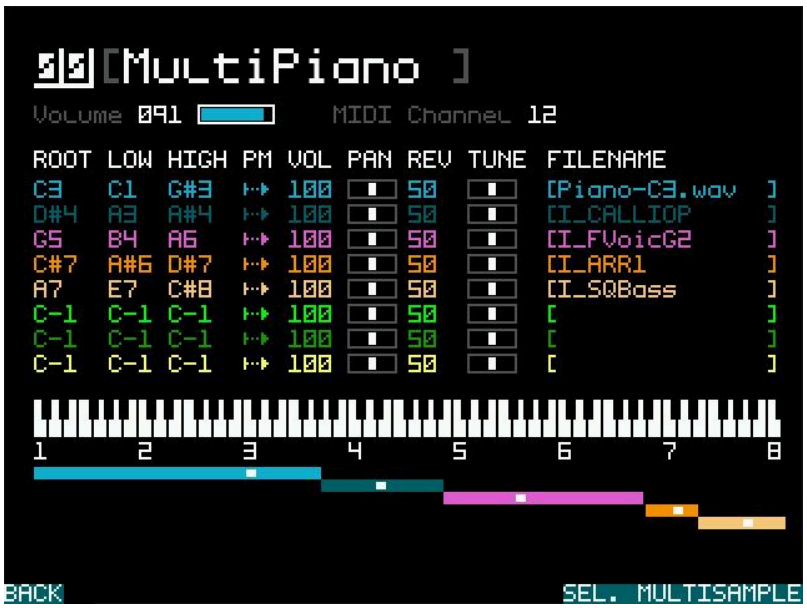
This feature can be partly experienced by using the (now depreciated) SPI Flash module. This turned out to not work reliably.

As a consequence, we switched that in summer 2024 to one (or two) PSRAM chips that are located (and soldered) to the backside of the Teensy Microcontroller.

This now gives full and stable control for custom samples, playing from the PSRAM chip(s).

It is usable as a live instrument and also can be triggered by both sequencers.

Further details about the usage and features of MSP are in the SEQUENCER chapter.



Sequencer

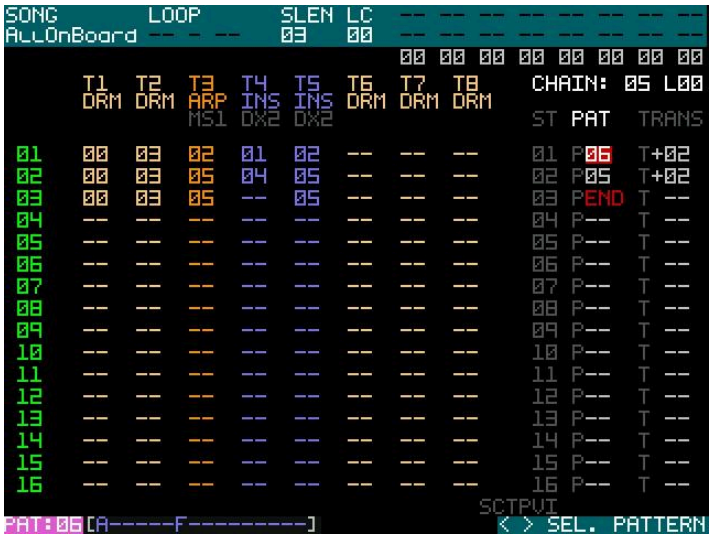
Microdexed features 2 different Sequencers that can be used at the same time.

The more modern one is **LiveSequencer** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z4lCJskHSTA

It is very easy to understand and fun to operate.

The previous sequencer is a LSDJ style, song/chain/pattern oriented sequencer which is capable but more complicated to get used to.

Sequencer overview

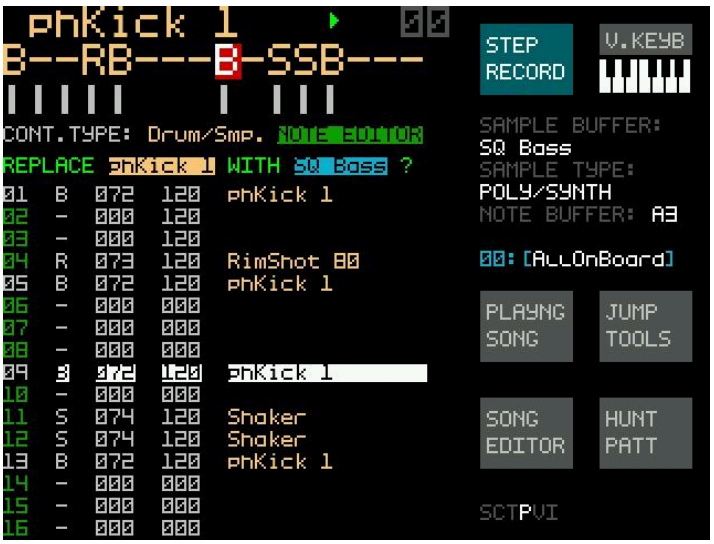


SONG VIEW

MicroDexed features an onboard sequencer that makes it possible to play up to 8 (SERIAL MIDI / USB MIDI / SAMPLE / MULTI-SAMPLE / DEXED / MDA ePiano / BRAIDS etc.) tracks simultaneously.

You can record your patterns either via (USB) MIDI in real time, by a step recorder or by manually putting in the note and velocity data on the device itself, without using any external equipment. The step recorder can be enabled by touch and allows for note/velocity input by your preferred input device/controller for every single pattern with 16 steps.

This makes MicroDexed a musical sketchpad, a practice companion for bands, vocal artists etc.



PATTERN EDITOR

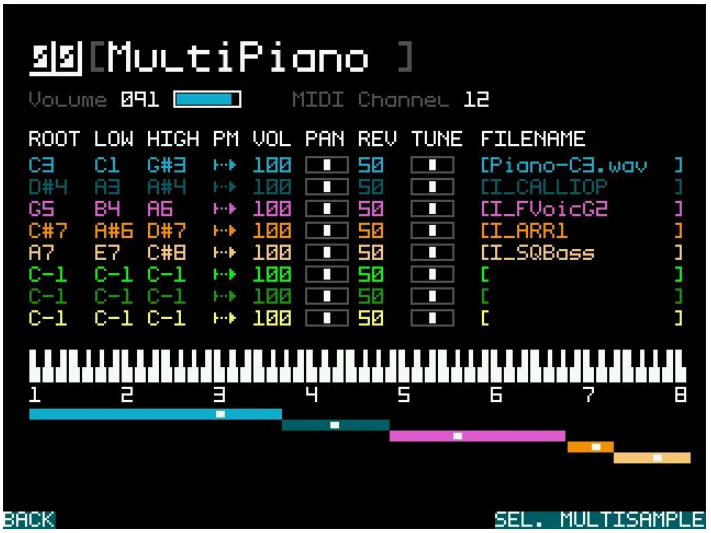
Since MicroDexed is also able to play back short audio samples, the sequencer can also be used as a drumcomputer.

Compared to a "traditional" tracker software like it was on the Amiga or other popular trackers, notes on a single track will not cancel out the previously played sound/sample from the same track. At least that is true until the polyphony limit is reached, that currently is 16 notes for each of the DEXED instances and 8 notes from the drum/sample engine. Microsynth, MDA ePiano and Braids have their own polyphony count of 2, 16 and 8 voices on top of that.

Starting from V1.0, when you have an SPI Flash chip module soldered, MicroDexed can also play multi-sampled instruments.

Since Summer 2024, SPI Flash is deprecated for sample playback and replaced by PSRAM. This allows for stable and easy use of custom samples.

Multi-Sample Player (MSP)



Multi samples allow you to have up to 8 samples for a single instrument, with multiple pitched, native samples as a sound source.

These (up to) 8 samples are called sample zones - All in-between pitches will be assigned and calculated to their best target automatically.

To make the automatic assignment possible, you have to name your sample files in a way that the filenames end with the root note of the sample in the name.

All common types of naming conventions are supported - Usually that is something like **MySampleXY-C4**.wav or **MySampleXY-C5**.wav - also half tones are supported, like **MySampleXY-D#2**.wav

Instead of **-** as a separator, you can also use **_** underscore.

You can edit these auto assign values later, if you are going for something different as a multi-sample instrument. For example when you want to use drum loops, vocal samples, effects or other one-shot samples, on to be played by a single note value.

Everything in the sequencer is highly customizable. That also is true for the included arpeggiator. Further, a single track can be used to play full chords and chord progressions.

Nearly all features and parameters are available during playback. This means that you also can play live on MicroDexed, while the sequencer is running. Also you can modify live the sequenced information, change playback options of the arpeggiator or the chord function and much more.

Our goal is to push the Teensy microcontroller to its limit. It is already doing a lot - playing FM Sounds, playing samples and sequencing them while you still can play live with 2 different FM sounds, an ePiano and 2 "virtual analog" Mono-Synths and external instruments on 16 USB MIDI and 16 classic MIDI channels.

Structure

The smallest building block in the sequencer is a pattern. Currently up to 24 different patterns can be used in a sequence.
It is completely up to you, when and how the patterns are played in the sequence. Of course every pattern can be put in multiple times inside a sequence. A pattern has the length of 16 steps.

Pattern

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 |

To create Phrases that are longer than 16 steps, the patterns are put in a Pattern Chain.
Each Pattern Chain can hold up to 16 patterns and these Chains can be inserted in the Song as a single Song Step - which can go up to 64 Song steps, per track. So the total length of your song can go up to 16384 steps.

Track Types

Since the sequencer can play notes, drum samples, chords and arpeggios, it is important to tell MicroDexed what type of content shall be played on which track. The track type of each track keeps the same, during the whole sequence.
Track types can be drum, inst, chord or arp. This assignment is controlled in the menu *Track Setup*

Content Type

While the track type is a setting regarding all chainsteps of a track, the content type is an assignment for every pattern.
Every pattern can be of different content types.

The content type mostly controls how you see your pattern content on the device. For example, if it is a drum pattern, instead of seeing midi-note-values, you see the names of the drum samples. For Chords, you see the chord name (for example in the arpeggiator view). Further, this controls many of the editing features and features that are displayed to you.

In many cases it is not critical to put in the content type for every pattern to get a sequence running correctly. But it is highly advised to do so - only then MicroDexed can understand what you are up to and help you in responding with the best menu options for editing and visualizing your patterns.

If this sounds a little strange, you have to understand that MicroDexed just "sees" MIDI Notes. To be more precise, it just sees a number between 0 and 127 :-) So setting the content type for the patterns helps MicroDexed to understand what your pattern is intended to do.

The content type is assigned in the menu *Seq.Disp.Style* (Sequencer display style).

Dexed/Instrument assign

In this menu you assign the 8 tracks to the two dexed-synth instances, the MDA ePiano or to microsynth. Notice that this setting is only valid for instrument tracks. Drum sounds will always play on the dexed-drum channel. The drum channel is set up in the *drum* menu and defaults to MIDI channel 10.

For chord and arp tracks, it is possible to override the setting in the *dexed assign* menu - or lets better say you can assign 2 different dexed-synth instances at the same time for them.

To give you an example:

Let's say you want to play a full chord with a piano sound and in addition a bass note with another instrument that is more bass-like. Internally stored, MicroDexed only has the root note of the chord, like data on every other track, as a single MIDI note. For chords, you have to assign the chord types for the chords. (more in chapter *chords*).

If you have this ready, you can tell MicroDexed to play the bass note on dexed-synth1 or 2 and also to play the chords - on an extra chord channel. All this, only using a single track of the sequencer.

Notice that the playing style of the chords can be tweaked. you can play the chords from 1 up to 7 notes at once and also shift by octaves and even in intervals, up and down.

Since V1.0, you can also choose from 10 different multi-samples in the dexed/instrument assignment. Above that, you can assign 16 MIDI channels from USB MIDI. And at last, there are 16 Channels of classic MIDI that can be assigned here.

Chords

In the current state, MicroDexed understands major, minor, seventh, augmented, diminished and major7 chords.
This can be extended, either directly in the source code of the firmware or in a future update as custom chords that can be stored on the SD-Card.

The available chords should cover the most common music styles but that opinion might change in the future :-)

Internally, the chords are stored nearly equal to the "normal" note information. Their chord type is stored per note, in replacement of their velocity. That is one of the reasons, why it is a good idea to set your chord pattern to the content type *chord*.

The chords can be edited while the sequencer is stopped and while it is running.

So you can experiment a lot while directly listening to the results. Editing of the Chord root notes and their chord type is happening in the *Velocity/Chord Editor* menu.

Chords (and Arpeggios) can be manipulated by multiple realtime controls in the *shift&transpose* and in the menu *Arpeggio*.
You can change the amount of notes that shall be played as a chord.
The default value is 3 - but you can increase and decrease it from 1-7 in the *Chord Track Keys* menu.

Arpeggios

Instead of playing chords, you can also configure a track to play arpeggios. The note/chord input is exactly the same as for chords.

So it is no problem to change the track type between these options.

In the *Arpeggio* you can modify various parameters in realtime and also stop/start the sequencer. So no need to change menus to do that.

The length parameter lets you choose between 1-9 steps for all arpeggio styles. In case of *up&down*, the arpeggio time is extended to 2x of the length. If you choose a length of 1 for the types *up* or *down*, this only plays the root note. In combination with an arpeggio speed of 1/8, usually this alone creates a simple bassline.

The arpeggio types are *up*, *down*, *up&down* and *random*, which of course is not completely random but plays random notes in the scale of the chord.

Further you can transpose all notes of the arpeggio in the *shift&transpose* menu. The shift can be made by full octaves or/and all possible chord fingering of the chord.

Drums

MicroDexed Sequencer does not only play instrument sounds out of the dexed-synth engine but also can play sampled mono sounds. Since storage memory is limited and the playback of samples from the SD-Card is not fast enough for multiple tracks, the list of samples is not endless. The library of samples is currently a work in progress. Nevertheless, it is possible to produce stunning drum patterns with MicroDexed.
You can assign as many tracks out of 8 for playing drum sounds and the notes can be recorded in real time with a MIDI device of your choice (including velocity), step per step in the editor or with the *fill* function, that inserts a bunch of notes at 1/4, 1/8 or 1/16 steps with one click.

You also can copy, swap and clear patterns inside the sequencer view with a few button clicks.
To further finalize your drum tracks, you can change the velocity values in the *velocity/chord* menu.

All copy and swap functions will always include the velocity values of the track.

Similar to the dexed-synths, you can modify volume, pan and reverb send for all drum samples. This happens in the *Drums* menu.

Drums can also be played live, externally, by setting the drums MIDI channel in the *Drums* menu. Changing the drum MIDI channel has no consequence for the sequencer - all drum sounds will be played automatically on the correct drum channel.

Sequencer Menu

After reading about all the possibilities and a lot of background information, let's talk about the sequencer menu.
The top row always shows options, the second row always shows the content of the currently active pattern.
If you have assigned the correct *content type* to the patterns, its displayed parameters will vary based on the content.

In the second row, you see either the names of MIDI notes or a short name of the drum sample, if it is a drum track.
In case of MIDI notes you will always see the root key and more details about the note in the first row.
A blank step is represented with a "-" at its place.

While the sequencer is running, you will see an "X" at the current step in the pattern.
If you move the cursor into the pattern with ENC_R, you will see an "x" at the currently selected step. If you press ENC_R there, it will insert the note/drum sound that is currently selected at your top left screen.

The menus/functions:

If the pattern is a drum pattern, at the top left you will see a browser with all available drum samples. If the pattern is an instrument pattern, you will see MIDI notes and so on.

After the last instrument note or sample, a list of functions will come up. The functions are:

1. EMPTY
2. ClrPat
3. ClrAll
4. Copy P
5. Swap P
6. Fill P

EMPTY selects an empty note. You can select that and then move with ENC-R quickly to the second display row to replace notes of your choice with nothing.

ClrPat clears the active (displayed) pattern completely.

ClrAll Beware, this clears all patterns of the sequencer, at once.

Copy P Copies a pattern to a destination pattern. The source pattern will be untouched.

Swap P Swaps the content of a pattern with another pattern

Fill P Fills the active pattern at 1/4, 1/8, 1/16 steps with a note or drum sample of your choice.

The second menu item in the sequencer is the Play, Record, Stop function. What is on display, is the next action that it is going to do.

The sequence is Play -> Record -> Stop, every time you click ENC-R. It will advance to the next step.

This is kind of self explaining. Note however, that the recording actually only will be active, while you are in the *sequencer* view. Also, while the *arpeggiator* has a Play-> Stop function, it does not have the record option on purpose because you do not see there, what is happening to your pattern if you would be able to record there.

So to record patterns live, the *sequencer* view has to be active on the display.

The next menu item to your top right is the active pattern selector. Here you can browse between all 10 patterns and it does not matter if this pattern is contained in your current sequence at all.

This means that currently you can only input notes in the pattern that you have on display. This is a good protection against messing up other patterns that you don't see - but also a small limitation if you like to fill up multiple patterns with data in a pattern chain during live recording.
Most certainly this will be changed in the future to be an option and mainly it is this way because of the limitation of the display to show only a small amount of data.

Step Sequencer

There is a new step sequencer. It can only be activated while your sequence is not running.
When you touch the step sequencer button, it will input your note and velocity from your attached MIDI device to the current step of the current pattern.
There is a lot of polish to do in this function. Currently it does detect the note pitch and velocity and if it is supposed to be a pitched sample, a drum sample or an instrument note. Other than that, when played, it will not fully respond with the correctly attached sound to it but will just play the currently selected instrument.
However it will play correctly what it is supposed to do, as soon as you start the sequencer.

To auto advance to the next step after putting in each note, there is an "Auto Advance" mode that can be activated in the pattern editor. By default, this is deactivated, so you will only overwrite the current step in the current pattern while playing around on your keyboard. When you activate it, it will advance to the next step, after every key input. When the last step is reached, it will continue on the first step of the same pattern and overwrite your note, if there is any. After that it continues to increment the pattern step until the pattern end is reached and then it starts from the beginning, again.

Velocity/Chord Editor

The Velocity/Chord Editor is very similar to the main *sequencer* view. Since you only have 2 Buttons and a 2x16 Char display in front of you, it made sense to put this into an extra menu.

On a drum or instrument pattern, you can change the velocity values of your notes. On a chord/arp pattern you can choose/modify the chord information, meaning which chord type should be associated with the note(s) of the current pattern.

The navigation is exactly the same as in the *sequencer* view. Instead of the information about the Instrument or Drum sound, you get their velocity values and can modify them. In chord view you can choose between major, minor, seventh, augmented, diminished and major7 chord types for every note.

These values are used for two kinds of tracks: chords and arpeggios.

Song Mode

To create Songs that are longer than 16 steps/1 pattern, the patterns will be put in a Pattern Chain.
Each Pattern Chain can hold up to 16 patterns and these Chains can be inserted in the Song as a single Song Step - which can go up to 64 Song steps, per track. So the total length of your song can go up to 16384 steps.

L.Transp.Key

This feature is kind of a work in progress. The idea behind it, is that you have a sequence, including chord or arp information and play it live while transposing the stored sequence on the lower part of the keyboard.
The octave that is doing this live transposition is selected in the menu *L.Transp.Key*
This transforms MicroDexed into an arranger keyboard or a tool for a live performance.

LOAD Performance

Using MicroDexed Sequencer, you will have a lot of things and ideas in your mind about how to progress with your patterns. In this creative process, the goal is to make things as easy as possible about loading and saving. The Sequencer will store as much about the machine state, including voices, voice settings, effects and drumsettings inside the storage of the sequencer. So when you have saved the Sequence previously, loading it back should return you to exactly the same state, as before.

SAVE Performance

When you save your sequence, MicroDexed sequencer will put you current voices, voice configs, effects and drum settings and store the current state of them as part of the sequence.
If you wish to save parts of it, like the effects+drum settings or a voicesetting as a separate file, to be able to recall them later for another project, you can do so in the default load/save voice config, load/save effects etc. menus.
Currently, saving the effects will also automatically include the settings for volume, pan and reverb-sends of the drum kit.

Delay Effects

The delay effect can be synced to the sequencer. If you already have synced your sequence tracks to a value like 1/16, 16t, 1/8, 1/8t. etc, tempo changes should automatically change the delay times, to fit the new tempo for this track.
If you have not done so, you can activate the delay sync in the effects -> delay - time menu, while the sequencer is running.
After saving the sequence, the correct value should be recalled automatically and follow any tempo changes.

Song Loop

Instead of playing your whole song, you can select a start and stop song step and create a loop between them. The starting step can be lower or higher than the stop step - MicroDexed will figure out what to do in either case.
You can edit the start and end steps with the X Cursor movement by scrolling below Track1 - it will then select the step column. Here you can scroll up and down to the start position, confirm with [BUTTON RIGHT], select the end Step and again confirm with [BUTTON RIGHT]. Either while already playing or starting playing, MicroDexed will now play only the Song Steps you have selected for your loop.
The Loop can be modified, while it is playing.

FAQ

MIDI CC for UI Control

20: // RIGHT
21: // LEFT
22: // UP
23: // DOWN
24: // SELECT
26: // BUTTON B
27: // BUTTON A

I have a "GEN1" MDT, can I upgrade ?

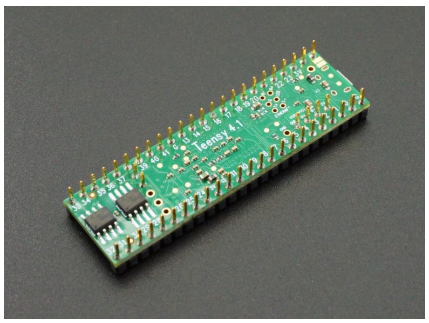
Can I modify it to the newer capacitive touch display?

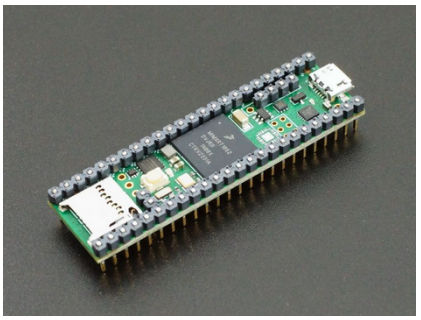
Yes, but it requires some manual soldering and cutting traces.
https://docs.google.com/document/d/19uz_f5Q-ubSz_sre03k6PxKubdhfkKNZsdVtecTyhIY/edit#heading=h.ap520dffq34k

It is not suggested to try that if you have no or only very little desoldering experience.

Can I buy a Teensy including PSRAM ?

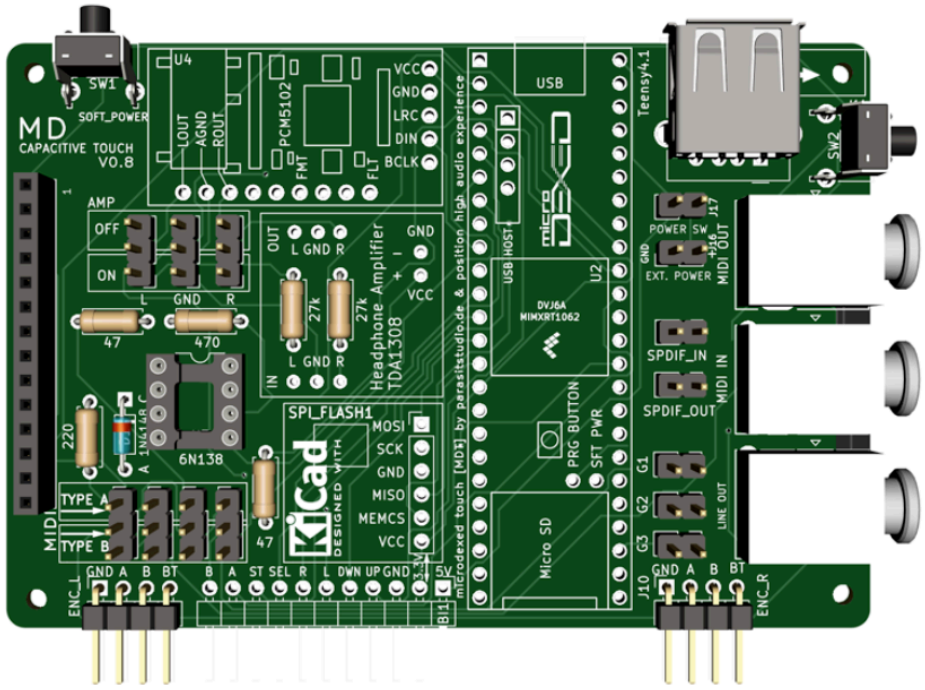
If you do not want to solder the Teensy pins by yourself, or the (optional) PSRAM chip, you now can order it from https://protosupplies.com/product/teensy-41-microdexed/ fully soldered and tested, specially for MDT. (with 8 or 16 MB PSRAM)





What do I receive when buying the PCB+assembly option at PCBWAY ?

What exactly i can expect to receive when ordering the partly build version from pcbway (pcb+assembly) ?



The preassembled parts should look like in the picture above. PCBWAY will not be able to supply all of the low-profile sockets, the teensy, the pcm5102 dac, the headphone amplifier, the opto coupler IC (but the socket for it) or the spi module. All these parts you have to order / get from your own sources.The Button-Interface Connector also is seen as an option and will not come preassembled. However that is a part that is very easy to solder since it has standard breadboard 2,54mm pin spacing and size.

included parts:

Item #	*Designator	*Qty	Manufacturer	*Mfg Part #	Description / Value	*Package/Footprint	Type	Your Instructions / Notes
1	R1, R2	2	Stackpole Electronics Inc	CF14JT47R0	RES 47 OHM ±5% 0.25W, 1/4W Axial	AXIAL	Through Hole	
2	R3	1	Stackpole Electronics Inc	CF14JT220R	RES 220 OHM ±5% 0.25W, 1/4W	AXIAL	Through Hole	
3	R4	1	Stackpole Electronics Inc	CF14JT470R	RES 470 OHM 5% 1/4W AXIAL	AXIAL	Through Hole	
4	R5, R6	2	Stackpole Electronics Inc	CF14JT27K0	RES 27K OHM 5% 1/4W AXIAL	AXIAL	Through Hole	
5	D1	1	SMC Diode Solutions	1N4148	1N4148 DIODE GEN PURP 75V 300MA	DO-204AH, DO-35, Axial	Through Hole	
6	U3	1	Preci-Dip	110-87-308-41-001101	CONN IC DIP SOCKET 8POS	DIP-8_W7.62mm	Through Hole	
7	J11	1	CUI Devices	UJ2-AH-4-TH	USB TYPE-A USB 2.0 Receptacle Connector	4POS	Through Hole	Right Angle
8	J9, J10	2	Molex	22124042	CONN HEADER 4POS 2.54MM	4POS	Through Hole	Right Angle
9	J12	1	TE Connectivity	1-534237-2	14 Position Receptacle Connector 2.54MM	14POS	Through Hole	
10	SW1, SW2	2	E-Switch	TL1105VF160Q	Tactile Switch SPST-NO Side Actuated	2POS	Through Hole	Right Angle
11	J1, J2, J3	3	Switchcraft Inc.	35RAPC4BH3	3.50MM – Headphone Phone Jack Stereo Conn.	3POS	Through Hole	Right Angle (TRS Mini Plug)
12	J4,J5,J6,J7, J13,J14,J15	7	Würth Elektronik	61300311121	CONN HEADER VERT 3POS 2.54MM	3POS	Through Hole	

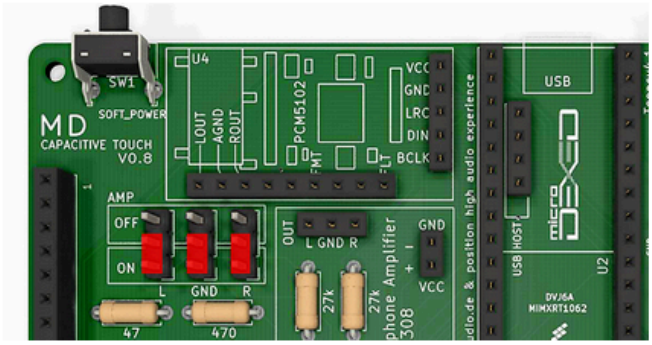
non-included parts:

13	U2	2	Mill-Max Manufacturing Corp.	310-43-124-41-001000	24 Position Receptacle Connector 2.54MM	24POS	Through Hole	low/ultra low profile
14	U2-C, U1-A	2	Mill-Max Manufacturing Corp.	315-43-102-41-003000	2 Position Receptacle Connector 2.54MM	2POS	Through Hole	low/ultra low profile
15	U1-B, U1-C	2	Mill-Max Manufacturing Corp.	315-43-103-41-001000	3 Position Receptacle Connector 2.54MM	3POS	Through Hole	low/ultra low profile
16	U4-B	1	Mill-Max Manufacturing Corp.	310-11-105-41-001000	5 Position Receptacle Connector 2.54MM	5POS	Through Hole	low/ultra low profile
17	SPI_FLASH1	1	Mill-Max Manufacturing Corp.	315-47-106-41-004000	6 Position Receptacle Connector 2.54MM	6POS	Through Hole	low/ultra low profile
18	U4-A	1	Mill-Max Manufacturing Corp.	310-11-108-41-001000	8 Position Receptacle Connector 2.54MM	8POS	Through Hole	low/ultra low profile

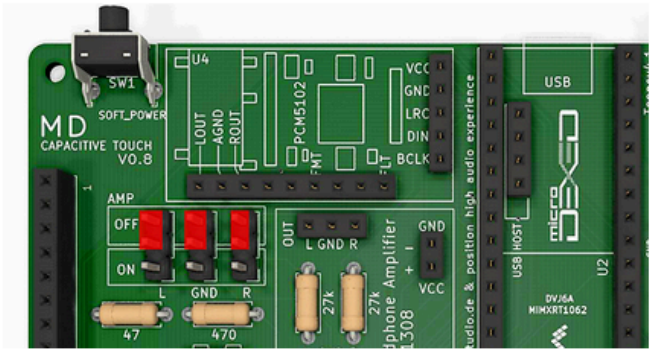
Also the MIDI opto-coupler IC is not included but the socket for it should be preassembled.

MDT jumper settings for Phones Amplifier and MIDI

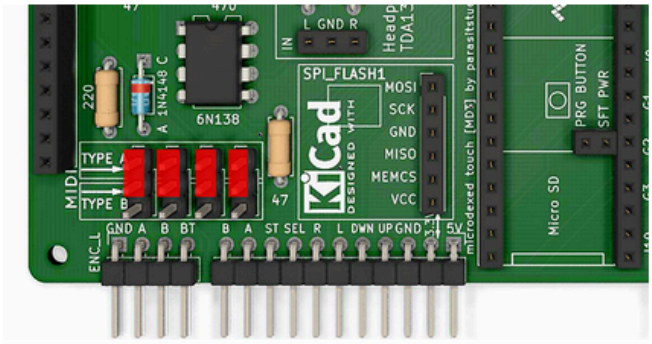
MIDI and AUDIO AMP Jumpers (MDT Capacitive Touch)



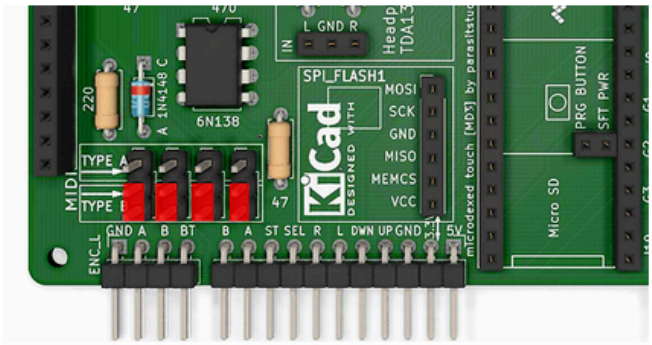
If you have added the optional Headphone Amplifier, set the 3 AMP Jumpers to the ON position.



If you have not added the optional Headphone Amplifier, or want to bypass it, set the 3 AMP Jumpers to the OFF position.

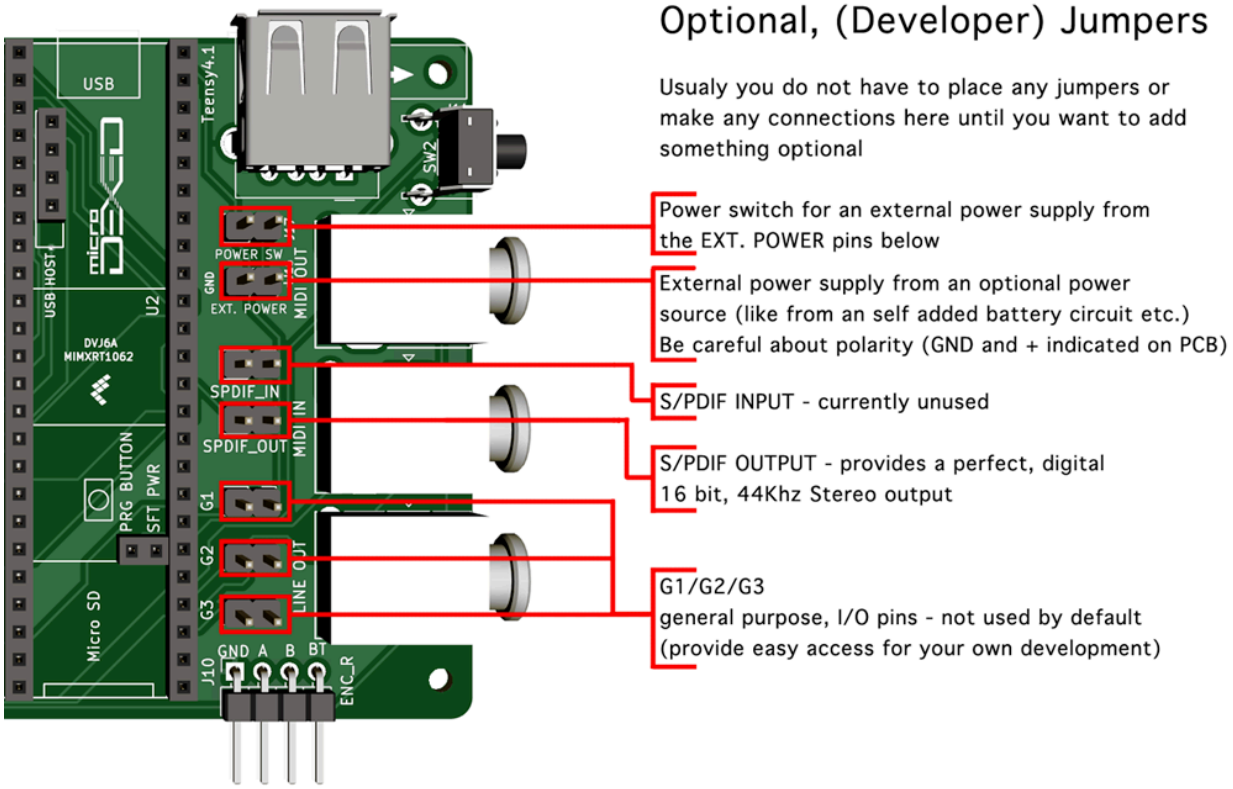


If you want to use TRS JACK TYPE A MIDI devices on Input and Output, place jumpers to the A position.



If you want to use TRS JACK TYPE B MIDI devices on Input and Output, place jumpers to the B position.

What are the connectors/pins on the right side of MDT PCB ?

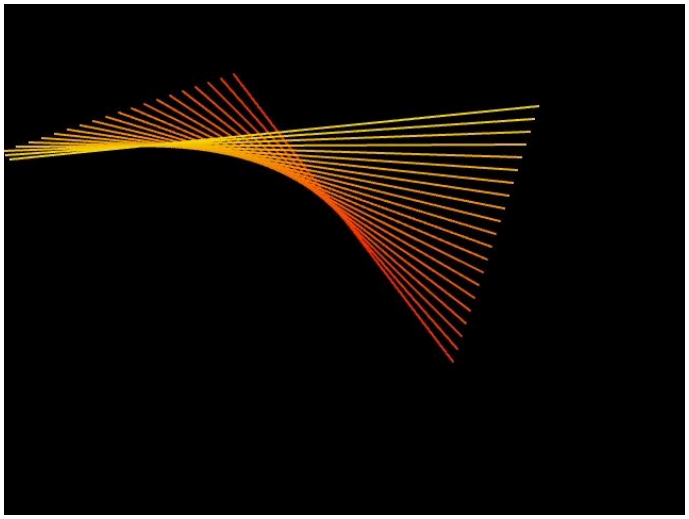


What is it about all the Screensavers ?

It started with only one but then expanded quickly since we love to put all the extra effort into MDT to make you smile. (As long as it does not lead to any compromises for the actual audio functionality).

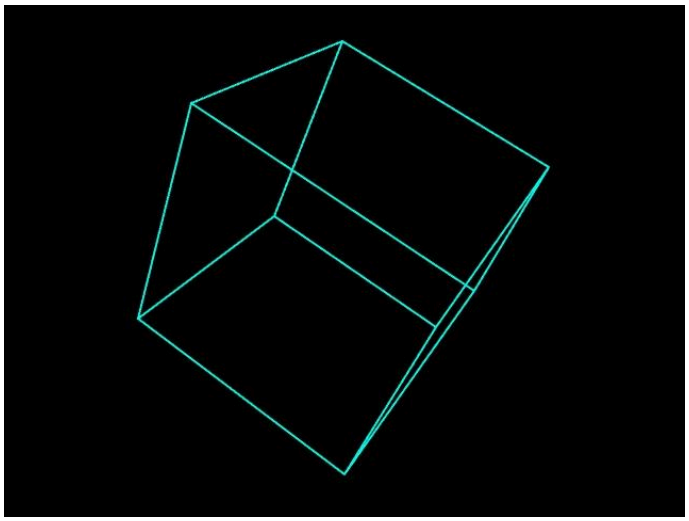
QIX

This is inspired by an early arcade game called QIX. In the game, the colored line is the enemy you have to defend yourself from.



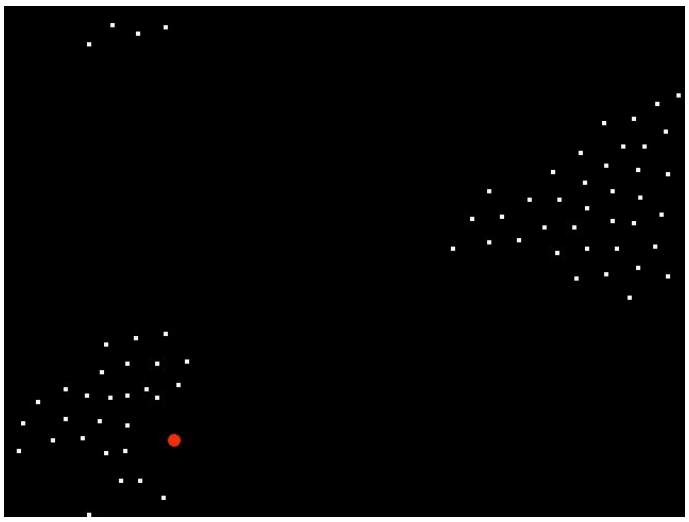
3D Cube

Just what it says, a spinning 3D cube.



Swarm

A flock swarm, escaping a predator



3D Terrain

MDT logo (classic) with 3D terrain

MDT logo (current) with 3D terrain

User Scenarios

Welcome to MicroDexed-touch, short form MDT.

This guide should be a help to completely new users. It will not go into much detail. This is mainly intended to get you started.

Who are you ?

We assume that there are very different user types and very different usage scenarios, these are the types we currently can mainly think of:

- you want something to play live, a FM Synth, Samples or other Synthesis (User A)
- you want a multi timbral MIDI expander, you are mainly a PC-DAW User (User B)
- you are a "dawless user" and want to use MDT as an external MIDI device to integrate in your setup with another sequencer, then you are also (User B)
- you want a studio or hobby tool to create demo sequences or demo songs, with an all-in-one box (and maybe expand to external devices later) (User C)

USER A

You can use a USB MIDI or "classic" MIDI Keyboard.

Attach your MIDI device to the USB HOST port or to the MIDI IN port.

MDT has USB and mini "TRS" jacks as MIDI Input.

There are 8 jumpers on the PCB where you can select between a TRS-TYPE A and TRS-TYPE-B device. This depends on the manufacturer of your device:

TRS-A:

Korg (Electribe 2, SQ1, NTS-1)
Akai Pro (MPC Studio, MPC Touch, MPX8)
Boss (RC-5/500)
Critter & Guitari (Organelle M)
Dreadbox (Lil' Erebus)
IK Multimedia (bei iRig Pro, iRig Pro DUO allerdings mit 2,5 mm)
Line 6
littleBits (MIDI Module)
Make Noise (0-Coast)
Retro Kits RK-006
Teenage Engineering (OP-Z oplab)
Twisted Electrons

TRS-B:

Arturia (BeatStep Pro)
Novation (Circuit, Circuit Mono Station, Launchpad Pro — bei neueren Geräten aber TRS-A)
Polyend (Poly 2, Tracker)
Pittsburgh Modular (Liveforms SV-1)

Depending on what you want to play live, you set your MIDI OUT channel on your MIDI device and/or the corresponding MIDI Channel on MDT.

All MDT Sound Sources/Instruments can have their own MIDI Channel and can play at the same time.
Dexed has 2 engines with 16 voices each, each have their own MIDI Channel or you can stack them to 1 Channel if you want to do that.

If you want to play Microsynth, MDA ePiano, Braids etc, set their MIDI Channel on their own page, matching the MIDI Channel of your Keyboard/MIDI Device.

Microsynth is a Mono Synth with 2 Instances and each also has its own MIDI channel. Braids has one instance and can play polyphonic with up to 8 voices on one MIDI channel (shared with other sample playing voices).

The MDA ePiano has 16 voices and has also its own assignable MIDI Channel.

Make sure that no other instrument that you do not want to play is playing on the same MIDI Channel by accident.

In the "System" Menu - "MIDI channels" you can see all MIDI Assignments at once.

Check on each instrument (Dexed, Epiano, MSP, Microsynth, Braids) if you have set the MIDI channel to identical MIDI channels, or OMNI, which means to react to all Channels at once. Usually you want to react to each instrument on its own channel.

USER B

This is easy. You can see MDT as a multi-timbral device with several sound sources.

First we have two instances of Dexed, both of them have their own MIDI channel.

Set the MIDI channel in the Dexed Voice screen (or in the deeper menus) to some channels you currently have free, each on its own channel, select the bank and the sound in the Dexed screen and you should have 2 FM synths, each with 6 OPS and 16 voices.

You can switch between the two instances either by touch on the display or by navigating to the top of the screen and selecting the current instance you would like to edit/customize.

The other instruments like Microsynth, ePiano, Braids etc. also have their own MIDI Channel. You can set their MIDI channel in their corresponding page.

Make sure that no other Instrument, you do not want to play, is playing on the same MIDI Channel by accident.

USER C

The first advice is to look into: https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/wiki/Sequencer

More (hopefully helpful) instructions:

The Sequencer uses MIDI / MIDI channels in combination with Track assignments for the internal playback. Currently, there are some issues when multiple Instruments are set to the same MIDI channel, especially when they are set to OMNI, meaning they are supposed to play on EVERY MIDI channel. So it is a good idea to check the assignment of MIDI channels.

In the "System" Menu - "MIDI channels" you can see all MIDI Assignments at once and also can change them, at a central place. While the sequencer is running, in this page you also see the activity on each instrument. So it is easy to find where a sound is coming from.

What the sequencer does on top of MIDI, is assign a fixed instrument to a sequencer track.

What can be assigned, as output, is:

- Dexed Instance 1
- Dexed Instance 2
- Microsynth Instance 1
- Microsynth Instance 2
- ePiano
- Braids
- MSP, preset 1-10
- TSR MIDI 1-16 or omni
- USB MIDI 1-16 or omni

Depending on the track type that you assign to the sequencer track, it will behave differently. It can play drum samples, pitched drum samples, single notes, arpeggios (depending on the arpeggio settings something like up/down/random/euclidean) or chords with up to 12 voices, etc.

When using a USB Gamepad, the Sequencer workflow is trying to replicate much of the behavior of LSDJ on the gameboy. There are quick-jump-shortcuts between song-chain and pattern view etc.

Value Input/Change, however, is currently not identical to that method of LSDJ. Instead of holding a modifier Key while changing the value, you press a Button to enter edit mode, change the value and then press the same Button again to exit the edit mode. The Button is usually [A] or Encoder[R], if you use the default encoder interface.

DEXED Settings

The following instructions are taken over in a slightly modified form, from MicroDexed generation 1 and are still valid and useful:

Using MicroDexed

After turning MDT on, you are usually in the voice/bank selection. (You can select another startup page, in the system Menu.) To enter the menu, short press **ENC_L**. You can return to the voice/bank selection of the dexed voice by holding down **ENC_R**. If you turn the **ENC_L**, the volume screen appears and you can see which value is set. After a few seconds the system automatically returns to the previous screen.

To select items in the menu, turn the **ENC_R**. You can select a menu item or jump to a submenu by short pressing **ENC_R**.

If you want to leave a parameter edit or go up one level in the menu, short press **ENC_L**.

In many dexed pages and sub-menus, a small icon with an inverted 1 and 2 will appear - To switch between the two engines and change their parameters, simply long press **ENC_R**.

Sound/Bank selection

The most important Dexed screen will be the sound selection (voice select). The screen displays the selected bank number (top left) and the selected voice number (below). Next to the numbers are the corresponding preset names. The active parameter (marked with square brackets) can be changed by turning **ENC_R**.

MDT can manage 100 banks (0-99) and 32 voices per bank. Above that, MDT has 100 POOLS for banks. This makes a total of 320000 voices in total available.

If you turn **ENC_R** farther than the 32nd voice of a bank, the first voice of the next bank will be loaded automatically, except if you already reached the last bank (bank 99). This happens the same way if you try to go lower than voice number 1.

In System Menu, you can activate a filter for the displayed voices and mark your most used as a favorite. You can set the filter to show only your favorites, all voices, only non-favorites and several other options.

To switch between the 2 dexed instances/engines, you can either navigate to the top in voice select and change it there, or just long-press **ENC_R**.

Next to the bank name is the symbol for the active engine.

If one or several MIDI note events are detected, a note symbol is displayed below the corresponding instance as long as this note is active.

When the voice is changed, MDT sends a voice dump in the background via MIDI SYSEX on its selected MIDI channel. This has the advantage that external devices (like a voice editor on a PC) synchronize the data directly.

To enter the menus, short press **ENC_L**

Voice Menu

The Voice menu is the most comprehensive menu. Here all functions related to sound generation are available in submenus.

Audio Menu

The audio submenu contains all functions that can lead to audible changes in any form.

Voice Level

By changing (and later saving) this value you can compensate for differences in volume between different sounds. The value ranges from 0 to 127. Default is 100, but you can make the sound louder by increasing the value.

Panorama

The voice's position in the stereo image can be adjusted here (MIDI-CC 10).

Effects

MDT comes with some effects. Basically, each MDT instance has its own resonant low-pass filter, (mono) Chorus and a separate (mono) delay (500 ms for mono-timbral / 250ms for bi-timbral). This is followed by the position in the stereo image (see panorama) and a stereo reverb.

(Mono-)Chorus

This simple chorus is generated by mixing the original signal and a pitch-modulated copy. The effect is only audible when frequency, depth and level are all somehow greater than 0.

Parameters:

- Frequency (0-10 Hz)
- Waveform (Triangle/Sine)
- Depth (0-100)
- Level (0-100)

(Mono-)Delay

The delay has a feedback loop and can be mixed into the original signal by means of level. Therefore time and level must be greater than 0.

Parameters:

- Time: (0-500ms for *mono-timbral* or 0-250 for *dual-timbral* (on Teensy-3.6))
- Feedback (0-100)
- Level (0-100)

  Dedicated MIDI controller numbers:

  - Time: MIDI-CC 105
  - Feedback: MIDI-CC 106
  - Level: MIDI-CC 107

(Stereo) Reverb (Master effect)

Parameters:

- Room Size (0-100)
- Damping (0-100)
- Level (0-100)
- Reverb Send (0-100)

Dedicated MIDI controller numbers:

- Level: MIDI-CC 91

EQ (Master effect)

The EQ is only active when using a Teensy audio shield (or SGTL5000 chip). It serves as a simple adjustment of the sound image.

Parameters:

- Bass (0-100)
- Treble (0-100)

Controller

The controller section is responsible for the settings of the different MIDI controllers.

Note on Controllers:

How it works inside MDT:

Pitch and amplitude modulations are set inside the voice presets by two parameters : *PMD* (*P*itch *M*odulation *D*epth) and *AMD* (*A*mplitude *M*odulation *D*epth)

These settings cannot be edited using MD's interface (but can be edited via MIDI-SYSEX).

Pitch modulation:

The LFO, internal to MDT, will affect all operators in the same way. Its frequency (or rate) and depth are common to all operators.

Depending on the LFO's waveform, the effect will sound like a faint vibrato or a large wobble (sine or triangle), a trill (square), a series of random pitches (sample and hold), to name a few.

Amplitude modulation:

The LFO, internal to MD, will affect all operators independently: Rate will be common, but modulation depth can be set differently on each operator.

If the operator is a carrier, the LFO will affect the general volume of the preset. A sine wave LFO applied to a carrier operator will result in some kind of tremolo effect.

If the operator is a modulator, the LFO will affect the harmonic content of the preset. A sine wave LFO applied to a modulator operator can, in most cases, be compared to an automatic Wah-Wah effect. A sample and hold LFO applied to a modulator operator will result in a series of notes with random brightness.

MDT's controller menu

Even if pitch and amplitude modulations are already set inside the Dexed preset, it is still possible to add modulation using external controllers.

Controllers are physical or virtual devices, external to MD, which will have an effect on some parameters via MIDI-CC messages.

On MDT, sources are : Pitch Bend, Modulation, Breath Controller, Foot Pedal, Aftertouch.

Destinations are: pitch modulation by internal LFO, amplitude modulation by internal LFO, EG Bias.

On a physical synth or master keyboard, pitch bend is usually controlled by a wheel or one axis of a joystick, modulation by a second wheel, or the second axis of the joystick, a breath controller by an external pressure sensor, and foot pedal is obvious.

But in fact, if this is a common setting, other combinations can occur, depending on the keyboard/controller and of the musician's choice.

Controller MIDI messages can as well be produced by virtual controllers as DAWs, virtual keyboards or MIDI command software.

The devices named in this manual refer to the MIDI message, no matter what kind of controller device produces them.

MDT will not produce any MIDI CC messages, but will define their destination, their operating mode, and their intensity.

Pitchbend

The pitch of a note can be raised or lowered using the Pitch Bend control, which is usually a dedicated wheel or joystick on a master keyboard. The range can be set up to one octave in both directions (up/down). *Range* setting defines the highest possible variation: from one semitone to a full octave. *Steps* define if the control is continuous (step = 0) or uses discrete values (steps) of 1, 2 ... 12 semitones.

Parameters:

- Range (0-12)
- Step (0-12)

Other controllers (Modulation-Wheel/Aftertouch/Foot-Controller/Breath-Controller)

Other MIDI controllers all have the same modification possibilities. The output of modulation can affect different destinations: PITCH (pitch envelope), AMP (loudness envelope), EG (see note below). It is possible to specify targets or any combination of targets. In order to hear an effect, the voice preset must be configured accordingly.

Note on controllers:

External controllers such as Mod Wheel, Foot Pedal, etc, will send MIDI messages to MDT, from 0 to 127.

- The *Assign* parameter will define the destination of this modulation.
- The *Range* parameter will define a divider, reducing this operating range to fit the user's needs (*Range* can be seen as a percentage value).
- The *Mode* parameter will define the behavior of the controller's output, or how MDT will react to the controller's messages.

In *Linear* mode, the modulation applied to the chosen destination will vary from 0 to the value defined by *Range*. Output can be considered as:

MIDI CC value * (*Range*/100) (not inverted)

In *Reverse* mode, the MIDI CC value is subtracted to its maximum. The output will vary from 127 to (127-*Range*), and thus will be inverted, compared to its input. Output can be considered as:

127 - (MIDI CC value * (*Range*/100))

In *Direct* mode, the modulation applied to the chosen destination will vary from (127-*Range*) to 127, without being inverted. Output can be considered as:

127 - ((*Range*/100)*127) + (MIDI CC value * (*Range*/100))

Linear will be preferred for Pitch or Amp modulations (no modulation when MIDI CC's value is null, maximum modulation set by the *Range* parameter).

Direct mode will be preferred when modulation is applied to EG bias: MIDI CC value of 127 (maximum) will leave the sound unaltered, while lower values will reduce the volume or brightness of the preset, down to a value defined by *Range*.

Reverse mode will be used for example when one controller is applied to two different MDT units (or two instances of a bitimbral MD), set to the same MIDI channel, to modify the level balance of those two engines. If one of the MDs is set

to Direct and the other to Reversed, it will then be possible to control the balance of those two engines, for example by turning the Mod Wheel or by pressing the Foot Pedal, allowing some kind of sound morphing.

Parameters:

- Range (0-99)
- Assign (PITCH/AMP/EG or any combination)
- Mode (LINEAR/REVERSE-LINEAR/DIRECT)

Dedicated MIDI controller numbers:

- Modulation wheel: MIDI-CC 1
- Foot controller: MIDI-CC 4
- Breath controller: MIDI-CC 2

Note on target EG:

Each of the 6 operators has similar settings, no matter if it is a carrier or a modulator.

Among those settings are an envelope generator and an output level.

Output level could as well be called "Gain" and can be compared to a mixer entry fader (in case of a carrier) or a modulation index (in case of a modulator).

EG stands for EG bias, and could as well be called EG depth. It could be compared to the filter's EG depth on an analog synthesizer.

When a controller is routed to EG (aka EG Bias), the *Range* value will define how much the controller will affect each operator's envelope depth.

Depending on a parameter which is internal to the sound engine's preset, this will have a different effect and in many cases no effect at all.

On MD, this internal parameter is called *AMD* (for *A*mplitude *M*odulation *D*epth) and the controller routed to EG will only have an effect on the operators when their individual *AMD* is set to a value greater than 0.

If those operators are carriers, the controller routed to EG will control the overall volume of the sound.

If those operators are modulators, the controller routed to EG will affect the modulation indexes, which have an effect on the harmonic content of the sound (the higher the modulator's level, the richer the harmonics, leading to a brighter sound).

If carriers and modulators have an *AMD* setting with a value greater than 0, then the controller routed to EG will affect, at the same time, volume and brightness of the sound.

If no operator has an *AMD* setting greater than 0, then the controller will have no effect.

In short: If, inside the preset, *AMD* is set to 0 for all operators, then the controller will have no effect.

> **Note on changing *AMD*:** You can easily change all voice parameters by using an external MIDI-SYSEX editor (see Appendix).

MIDI

In this menu everything concerning MIDI control is set.

MIDI Channel

This parameter sets the MIDI receive channel. MDT will react to messages coming from this channel. A channel between 1 and 16 can be selected. Alternatively *OMNI* can be selected if data should be received from all MIDI channels.

Parameters:

- MIDI-Channel (OMNI/1-16)

Lowest/Highest note

You can also restrict the range of MIDI-notes to which MDT should react. This allows split and/or dual configurations with the *dual-timbral* engine.

Parameters:

- Lowest Note (A0-C8)
- Highest Note (A0-C8)

Note on ranges: You have to check by yourself if the note ranges you entered make sense. If you set *Lowest Note* to C6 and *Highest Note* to C4 you won't hear anything!

Send voice

The currently configured voice can be sent via MIDI SYSEX, for example to edit it in an external editor or use it on another MD.

1. Choose the bank.
2. After choosing, push the preset encoder.
3. Choose the voice to send.
4. After choosing, push the preset encoder and the data will be sent via MIDI.

Note on sending voice data: The voice data is sent on the current MIDI channel. If the MIDI channel is *OMNI* the data will be sent on Channel 1.

Setup

The setup menu contains all other parameters that control this voice.

Portamento

Portamento allows the pitch to slide continuously from one note to the next one.

Parameters:

- Mode (FINGERED/FULL)
- Glissando (ON/OFF)
- Time (0-99)

Dedicated MIDI controller numbers:

- Portamento On-Off: MIDI-CC 65

Note on portamento:

Each musical instrument has a specific way to produce notes. Some have frets, keys, pistons and will produce discrete notes inside a scale. In european temperament, those notes are usually a chromatic scale (C, C#, D, D#, ...).

On these instruments it is very hard or even impossible to produce a note between those of a scale. The pitch will then abruptly switch from one note to another, it will only vary by steps, and no intermediate pitch will be produced.

On other instruments, such as violin or trombone, the pitch of the note can vary continuously, depending on the exact position of the finger on a string, or the length or the air column inside the pipe: This allows the pitch to slide continuously from one note to the next one. This is known as portamento. Depending on the instrumentalist technique, this slide can be fast or slow. On MD, this speed is defined by the *Time* parameter. Higher values for portamento rate will produce a fast slide while lower values will result in a slower slide.

In monophonic settings, you can choose between a constant (*Full*) portamento (all notes are concerned) or a *Fingered* portamento, which will only happen while you keep the initial key pressed when playing a new key (legato).

Glissando is different in that instead of producing a continuous slide between the pitches of the subsequent notes, it will play all the notes of the scale which are between those 2 notes, like a pianist gliding his finger on the keyboard, or a guitarist on his fretted guitar neck. A glide between C3 and E3 will play subsequently C3, C#3, D3, D#3, E3, when a portamento would result in a continuous rising of the pitch, from C3 to E3.

Polyphony

You can reduce the maximum number of voices played simultaneously if necessary. If you hear glitches or gaps in sound maybe reducing the polyphony by one can help to avoid these problems.

Parameters:

- Polyphony (0-20, see note below)

Hint for *Polyphony*: Maximum polyphony depends on the Teensy used and the clock speed set at compile time. Setting the polyphony to 0 means that no sound will be produced. In *Monophonic* mode you need at least a polyphony of 2.

Transpose / Fine-tune

With these parameters you can adjust the pitch. By means of *Transpose*, this is done in semitone steps (+/- 24 semitones) and by *Fine-Tune*, in +/- 99 cents.

Parameters:

- Transpose (-24 - 24)
- Fine-Tune (-99 - 99)

Mono-/Polyphonic

MDT can be set to a monophonic mode. In this mode, envelopes are not restarted when playing legato. In combination with *portamento* this can lead to nice sounding effects.

Parameters:

- Mono/Poly (MONOPHONIC/POLYPHONIC)

Important note on *Mono/Poly*: Please do not confuse this parameter with *Polyphony*! *Mono/Poly* limits the polyphony only indirectly by using only two of all available internal sound generators. If *Polyphony* is set to one, it is still different from playing with *MONOPHONIC* mode enabled. Furthermore, a polyphony of at least two is required for *MONOPHONIC* mode!

Internal

In the internal menu there are several basic items.

Note Refresh

With *Note Refresh* you can influence the behavior when playing the same note.

For example: If you play a G5, press and hold the sustain pedal and play the same note again, another one of the available tone generators will be set to play the note. So the note sounds double and its envelope would also run out separately for both notes (with a corresponding time delay). This would, however, limit the maximum available notes, since the same note sounds multiple times.

With *RETRIGGERED*, the envelope of the same note is started again and more remaining tone generators are available for other notes.

You should try out this setting and decide yourself which variant is more to your liking.

Parameters:

- Note Refresh (NORMAL/RETRIGGERED)

Velocity Level

Presets which have been programmed on some editors, like DEXED for example, may benefit from setting Velocity Level to 127. Other presets coming from other sources or editors might sound better with Velocity Level set to 100. If you have a hard to play keyboard or just want everything to sound "louder" or "more brilliant" and you don't like to press the keys so hard, you can set a higher value here.

Parameters:

- Velocity Level (100-127)

Engine

The original Dexed offers three different routines for generating sound, all of which sound a little different. These three engines can also be found in MDT and you can try out which one sounds best in your opinion. *Mark 1* is modeled after an original FM synth (with respect to the calculation), *Modern* is more modern and more accurate and *OPL* is the attempt to recalculate the sound generation like it was done on OPL chips back then.

Parameters:

- Engine (MODERN/MARK 1/OPL)

Save voice

Use this entry to store the current voice inside a bank on the SD card.

1. Choose the bank.
2. After choosing, push **ENC_R**.
3. Choose the slot where to store the voice.
4. After choosing, push the preset encoder.
5. Want to overwrite the selected bank/voice? If yes, turn the preset encoder to choose **YES**.
6. If you are really sure, push the **ENC_R** and the voice is stored.

You can always abort the process by pressing **ENC_L**

Voice config

Voice configurations store all data beyond the sound data itself that is necessary for playing. Voice configs should not be confused with the voice data (inside a bank) that describes the sound. All data that are not stored in the voice data are stored in a voice config:

- MIDI channel
- MIDI lowest note
- MIDI highest note
- Transpose
- Tune
- Internal level
- Panorama
- Polyphony
- Velocity level
- Engine Type
- Mono/Poly
- Note refresh mode
- Pitchbend:
    - Range
    - Step
- Modulation wheel

    - Range
    - Assign
    - Mode
- Foot controller
    - Range
    - Assign
    - Mode
- Breath Controller
    - Range
    - Assign
    - Mode
- Portamento
    - Mode
    - Glissando
    - Time
- Operator status

Effects

Effect configurations save all settings for the effects and are independent of voice configurations or the voices themselves. The following parameters are stored:

- Filter cutoff
- Filter resonance
- Chorus
    - Frequency
    - Waveform
    - Depth
    - Level
- Delay
    - Time
    - Feedback
    - Level
- Reverb
    - Send
    - Room Size
    - Damping
    - Level
- Equalizer
    - Bass
    - Treble

MIDI

The following menu items allow data exchange via MIDI-SYSEX with editors/ librarians or a second MDT.

MIDI Recv Bank

A bank consists of 32 voices. These can be sent in a block to MD. Before you can send them, you have to select a bank slot and maybe you would like to edit the name of the bank on MD's side.

1. Choose the bank slot.
2. After choosing, push **ENC_R**.
3. Think about overwriting the selected bank/voice? If it is ok, turn the preset encoder to choose **YES**.
4. If you are really sure, push the **ENC_R**.
5. Now you can choose to edit the name of the new bank. The blinking cursor is located on the first character (on the left) and can be moved with the preset encoder in this example to the position of character the "4").
6. At the position where the letter is to be changed, **ENC_R** must be pressed to switch to *edit mode*.
7. After you press the preset encoder, you are in *edit mode*. This is indicated by an asterisk at the end of the field.
8. Now you can turn **ENC_R** up/down to choose the character you need.
9. With pressing the preset encoder you leave the edit mode (the asterisk disappears).

10. Now you can go back to step 5 and edit the other characters like the first one, or you can go one position after the last character to leave the edit screen. An OK prompt will appear on the right.
11. Push the **ENC_R** to wait for the data to receive.
12. Now you can send the bank data from the remote device. After the transfer is succesful, the data will be stored - not before!

You can always abort the process by pressing **ENC_L** (back):

MIDI Snd Bank

You can also send a complete bank of 32 voices via MIDI-SYSEX.

1. Choose the bank slot.
2. After choosing, push **ENC_R**.

The bank will be sent immediately.

> **Hint for sending banks via MIDI:** The bank is sent on the configured MIDI channel. If OMNI is configured, then MIDI channel 1 is used for sending.

MIDI Snd Voice

This is where you can send one voice via MIDI-SYSEX.

1. Choose the bank slot.
2. After choosing, push **ENC_R**.
3. Choose the voice slot.
4. After choosing, push the preset encoder.

The voice will be sent immediately.

> **Hint for sending banks via MIDI:** The voice is sent on the configured MIDI channel. If OMNI is configured, then MIDI channel 1 is used for sending.

System

Everything that belongs to the basic settings and is probably rarely changed can be found in this menu.

Stereo/Mono

MDT can be operated both in stereo and mono. In addition, the mono signal can also be output on both channels or only on one channel.

Parameters:

- Stereo/Mono (STEREO/MONO/MONO-R/MONO-L)

MIDI Soft THRU

It is possible to output all incoming MIDI data via the existing interfaces.

For example, if data arrives via MIDI-MINI JACK it will be output on USB-HOST-MIDI and USB-MIDI (without filtering).

MIDI Soft THRU is also a MIDI merger. When two controllers are plugged into MD, one in the MIDI MINI JACK input, and one on the USB socket, the MIDI messages are merged and sent back to the MIDI DIN output.

> **Hint on MIDI Soft THRU:** This also works when MIDI data is sent that MDT does not process. So you have a simple MIDI media converter (USB-MIDI <-> DIN/MINIJACK-MIDI).

Parameters:

- MIDI Soft THRU (ON/OFF)

Info

The Info menu states some information about the software version and the SD card.

Tips and tricks

The sound generation is (msfa) from the free VST-plugin Dexed. So you can use Dexed as MIDI SYSEX editor or you can use sounds programmed with Dexed on MDT. For the original Dexed/msfa software take a look at Dexed on Github and Music Synthesizer for Android on Github.

Editing voice presets

As mentioned before: you can use external editor software for MIDI SYSEX editing of MDT voice presets. Here is a collection of freely available editors:

- https://www.thisdx7cartdoesnotexist.com/
  - not really an editor but a system which generates a bank of voice presets with a KI behind. The names of the voice presets are mostly not readable at the time of writing, but the sounds were not bad.
- https://dx7.vstforx.de/
  - an online editor inside the browser, tested with Google Chrome or Chromium.
- https://synthmata.com/volca-fm/
  - also an online editor which was written for Volca-FM but also works for Dexed/MDT.

Another way of editing voice presets is to use an editor like Edisyn. For download and install instructions read the manual at https://github.com/eclab/edisyn.

MIDI-Controllers

MIDI-CC#	Target
0	Bank-Select MSB (currently unused)
1	Modulation wheel
2	Breath controller
4	Foot controller
5	Portamento time
7	Volume
10	Panorama (0-62 = left, 63-64 = middle, 65-127 = right)
32	Bank-Select LSB
64	Sustain (0 to 63 = Off, 64 to 127 = On)
65	Portamento (0 to 63 = Off, 64 to 127 = On)
91	Reverb send
93	Chorus level
94	Tune
103	Filter resonance
104	Filter cutoff
105	Delay time
106	Delay feedback
107	Delay volume
120	MIDI panic
121	Reset controllers
123	All notes off
126	Monophonic mode (0 = Polyphonic, >0 = On)
127	Polyphonic mode (0 = Mono, >0 = On)

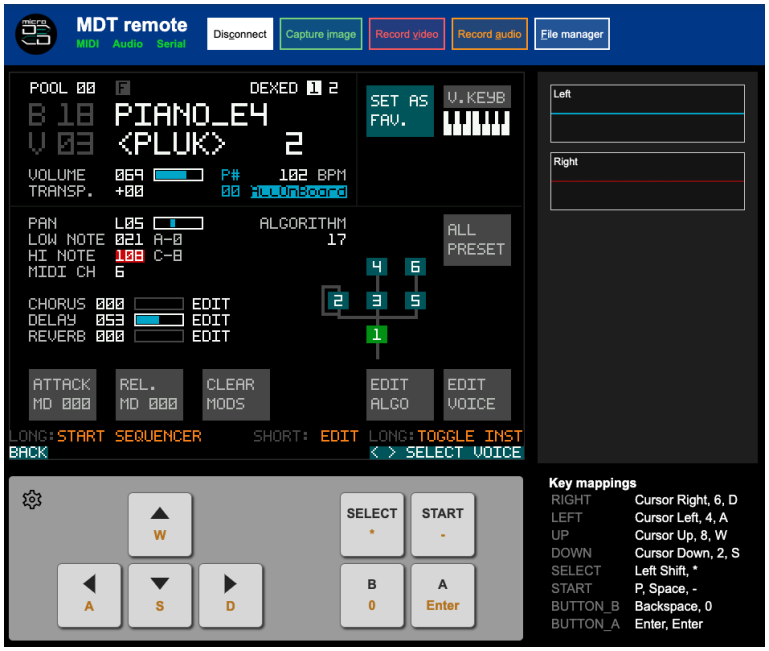
Hint on bank and voice selection: If you want to select a new voice preset, you can send a program change command.

To change the bank there are two MIDI CCs (0 and 32), where MIDI CC 0 is currently not used.

So to select a new voice preset you either have to send a program change command (then the bank is not changed) or change with MIDI-CC 32 the bank number followed by a program change for the voice preset number.

Web Remote Console

MDT can be remotely controlled/used on your Desktop PC, with a Web Browser.



To use the web remote:

Plug MDT (Teensy) Micro USB into your computer

Click or go to link:

https://positionhigh.codeberg.page/

To use Web Remote **offline**, locally or on your **own Web Server**:

Install and run Chrome 127 or later.

Click or go to link:

https://simplewebserver.org/download

Download Simple Web Server Portable appropriate for your CPU and OS

Click or go to link: https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/pages

Click the three dots to the upper right and download as a **.zip**

Extract the downloaded archive

Goto directory of Simple Web Server Portable that was downloaded

Click or double-click simple-web-server (executable)

Click New Server

Select folder icon and select the folder (**pages**) **inside the folder that was unzipped**

Press Create server

Click on the started server just created, Click on the Web server URL/highlighted (blue) link

Accept changing midi device if it pops up look for icon in the upper left, Click connect button

In the popup window, select the serial port for MD and click OK button

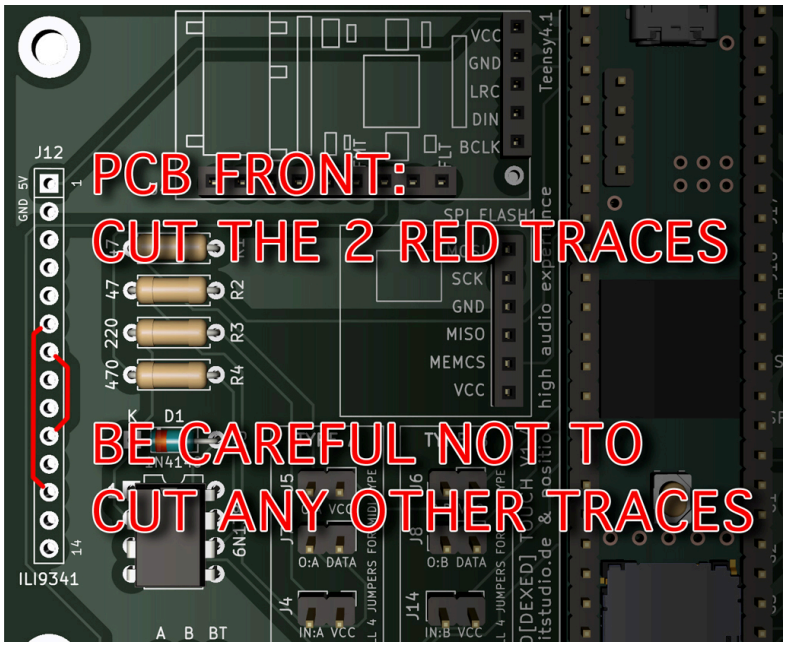
Accept mic permission if it pops up for USB Audio

Display Conversion from resistive to capacitive touch

This short guide shows how to convert your PCB from first gen, resistive touch to capacitive Touch display.

CUT all traces/connections shown in RED color. ADD connections shown in GREEN with wires.

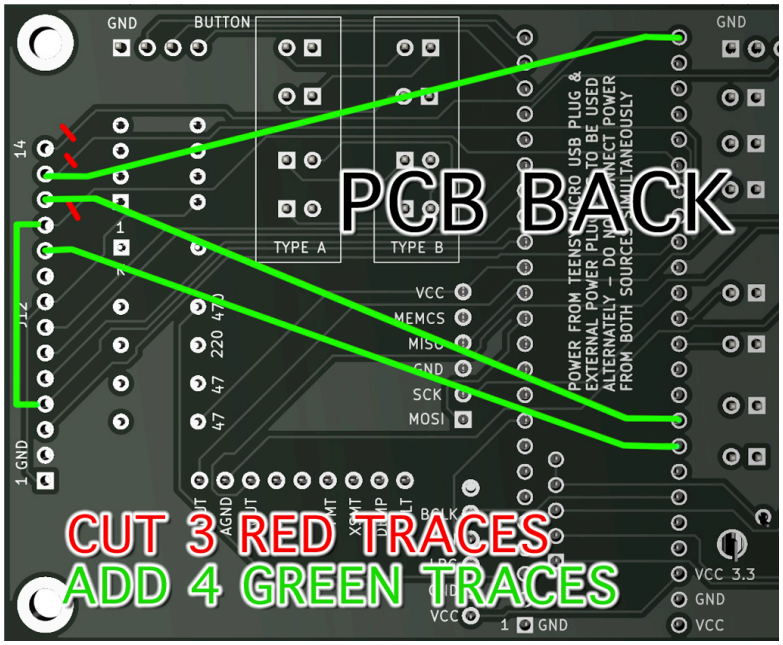
PCB FRONT



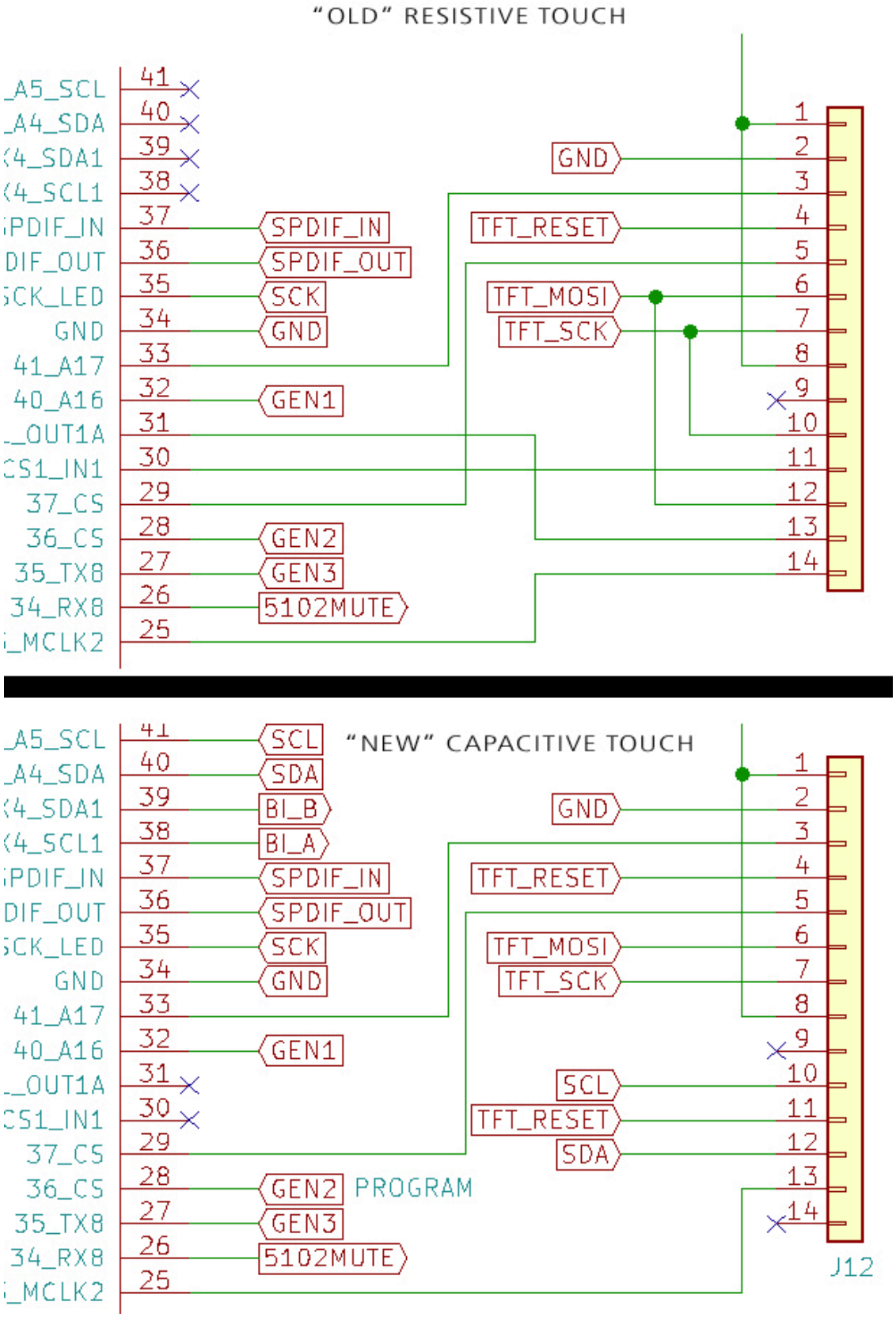
Unfortunately it is required to remove the display connector to reach these 2 traces.

Use your favorite proven method, how to remove the connector. This could be hot air, a desoldering tool/gun or desoldering wick.

PCB BACK

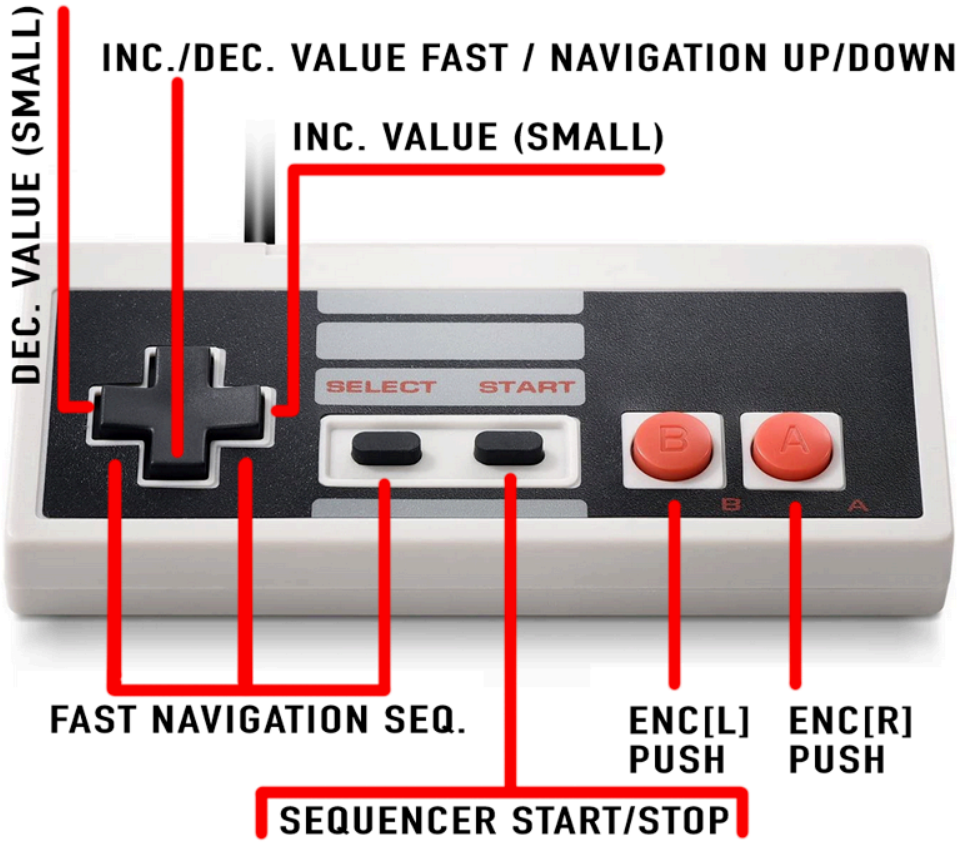


CONVERSION SCHEMATICS



Wiring of old and new display connector

USB GAMEPAD (NES STYLE) for UI Input



20/07/2024:

- When using the button interface (or a USB NES Controller on the HOST port) you now can change master volume by pressing and holding SELECT and UP / DOWN Keys at the same time. This will work in almost all pages and the main menu that has no special functions for quick navigation already assigned for the sequencer. The volume control will speed up with time according to the setting in SYSTEM - SYSTEM SETTINGS - GAMEPAD/NATIVE KEY SPEED.

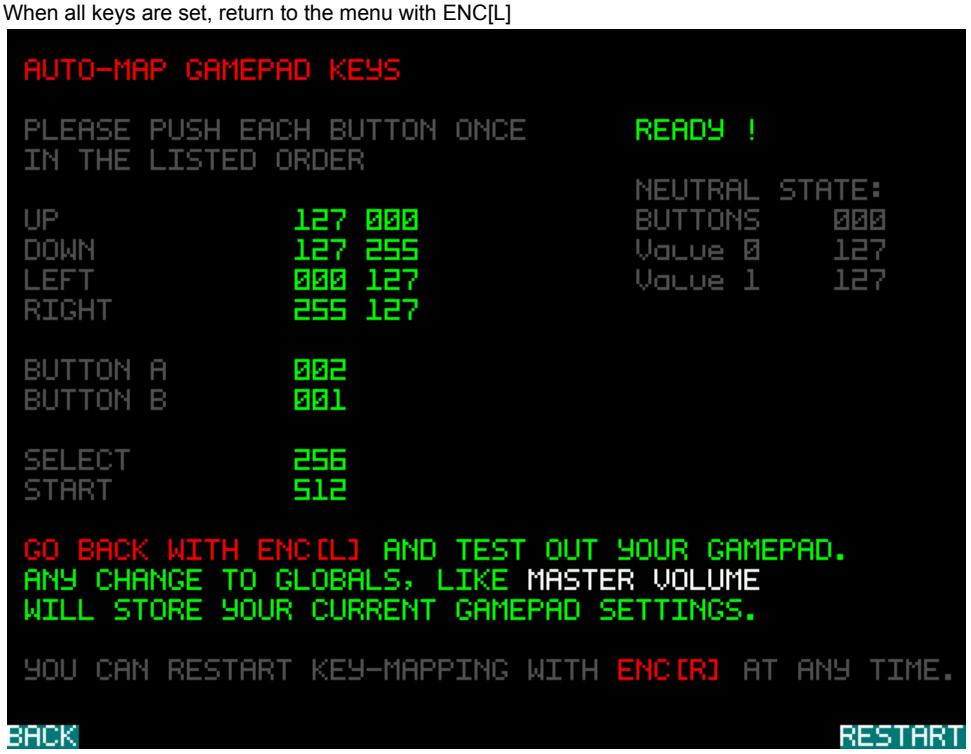
If your gamepad is not working by default (it should), then you can try to map your keys to the following instructions. Important: The gamepad MUST be connected at MDT boot. Otherwise it can not detect the key inputs, compared to the neutral position.

Go to SYSTEM:

GOTO AUTOMAP GAMEPAD :

Follow instructions.
Press each of the Gamepad keys shortly, the list should advance to the next key :

When all keys are set, return to the menu with ENC[L]



Known problems/bugs:

- while in edit more, value inc./dec. is reversed in some menus
- some menus that use x/y movement of the cursor, are not working correctly, yet.

MDT Firmware Guide

MDT Firmware is installable on your Teensy Microcontroller in two ways. You can either compile the source code by yourself or use a "binary distribution" that is readily made for you. If you do not know what this means, please go for the "binary" way to get going. The binary files you will find in your downloaded file you got from the page:

https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/releases

in the folder **release**

STEP 1 : What display type do I have ?

If you have your MDT earlier than Autumn 2023, you most probably have a touch screen of type **RESISTIVE**. These display usualy come with an attached PCB in RED color. **RESISTIVE** touch is not really state of the art. You can use it with finger tip pushes but it requires some physical force to do so, it is common to use this type of display with a plastic pen "touch pen" to give you more precise input.

If you have MDT newer than Autumn/Winter 2023, you probably have a PCB and a Display made for **CAPACITIVE** touch. If you have an older MDT-PCB, but a newer, capacitive display, it is possible to convert it to some of the features of the newer MDT-PCB. This requires some manual soldering and cutting off traces of the PCB. It is not very complicated to do so, but if you are not up to that task, it is suggested to get the more current PCB from PCBWAY.

The **CAPACITIVE** display usually comes with an attached PCB in **BLACK** color. And on the backside it usually states in text that it is a capacitive display.

Now you should have some knowledge what type of display you currently have.

STEP 2: What are all these files/versions in folder RELEASE, which i shall install ?

Following on from STEP 1, if you do have a **CAPACITIVE** Display, only go for firmware files having the word **capacitive** in the filename. Otherwise, only go for files that DO NOT have **capacitive** in the filename.

STEP 3: DEFAULT, FLASHMEM or PSRAM ?

If you do have a PSRAM CHIP (or two) soldered to your Teensy, go for a FIRMWARE starting with PSRAM in the filename. This currently is the best possible option with most features and highest stability. It is the only stable option to work with loadable custom samples during runtime.

If you do have a SPI Flash Chip - that is located left to the Teensy on the MDT-PCB, go for a file having **FLASHMEM** in the filename. If you do **NOT** have a SPI Flash Chip, meaning you have only the Teensy and the Audio/DAC Board, go for a file with **default** in the filename. All the **DEFAULT** Firmware files use **PROGMEM** . This is a storage chip that is included on every Teensy 4.1. However the drawback of **PROGMEM** is that it is a read-only Memory during runtime, its content can only be changed by uploading a Firmware File to the Teensy from your PC, it can not be changed while MDT is running and you are playing with it.

STEP 4: You should be done

You now should be able to pick the correct filename/firmware. Ignore all other, obscure looking filenames. These are versions for some specific features - If you want to use them you probably know what to look for. Otherwise please go with the 3 steps above.

STEP 5: Optional - I want to know - What are these other files ?

Just a short description of what the other versions might have to offer:

- PSRAM: Using this assumes you have a PSRAM chip soldered to the backside of your Teensy. This chip extends the free available RAM (Memory) of the Teensy. It is a bit slower than the included RAM but still faster than everything other beyond that. Currently this allows to have much longer Audio DELAY times (Having several minutes of DELAY TIME instead of 500 Milliseconds)
- BUTTON-INTERFACE: This is an optional build where you have DIY push buttons/switches soldered to your device or attached them via the BI (Button Interface) Connector, available on the more recent MDT PCB Versions. This allows navigating the system with buttons instead of the push-encoders or as an addition to them. There are also a few button-shortcut

navigation controls available, for jumping through several sequencer related pages more quickly.

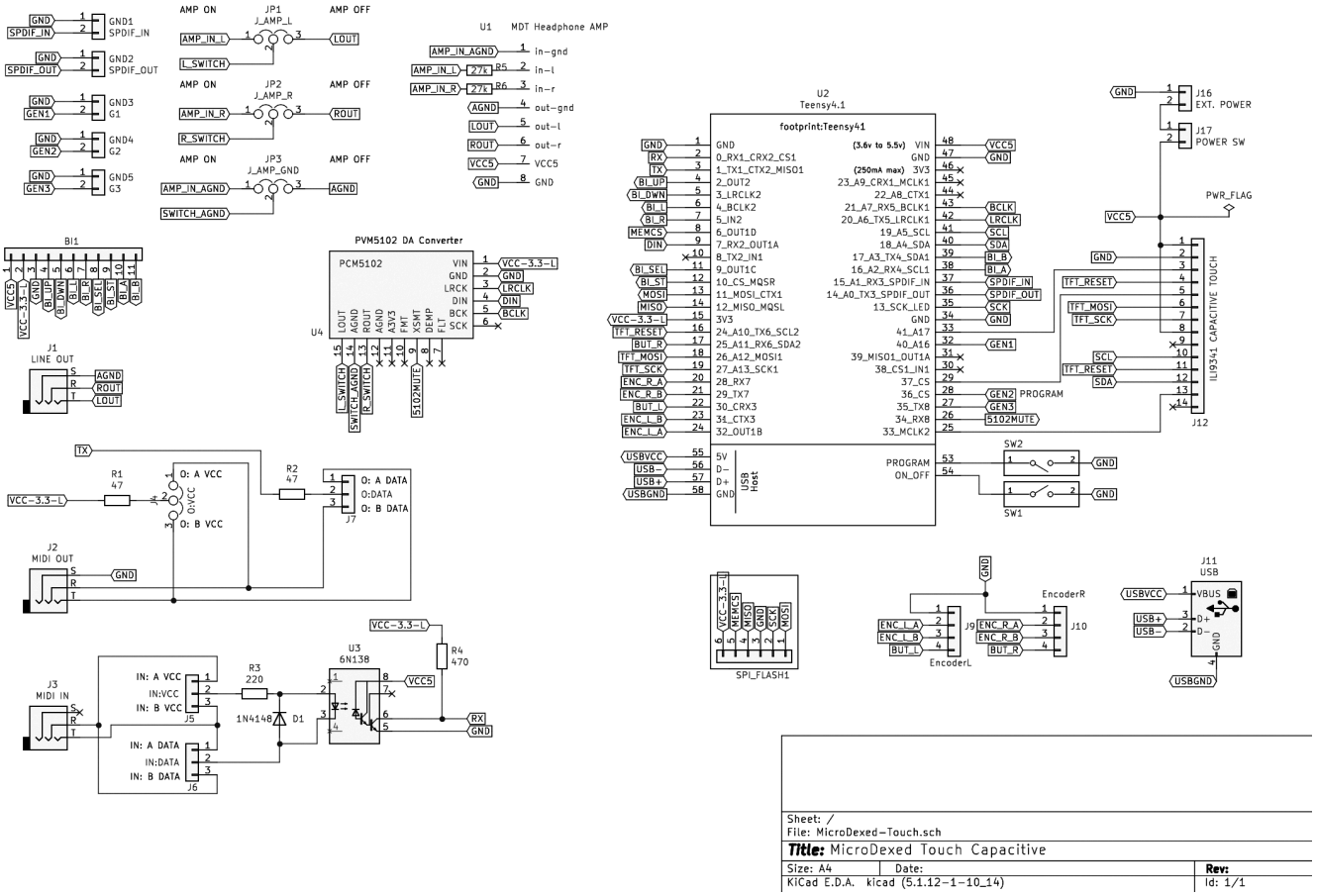
- GAME PAD AND PC KEYPAD: These two options once were both their own build version but are now included in every build of MDT by default. Both allow similar, alternative input methods like Button Interface above. However they are externally attached via the USB HOST Connector of MDT.

  GAME PAD is for a "Nintendo" style gamepad, connected via USB. These controllers are available from platforms like Amazon and others and are aimed at users looking for a PC Joystick/Gamepad.

  These devices usually follow the same pin/numbering/input style and can be attached to MDT and used like an alternative, cursor based user interface. The same is valid for PC KEYPAD. These are similar to the GAME PAD but aimed at users looking for a numeric-keypad to enter numbers more quickly into their PC or Notebook. They usually come in a 4x4 key matrix and vary in style and function. As long as they replicate a usual PC Numpad, they should work with MDT by default.

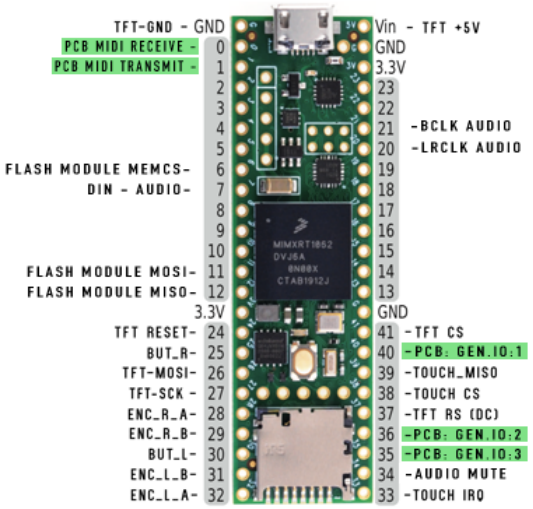
MDT Schematics

Schematics (for current capacitive touch):

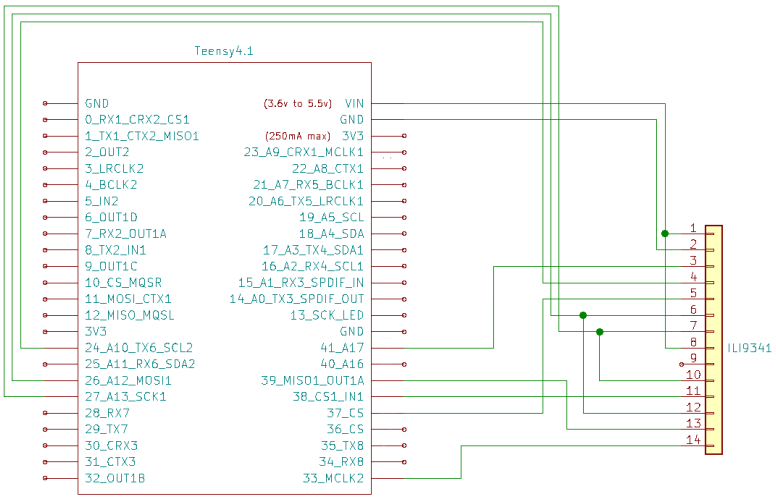


Depreciated Information for previous version with resistive touchscreen

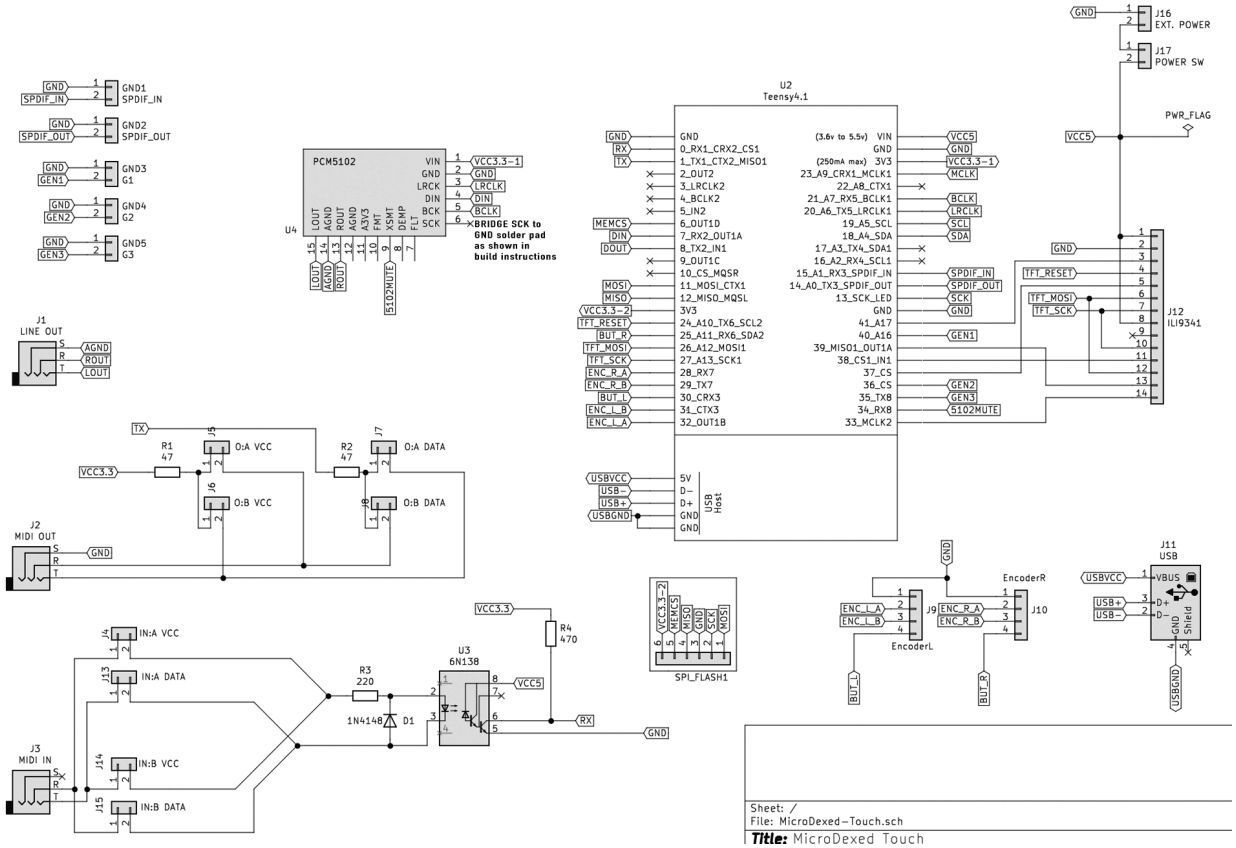
PIN LAYOUT (depreciated)



DISPLAY WIRING (depreciated)



COMPLETE WIRING (gen1, depreciated)



Alternative Pins and Sockets

If you are unable to get all suggested parts from the BOM, specially the BKL low height sockets, this chapter should help and guide you to get MDT working with alternative parts.
The 3.5 mm high E-Simpo sockets from Aliexpress, combined with the 9.5 or 10.5 mm male pin headers can work together if planned carefully.

The amount of insertion of the contact pin into the socket is less than the BKL sockets, the difference will add that much to the overall height of the stack. It is here that the reader is reminded that not only do millimeters matter, but even tenths and hundredths of a millimeter can add up!

A word of caution, these sockets grip so tight that a builder could damage their teensy (or perhaps other modules) when removing them! Go slow, and move along the edge of the module going back and forth in opposite directions to incrementally lift it straight up. If a person only pulls up against the ends, the fiberboard PCB could be permanently bent in the middle. And the force is great enough to bend over sockets and pins if at a sharp enough angle while removing or inserting. The sockets do allow for removing modules later as needed, but this should be considered at a minimum.

Reporting Bugs

MDT has errors as there is no error-free software - at least I don't know any. If you find a bug in the program, please open an issue at https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/issues. Please remember to make the error description as accurate as possible and include as much information as possible and possibly MIDI files in the report.

Feature Requests

Feature requests can currently also be made via https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/issues . Please mark the title as **Feature-Request**.

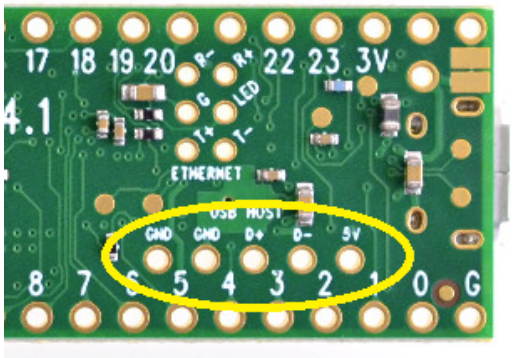
Troubleshooting Guide & FAQ

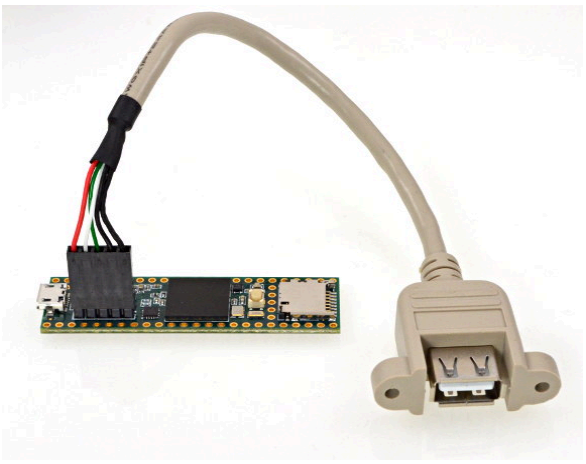
DIY USB MIDI HOST

If you are not using the MDT-PCB/Case (and just have a bare teensy) and want to attach MIDI Devices to the HOST port:

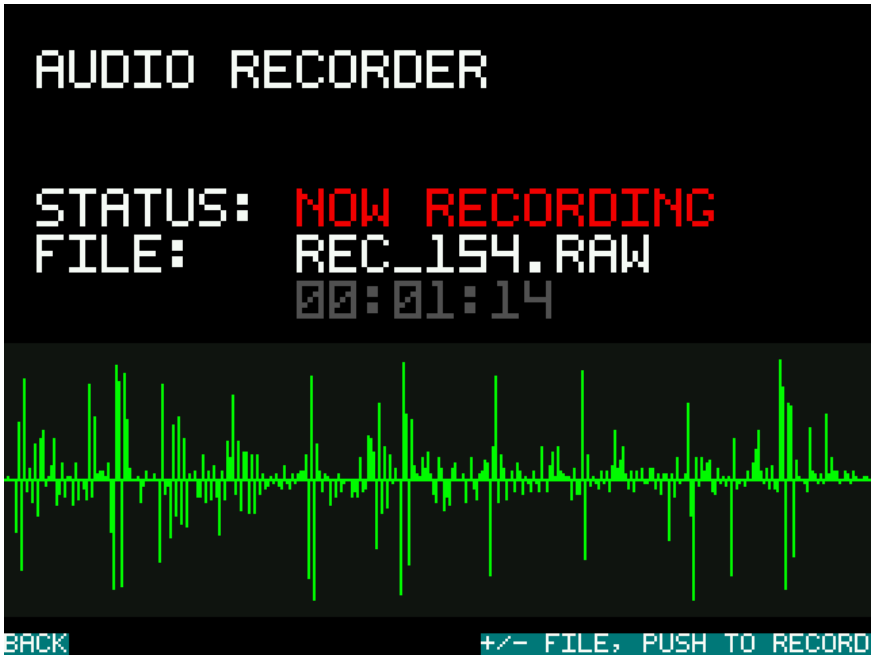
Connect your USB MIDI Keyboard/Controller here (or buy the cable from pjrc.com)

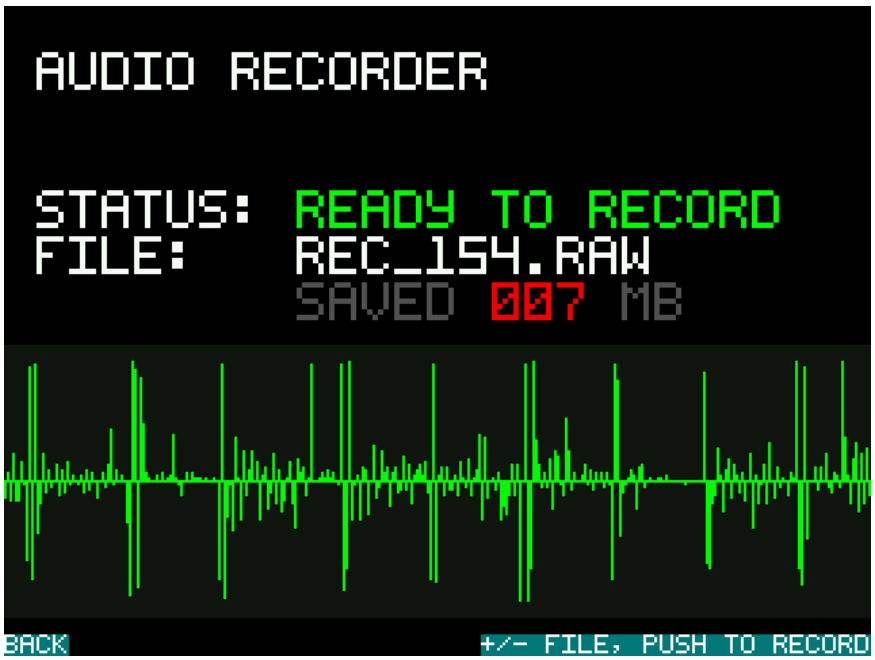
https://www.pjrc.com/store/cable_usb_host_t36.html





How do I use the exported raw audio files from MicroDexed on my PC ?





The files are stereo-raw, without a WAV header. You can load them in Audacity (or the Wave Editor of your choice) by:

File -> import -> raw ->

Troubleshooting

Microdexed-touch is a complex system. For every problem, there could be several reasons, when not working as intended. This Wiki page should be the First stop to find solutions to a problem.

Every tip here is a step for troubleshooting. If your problem is fixed after doing anything from here, make sure you revert all the changes after because it will have (more or less) negative impact to the overall performance of your device.

I have random crashes at startup

If you have unusual crashes when playing from external USB MIDI Devices, check if your power supply is sufficient. A Power Adaptor / USB Power Bank with 1A is enough, however a standard USB2 PC Port with only 500mA might not work stable with additional, external devices connected to Microdexed.

MDT is not compiling

Build settings must match:

- Board "Teensy 4.1"
- Optimize: "Smallest Code" (fixes "program exceeds memory space")
- USB Type: "Serial + MIDI + Audio" (fixes lots of errors like "'audio_block_t' does not name a type")
- If you still get strange compile issues even after following the above, please try to rename the project folder from MicroDexed-touch to MicroDexed-touch

MDT is not starting/booting - i see nothing on the screen

This can have many reasons. Lets start with the basics:

- remove your SD Card

If this helps then something about the SD Card is wrong, either it is not formatted FAT32 or something is wrong with the files or directories. Format your card as FAT32 and copy all content from addon/SD to your card. Then try again with the card inserted..

If nothing is going on the screen, check what is going on with the microDexed Web Remote Console.

I have installed flash chip module - how can i test if it is working

From the Teensyduino example code library, load and compile

SerialFlash -> RawHardwareTest

Watch the output on the serial monitor.

If everything looks fine, now reflash Microdexed-Touch.

In the menu System -> Format flash, format you Flash Chip.

This should take 30-90 seconds, depending on your flash size.

There should be dots going on showing the progress.

When that is finished, make sure you have copied the stock samples from addon/SD/DRUMS to your SD Card to a folder DRUMS.

Go to FileManager and touch the button "Copy Presets" and push Encoder R. You should see a progress bar for every file that is copied to the Flash Chip.

After that, all samples should be visible on the right side in the Filemanager (maybe you have to go back, then enter Filemanager again)

Touch the screen on the right half in the area where the files from Flash are visible. Now you should see a border around that. With Encoder R you can scroll through the Samples.

They now should be visible in MultiSamplePlayer and you can select them for multi sample Instruments.

I have issues compiling the code

- Make sure you have added all libraries from the third-party directory to your teensy/arduino Library folder
- have you installed a recent version of Arduino and Teensyduino ? At point of this writing the versions are:

Arduino	Teensyduino
1.8.16	1.56

When this still does not solve compile issues, check if you have older versions from the used libraries in your Library folder present. Delete/move them elsewhere.

All Libraries are in place but i still have problems compiling

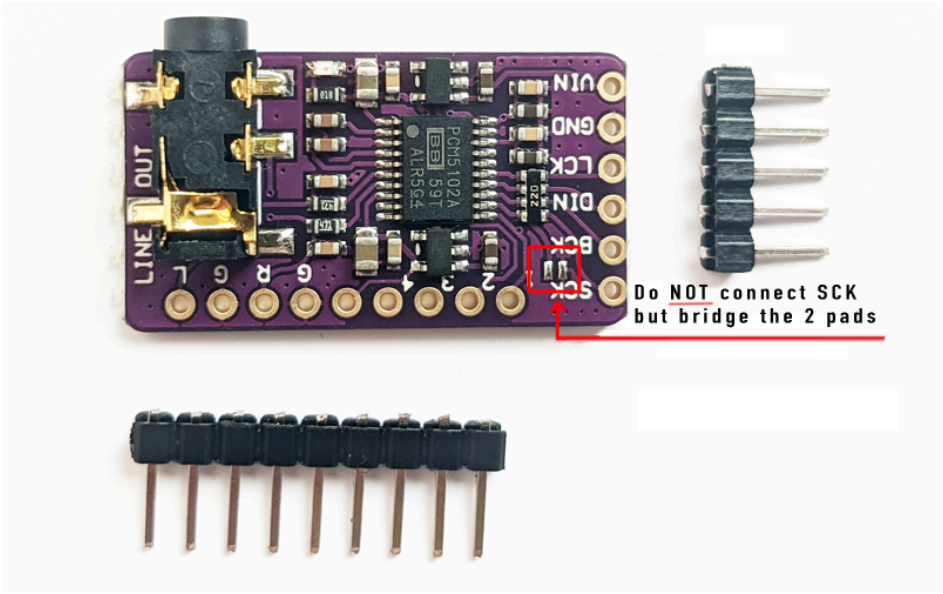
- Open MicroDexed-touch.ino with Teensyduino
- Set Tools -> Optimize to "smallest code"
- Set USB Type to "Serial + MIDI + Audio"
- Compile and Upload to your Teensy 4.1

My touchscreen input is inverted / reversed in one or both directions?

You can rotate the screen and the touch input in System - System Settings. The manual code changes from the past should not be necessary any more.

I think audio is playing but i do not hear anything?

- If you are using the PCB with PCM5102, check that the mute-pin XSMT is soldered.
- Check if SCK is bridged to GND on the PCM5102 board with these 2 solder pads:



- If you are not using the PCB, check if your wiring to the PCM5102 can be done with shorter cables. Too long wires, or uneven length of the wires to the PCM5102 or the Teensy Audio Adaptor will introduce audio issues or no audio at all.
- If audio is not working at all, check what is going on with the microDexed Web Remote Console. It should output audio via USB AUDIO.

User Chat groups

https://discord.gg/XCYk5P8GzF

https://matrix.to/#/#microdexed:matrix.org

Join our community and say hi, there is a good chance we can help if you have questions. Please be aware that MicroDexed is an open source hobbyist project. When you have a code/bug issue, you can also open a question on:

https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/issues

Feature matrix

Feature	Status	Notes
Pattern Editor	92%	This is the basic editor for note/velocity/sample selection, chord and arp assignments for the sequencer. A pattern is always 16 Steps long that can be chained up to 16 steps into a Chain step. In Song Mode, you assign a chain step (of up to 16 patterns), to a single song step.
Song Mode	90%	This is the most overall/birds eye view of your performance. Here you assign Chain steps to the song and also can edit the Chains with their pattern content. Every Chain step can transpose all of its assigned pattern, separately. This way, you only need a single bass or chord pattern for every chord type - and can transpose it in the Chain steps, according to your song structure.
MicroSynth	92%	MicroSynth is a mono synth with basic waveforms and PWM and has 2 instances that can be used simultaneously, with different sound and MIDI settings.
Virtual Keyboard	90%	Virtual Keyboard is currently available in dexed voice select, microsynth and pattern editor
ePiano GUI	98%	
General UI Merge	92%	This covers all necessary menu changes needed since Microdexed Gen1 and the first, outdated display for MicroDexed-touch
Main Mixer View	90%	View and edit volumes of dexed, Microsynth, Drums/Samples, Reverb and Master Volume in one screen.
Step/Grid Editor	80%	
Mute Matrix	80%	This mode is intended to be used mainly for "live" usage. Via touchscreen, tracks can be enabled and disabled in real time.
Piano Roll Editor	80%	

MultiSample Player	85%	Play multi-sample instruments live or by sequencer from PSRAM
SysEx/MIDI Controls	75%	
File Manager (SD/Flash)	65%	File Manager is supposed to copy/swap/delete Samples from SD Card to PSRAM so that the sounds can be changed during runtime.
Tracker view/edit	35%	
Custom/User Samples	90%	Samples from progmem are static and can not change while runtime. So for custom samples, external flash chip must be used
Track recording to files	65%	Export/render Tracks and complete songs as RAW/WAV audio files, directly to the SD Card.
Sample Editor	15%	
cv clock/sync	0%	
MIDI Clock / Sync	70%	Since 06/2024 MDT can run in MIDI Master and MIDI Slave mode, triggered by MIDI Clock
Livesequencer	80%	Livesequencer is an alternative Sequencer for live recording and performing - it runs parallel to the previous sequencer so both can be used at the same time. It is easier to use and delivers very quick and intuitive results
Livesequencer Editor, List-View, Graphical View	70%	

Changelog

30/08/2024:

- release 1.8.4
- both sequencers are now fully in sync
- small fixes

28/08/2024:

- count in for recording in LIVESEQUENCER by having REC already activated before pressing START
- bug fixes and code optimizations
- tested 16MB PSRAM chip

27/08/2024:

- release 1.8.3
- live sequencer now supports 12 instead of 6 tracks. use ENC_R rotation to switch screens
- support deselecting an active value by pressing ENC_R
- moved track quantize and velocity settings to track setup in TOOL SEQ
- show track quantize and velocity below track buttons
- reduced GUI drawing to quite the minimum needed. no flickering anymore in song automation
- show performance name
- fill notes tool now has note velocity setting
- add some frequently used page shortcuts to TOOL SEQ screen
- bugfix : file manager for PROGMEM only build was broken
- bugfix : Custom samples at non existent MIDI key positions caused to play audio garbage from memory
- bugfix : 8MB PSRAM capacity was displayed wrong (changes for 16MB will be coming soon)

CAUTION: a performance saved with this version will contain 12 tracks and will crash on load when loaded with **older** firmware!

24/08/2024:

- release 1.8.2
- drum effect levels did not save/load completely due to memory issues. This is now fixed.
- updated demo/performance content. Please do not forget to copy over the updated performances from this release to your SD CARD.
- Added new demo performance including all vocal samples shown in recent youtube video. This will only work on the PSRAM firmware fully.
- If you make your own performances, they will be autoconverted. As soon as you save them with the new firmware, they will be saved in the new format.
- If you are really cautious about your own files/sequences etc., it is probably a good idea to make a BACKUP of the SD CARD performance folder to your PC - before doing any firmware update. However, except the incomplete drum effect settings mentioned above, so far there are no known issues about the file conversion process.

20/08/2024:

- added preview functionality in the file manager for samples in PSRAM. A visual progress bar is unfortunately not available, yet. Other than that it works now the same as from SD-Card or SPI FLASH.
- fixed ui for position and size of PSRAM. Extended to support 16MB or more (in theory)

18/08/2024:

- Virtual keyboard now does not make any unnecessary screen redraws when opened for the first time after boot
- Virtual keyboard note range is now adjusted to include the custom samples correctly

17/08/2024:

Release 1.8.1

-fix up file names/display names of custom samples

17/08/2024:

Release 1.8

The following changes affect mostly the firmware type MDT_PSRAM_CAPACITIVE

Custom Samples for Teensy with 1 or 2 PSRAM chip(s) How does it work?

- Go to file manager, touch **COPY>PSRAM** , SD folder should switch to /custom/
- Select a sample from the SD Card on the left side and confirm with ENC[R] push.
- If you want to load to a different sample slot, touch the right window and scroll with ENC[R] to the slot you want to load it in.
- Custom samples are then available in the pattern editor, exactly the same as the preset samples.
- The custom samples are also usable in MSP (MultiSamplePlayer).
- Also Live Sequencer now can address the custom samples via MSP.

Notice: It is possible to also replace the stock samples loaded from /DRUMS. However, names and location of these samples are fixed to the firmware. I suggest not that route in your first testing but go for the new 20 custom sample slots as described above. Samples are expected to be 16 bit, mono, wav format. Keeping the filenames short helps.

- fixed issues with non existing samples trying to play from empty slots
- fixed some visual glitches with sample names

16/08/2024:

- custom samples are now saved and loaded with a performance
- expect to get visual glitches or worse, this is a very early preview of the PSRAM-sample build
- go to file manager, touch copy to PSRAM, sd folder should switch to /custom/ select sample from the SD Card on the left side and touch the right window for the location in PSRAM on the right side. Scroll to the slot you want to load it. Confirm with ENC[R]
- Custom samples are then available in pattern editor as the preset samples
- It is possible to also replace the stock samples loaded from /DRUMS. However, names and location of these samples are fixed to the firmware. I suggest going for the new 20 custom sample slots for your user samples. Samples are expected to be 16bit, mono, wav format.

12/08/2024:

- working on custom samples from PSRAM

09/08/2024:

- Release 1.7.2.1 Sample loading will be displayed at the boot procedure

09/08/2024:

- MDT introduces a new binary: PSRAM_CAPACITIVE
- New release : 1.7.2
- All previous build versions still exist and will be updated, too. This is just a new (but very exciting) option that is added.

PSRAM_CAPACITIVE is the first version that offers/requires a PSRAM chip on the Teensy to work with (custom) samples. From what we have experienced by now, this seems to work flawless (compared to the previous SPI FLASH based method)

Instead of preloading your (custom) samples from SPI FLASH, this MDT build starts off empty and loads all default drum samples from the SD Card /DRUMS directory to the PS RAM Chip at boot. For the stock/default samples, this takes about 1-2 seconds.

What this means is that you now can edit/modify/copy standard 16bit/44KHz wav mono samples, in the /DRUMS folder on the SD Card (Replacing the Files with the same Filenames of the preset drum samples) and they will be loaded to PSRAM at every boot of MDT.

This is so far the easiest way to change preset samples, it couldn't really be much easier to customize or replace the samples now.

- We will investigate if and how this can be extended into banks / kits of samples or how to integrate it into msp, multisample player in the future

- If you do not have a PSRAM chip on your Teensy and are unable to solder it by yourself or by a friend, you can get a fully loaded Teensy from protosupplies.com

21/07/2024:

- There is now VERY basic functionality for adressing external MIDI devices from LIVESEQUENCER as a destination. The destination selection still happens in the SONG page of the LSDJ style Sequencer. Here you can select all the internal sound generators like Dexed, MS, ePiano etc and also MIDI Channels 1-16 from USB Host, DIN/TRS and internal MICRO USB ports. (Identical for both sequencers)

20/07/2024:

- When using the button interface (or a USB NES Controller on the HOST port) you now can change master volume by pressing and holding SELECT and UP / DOWN Keys at the same time. This will work in almost all pages and the main menu that have not special functions for quick navigation already assigned for the sequencer. The volume control will speed up with time according to the setting in SYSTEM - SYSTEM SETTINGS - GAMEPAD/NATIVE KEY SPEED.

19/07/2024:

- Updated bom to reflect extended (current) display and case/enclosure options.

07/07/2024:

Hotfix:

- when Sequencer was set to internal or master mode but an external MIDI Clock was applied to a MIDI input, livesequencer tried to sync to that external clock. This is now corrected.

07/07/2024:

- Added all 3 original available dexed engine types :

  Modern : this is the original 24-bit music-synthesizer-for-android implementation. Mark I : Based on the OPL Series but at a higher resolution (LUT are 10-bits). The target of this engine is to be closest to the real DX7. OPL Series : this is an experimental implementation of the reversed engineered OPL family chips. 8-bit. Keep in mind that the envelope still needs tuning.

I honestly do not hear much differences between them but maybe you do.

- Renamed System "Misc Settings" to "System Settings" You can select the dexed engine type there. It will be applied to both dexed engines as a global setting at boot.

- Updated to latest SynthDexed code from @C0d3man , the original creator of MicroDexed on teensy

04/07/2024:

- Dexed chorus (modulated delay) is now working (for both instances individually)
- Dexed chorus settings in all detail are available and editable in dexed - "audio" menu
- Chorus settings in the demo performances are set to 0 - so to actually hear the chorus effect, you have to increase the level, speed and depth setting in dexed audio
- You now can quickly jump directly from dexed voice screen into chorus, delay and reverb settings pages by clicking on "EDIT" right to the level gauge for the corresponding setting
- fixed some panorama issues in dexed
- Dexed chorus is currently centered in the stereo field, no matter where the dry signal is placed in the panorama. Let me know if you find it better if panning it together with the dry signal or not

02/07/2024:

- LiveSequencer now always finishes pending notes before a new pattern starts. fixes very rare noteOff not played
- Moving the cursor in sequencer settings does not confuse sequencer timing.
- Scope mostly rewritten. Plots its log scaled value to available height. Scope should use less CPU now

25/06/2024:

Several small adjustments to the hardware/pcb parts:

- PCB-based front plate should no longer have the PCBWAY-IDENT Number visible on the front. Instead it should now be located on it's backside and not be "visible" any more

- reduced/minimized text on the PCB-based front plate for a cleaner design

- Added further info to the (invisible) back side of the front-plate like hole sizes etc.

- MDT Main PCB: Drill Holes for the MiniJacks now are no longer circular but oval in space which should fit better the pins of the connectors

- MDT Main PCB: PCBWAY-IDENT should be placed better and not randomly

- MDT Main PCB: spacing of the MiniJacks, specially the MIDI out port, should be better aligned with the SLA printed case

- PCB-based back plate now has text indicators for MIDI IN, OUT and AUDIO
- PCB-based back plate should reflect the oval shaped holes of the updated MDT Main PCB and are bigger in general to cover up excessive soldering points better than before
- PCB-based back plate: PCBWAY-IDENT should be placed better and not randomly
- PCB-based back now has been modified to make the Teensy SD Card Slot more accessable, it now should be possible to swap/insert/remove the Card without screwing apart the top or have to use any tools to reach the Card

23/06/2024:

Release 1.7.1

- Added MIDI MASTER (CLOCK SYNC) to sequencer. When activated, MDT will send out MIDI clock to USB-HOST, (Micro-)USB and TRS-MIDI simultaneously. If you want to use MIDI Sync, this mode is the prefered option since it provides best timing and smallest additional system load.
- small improvements for all MIDI CLOCK SYNC modes.
- Scope view is now detached from the Master-Volume and instead captures the level right before going into the Master-Volume adjustment. This means it should display audio activity at much higher levels, even when Master Volume is at 0. So now the scope is a valid visual tool to check if MDT is playing something, even when you have no headphones/amplifier etc. attached.
- Virtual Keyboard now should work with drumpad view in all screens where Virtual Keyboard is available.
- CONFIG SAVE Notification should no longer draw over the virtual keyboard, when used from the main menu and changing System parameters like Master-Volume.
- When the velocity editor and sequencer plays and then is stopped, the scope view was not cleared out correctly. That is now fixed.

22/06/2024:

Sequencer:

- Sequencer will follow MIDI CLOCK SYNC (Enable/Disable it in SEQUENCER/SETTINGS) Timing is solid for voice instruments (dexed etc.), not so good for samples (small delay - if possible, put your timing critical drum samples on the MIDI Master to solve it)

Livesequencer:

- Livesequencer will now also try to follow MIDI CLOCK SYNC (if enabled) but this is currently more a proof of concept and a bit sloppy sounding. Livesequencer is not working with hard steps but has much higher internal timing resolution. This can not be directly mapped to the 24 beats per quarter note of the MIDI Standard. Livesequencer will try to match to the external tempo by measuring the time between every 1/8 note and then recalculating every note based on this time, each 1/8 note. Going higher, like a 1/16 note, in real time, takes too much CPU and makes the result even worse. Work in progress.

Common Issues:

- The Delay1 & Delay 2 Times are recalculated at every tempo change (when they are set to a SYNC Tempo like 1/8, 1/8T, 16T, 16 etc.) but since the incoming MIDI CLOCK has some variation of +-1 BPM per step (sometimes even +-2 BPM) , this causes the recalculation of the delays for every step and produces some audible audio clicks (even when tempo in reality is not changed). These small changes are now ignored for the delay calculation. If using the internal timing, it still will recalculate it for every tiny adjustment as before

14/06/2024:

Livesequencer:

- fix wrong arp behavior regarding arp input and played track
- implemented livesequencer real time bpm adaptation to global tempo (when changing tempo in seq. adv. settings)
- fix crash on opening empty livesequencer while sequencer running
- delay all arp events by 1ms to make sure when in track source mode, quantized notes are already on when sampling

13/06/2024:

- liveseq editor better scrolling, UI fixes, better stability

09/06/2024:

- Livesequencer Graphic Editor - added note-add/copy note There are issues with scrolling around that are unsolved. If you want to use the copy-note function, it is (currently) easier to first scroll near the area where you want to copy. Then select the note to

copy with SELECT NOTE and Encoder R, PUSH COPY NOTE move up/down with ENCODER R where it shall be copied confirm with either the COPY NOTE or the NOTE VALUE touch button

07/06/2024:

- Livesequencer Graphic Editor - improved stability
- Livesequencer Graphic Editor: Navigating X/Y and Zoom now working in general
- Livesequencer now can directly jump into Graphic Editor by long-touch of TRACK Icons in LiveSequencer

04/06/2024:

- Livesequencer ListEditor - now stepping through note edit steps is available by touch button and also by pushing Encoder_R
- Livesequencer Graphic Editor (early alpha) - should be less frequent to crash and can now edit note values and velocity graphically

03/06/2024:

- Improvement: FORMAT FLASH After formatting the FLASH Chip, you will be presented with the option to copy the default Samples to it. It is no longer necessary to go to FILE MANAGER and push the COPY PRESET Button. (You can still do this, it will skip all existing Samples and just copy over what is different since the last copy).

30/05/2024:

- LiveSequencer Editor (Listview) will now try to delete also the corresponding note-off event when you are deleting a note-on event. Also it should protect you from deleting a note-off event only, by mistake.

27/05/2024:

- release 1.7.0 https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/releases/tag/v1.7.0

- Introducing LiveSequencer Editor. The editor is a (low level) tool to manipulate note data behind the curtains of LiveSequencer. LiveSequencer can merge and delete patterns very easily like a pro but can not modify data inside the patterns (yet) after recording. So this is my attempt to allow (small) changes to the data, without recording a pattern again when there are only small mistakes or problems.

- LiveSequencer Editor can:

    - delete notes from LiveSequencer
    - change notes/pitch, velocity and time value
    - helps you to find duplicate notes , erase or change them

24/05/2024:

- fix crash on record with too many layers. was caused by a copy-paste error using LIVESEQUENCER_NUM_TRACKS instead of LIVESEQUENCER_NUM_LAYERS. cleanups
- fix pages opened from livesequencer got overdrawn onStopped. keep processing midi in for all pages opened from here
- fix tick timer too slow and not triggering events just at end of pattern reliably

14/05/2024:

release 1.6.9

this adds a live arpeggiator implementation to live sequencer:

- settings: speed, number of octaves, 8 modes, note length, swing (+/- 8 steps), velocity, latch, repeat notes
- arp source can be keyboard or any track (automation possible with song mode)
- sample times 1x to 4x per bar

26/04/2024:

release 1.6.83

- massive improvements to pattern editor and virtual keyboard, too much to list
- fixed display glitches on screen and on remote console
- the virtual keyboard tries to be much smarter. When opening vk in dexed screen, microsynth or braids, it will autoselect its page
- when in pattern editor and switching to virtual keyboard, it will try to open the best editor for the current pattern
- new drumpad view in pattern editor with rest and latch feature. The latch feature is only usable on instrument tracks

- step record with virtual keyboard and new features is now stabilized. It should work with external MIDI input device as well as internal virtual keyboard

work in progress:

- content type changes of pattern will now update in realtime in pattern editor
- display content when changing to and from virtual keyboard glitches fixed
- fixed pressed virtual keyboard keys status for pitchable samples
- colors in step record input are fixed

Step Recorder Enhancements:

When step recording is enabled you have some new and improved options, just with using the touchscreen:

- When recording, you can toggle to modify just the current step, or auto advance to the next step endless, or auto advance and stop after the last pattern step.
- latch/tie : you can add latch notes with a new touch button (this will only work in instrument tracks/instrument content type, not for samples)
- rest/clear: you can clear a step with a new touch button, this works for all content types.

NEW virtual drum pad keyboard:

- apart from the piano keyboard view, now there is a new drum pad view. Sample Names will be shown inside the drumpad icons. This makes it way easier to input drum patterns on MDT alone, with no external input device. Samples can be scrolled up and down in octaves. The drum pad view shows 12 pads at a time and can be scrolled through 5 octaves.

24/04/2024:

- Release 1.6.82

Pattern Editor:

- now when selecting/scrolling through the preset samples, the sample will auto play (at slightly reduced volume so it should not get annoying very fast) Let me know in discord if you find this too distracting so it should be changed into an option or find any stability issue with it, so far i have not seen any issue even i was expecting to get problems, specially when scrolling really fast with samples from FLASH. I also was expecting some kind of slowdown from this change but i don't see any.

Note: The preview will not happen while the sequencer is running. This is intended behaviour, the same as in previous post where the preview of sequencer step sounds was added.

- some samples were missing or had a name mismatch, if you still miss samples after this update, make sure you copy the wav files from the addon folder to SD Card and get them on to flash with filemanager (push touchbutton COPY PRESET). You do NOT have to format your flash, only the missing files will be copied. If you still find that a sound is not playing, it is probably playing at a very low volume. Check in DRUMS page, each sample has its own volume setting

23/04/2024:

Pattern Editor:

- samples and pitched samples as well as notes from instrument tracks now will play their sound sample / note when scrolling through the pattern.

- when inserting a new step into the active sequence, the corresponding sample/pitched sample or the MIDI note will be played once. In case of an instrument track, this currently will be played by the mda ePiano, no matter what instrument the pattern actually is assigned to or will be assigned to in it's track, in song view.

- the piano sound for preview is very short by default but you can just increase decay and release time of it in ePiano page

- when the virtual keyboard with step recording was enabled in pattern editor, the touch-velocity bar was not alligned correctly, that should be now much better

- the instrument + touch button of virtual keyboard in the pattern editor was behaving unreliably (only working at the outer top right corner) because of a touch button conflict with a button from the interface with the virtual keyboard not showing. This is now fixed and both touch buttons will behave as expected

- fixed minor visual glitches from too long text displays in sample selection

- drum samples, when previously not used but saved to a performance turn out to be saved with a volume of zero which leads to the "bug" that previously unused sounds were muted. This is now fixed, only sounds that have set a manual value will be

loaded and the unused ones will get a default volume of 100 so you can hear them without changing all of the manually.

22/04/2024:

- RELEASE 1.6.81
- forget about the inconsistent scrolling behavior between song and pattern page:

Now, when scrolling from song to pattern page, you can do that continuously with Enc_L. So when you switch to pattern mode you need Enc_R only for activating and deactivating the parameters and changing the value. The scrolling all can happen with Enc_L, all the time.

- The previous behavior for scrolling with Enc_R is untouched, so you can still do that, as before.

However the global Volume Change is now gone in the pattern editor with Enc_L. I think it is worth it, since it now feels much more natural to browse through the full sequencer functions and pages, without going to the main menu, at all.

Notice: When you start up the pattern editor at boot, without touching song page before, the scrolling will behave, as it was before to avoid confusion.

22/04/2024:

- RELEASE 1.6.8
- UI fix/cosmetics: When using the pattern auto-fill function in the pattern editor, while the sequencer is running, parameter highlighting color was overwritten with the moving sequencer cursor. This is now fixed and the current selected parameter that is modified is indicated in red brackets (as usual)
- Song/Pattern Editor workflow improvements: When working in a song editor, it was previously not possible to jump to the linked pattern(s), without using the lsdj-like native buttons or a USB gamepad. You had to exit the page and go to the pattern editor manually though the main menu.

This is now improved.

When you are in edit mode in the song page and scroll to the right with Encoder_L, after going to chain and then to transpose, the view will switch to the corresponding pattern in the pattern editor. However the situation is still a bit unnatural feeling since in song mode you use x/y navigation with BOTH encoders but in the pattern editor it is just left/right with Encoder_R and Encoder_L is getting it's "normal" behaviour, meaning changing master volume level.

Nevertheless, you now CAN go back to the song page, by just scrolling all to the left, but with Encoder_R. As said, that currently requires a litte mind switch since in the song page, you navigate left and right with Encoder_L and up down with Encoder_R, since it is a grid view.

To avoid confusion about that, this jumping page behavior will only occur when you open the pattern editor by this new way (scrolling to it from song page). If you just enter the pattern editor by the regular main menu, without this new navigation tool, it will behave as it was before, meaning it will not jump and not scroll any further than the first parameter available in the pattern editor.

14/04/2024:

- continued work on side chain compressor
- removed boot delay for PSRAM configurations - please open an issue ticket if this causes any boot problems with details about your configuration (display type, PSRAM size etc.)

08/04/2024:

HOTFIX: Dexed voice select confirm button was setting live modifier envelopes to zero

02/04/2024:

Enhancements DEXED voice screen:

- added favorites search touch button to toggle between all presets, favorites only, non-favorites,random non favorites.

This setting is identical to the system setting but not saved permanently, only set during device runtime. You still can set it permanently in the SYSTEM submenu FAVORITES This also makes sure you can switch the modes when there is an issue with touch, so you can

always change it in the traditional menu. The new touch button makes it much quicker and convenient to tag and search for your favorite voices without leaving the voice screen.

FIXES:

- Fav. search text was not aligned perfectly, this is now fixed
- touch buttons for dexed voice live modifiers were slightly offset, that is now corrected
- unnecessary redraw/screen flashes of live modifier touch buttons enhanced
- live modifier CLEAR button was not implemented fully, this is now corrected
- While the editing mode of performance modifier attack/release is active and going to virtual keyboard, it is possible to still change the value, even if the touch button is not visible on screen. This is good to have but currently not best visualized, work in progress. However, being in this state there was a visual glitch when changing voice presets while virtual keyboard is displayed and modifier edit is still active. This is fixed now.
- binaries in repo updated

23/03/2024:

- when drum samples are played from keyboard with drum screen open (from livesequencer), the sample is selected. this makes finding drum samples very easy.
- made midi note to drum sample note lookup much more efficient

19/03/2024:

- small fixes for MIDI SYSEX path issues

03/03/2024:

- drum channel problem when playing from an external MIDI device - drums are added to the current selected channel, no matter what channel is selected
- disabled live sequencer for now since this seems to cause the issue
- upload the latest binary, if the problem still persists, check if you really have set the drum channel to something other than ONMI.

15/02/2024:

v1.6.73

- small fixes for drum page
- waveform will be auto disabled when streaming samples from flash while in drum page
- you now should be able to start and stop sequencer even when in drum page as usual by long press ENC_L, it should not lead to any crashes anymore when using FLASHMEM

14/02/2024:

- small enhancements of drum page (added waveform display when compiled for FLASHMEM)
- drum parameters will update now correctly when cycling through samples

13/02/2024:

Small bug fixes v1.6.72

- small fixes to livesequencer
- arp_num_notes_max was not loaded or saved in performance
- ep_delay_send_1 & 2 were not loaded or saved in performance

11/02/2024:

Hotfix: Release v1.6.71

- disabled default metronome of live sequencer

02/2024:

Fixes for LiveSequencer:

song length was incorrectly saved/loaded and displayed

fill track rounding error, made beat to be off at some bpms

song events were played once in pattern mode after loading

corrected button colors

Release Firmware v1.6.7 Featuring:

Live Sequencer implementation in MDT

Quick howto:

define 6 instruments to tracks 1 - 6 in song view. Assign all different MIDI channels (also for your keyboard, events are forwarded)

open "Live Sequencer" in Sequencer menu

a simple drum track layer is added automatically to have some tempo

not recording: play as you like on a selected instrument (GREEN is active). Click on Green button to open instrument page

press "REC" as soon as you like to record (Recording track is RED). Start to play at beginning (0.0000)

When the pattern ends, a new layer is added. While recording you can abort by clicking the blinking button.

then continue with other layers / tracks as you like...

by clicking on layer, layer mute is toggled. Click on recording track (Red) to cycle through layer menu (merge up / delete)

In Song Mode, track mutes and additionally played music is recorded. To end song recording, press "Stop". The longest song layer defines song length. If not recording, song will loop.

Pattern Mode:

One click instrument selection

Layer based live recording with quantization support

Layers can be muted, merged and deleted after recording

Tools menu with quantization setting per track

Fill notes tool (not really useful)

Pattern length selection

Current GUI limitation: 6 tracks with 4 layers each

Song Mode:

Record track mutes and midi notes over time and replay them. Instrument change during recording supported.

Song Layers also can be deleted and merged

Allows basic song composition

Pattern and Song data is persistent. Normal Sequencer and Live Sequencer can be used in parallel.

- updated PCBWAY faq
- updated MDT faq what you will get when ordering the pcb+assembly option
- added rendering of pre assembled pcb
-
- fixed wrong IC socket picture
- added detailed part list of included and excluded items
- added pictures and short instructions about main jumper settings

06/12/2023:

- small bugfix: resistive touch was broken after doing some work for capacitive yesterday

26/11/2023:

- release 1.6.4
- fixed broken note-latch
- reverted some changes about volume control: when multiband compressor is on, now a manual volume change by ENC_L will disable the compressor instantly. This might be annoying at first usage. Volume level changes can be massive with the compressor so this is a step to make it safer to use. Please be very careful whenever enabling the compressor and expect that audio level can go up 10x or even more depending on what parameters the compressor currently is set to.
- small UI fixes

24/11/2023:

- release 1.6.3
- enable digital audio output: S/PDIF / Toslink by default. Digital output is free of all kind of noises. This might be the prefered output if you are recording from MDT or in a live environment. S/PDIF is tested with a coaxial output connector. It also should work with an optical, Toslink style cable but that is so far untested
- When the mastering/multiband compressor is set to on and volume change is requested by ENC_L, a help message is displayed that volume will stay at max. level while multiband compressor is enabled. While mastering, you do not want to change the master output level since this would reduce dynamics/output bit-depth. Just disable the multiband to change volume settings while composing, arranging or doing other operations with MDT.

19/11/2023:

- improved master volume scaling and handling
- updated links of MDT releases
- deleted outdated releases
- added v1.6.1 unified release

18/11/2023:

- working on an option for getting a partly build MDT version by PCBWAY

code fixes by damster:

- fix screensaver 2/2: while playing midi, screensaver used to pop up shortly. now resetScreenTimer() is called at midi key note on
- inhibit screensaver while any midi notes are playing. before this was only when the sequencer running in song view.
- code reduction for screensaver timer reset and abort conditions, reverts parts of my recent pull request since no more needed
- remove dead code
- screensaver ids now defined in enum for readability
- fix random screensaver could pick the same screensaver again :)
- fix terrain_init was not called in random screensaver mode
- random screensaver transition effect written simpler
- the terrain screensaver also uses dynamic color. and color gets darker at the horizon. looks almost realistic
- terrain screensaver now also has both logo versions randomly picked
- screensavers now with 25fps. looks smoother. cpu seems not to care much
- swarm screensaver has color changing circle predator now

15/11/2023:

- some code enhancements by damster regarding PSRAM & capacitive touch bootup, screensaver and other fixes
- updated readme, descriptions, 3d print models, screenshots / photos, links on PCBWAY and codeberg

14/11/2023:

- v1.6 first unified release for both MDT versions

12/11/2023:

- updated BOM: sources for buttons, headphone amp. Notice: Headphone amp has noise issues. Previous output is still available and is unaffected.
- updated, test printed SLA enclosure. For the added buttons, make sure to order not too long push buttons since this will be difficult to fit to the enclosure. read BOM instruction notes.
- Headphone Amp Option: Be noticed that is not working perfectly. There are digital noise issues. DAC output (as it was previously) is unaffected.
- ordered SLA prints from PCBWAY for testing in standard white and transparent
- put future enclosure parts on PCBWAY (you can order them now but at this moment they are untested)
- added pictures and updated texts for new version of pcb on PCBWAY
- linked items and updated texts on codeberg and PCBWAY
- reworked Threaded Inserts for SLA enclosure screws to fit with new buttons
- moved button holes and estimated more ideal placement for DAC jack and the 2 new buttons
- made measuring tests with self printed parts in FDM to test out changes to the SLA printed parts

11/11/2023:

- line clipping that allows terrain screensaver back on web remote (thanks to dronus)

10/11/2023:

- release PCB capacitive touch: https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/MicroDexed_Capacitive_Touch_64970fee.html

Enhancements to prior version:

- Capacitive touch display (works similar like your current smartphone touch)
- Easy Access: PROGRAM Button (mainly useful for development)
- Soft Power on/off (aimed at users building their own power/battery solution)
- Option for Headphone amplifier

Tested so far:

- display ok
- touch ok
- usb host MIDI ok in and out
- button for PROGRAM
- button for SOFT POWER
- DIN/minijack Type B MIDI in
- DIN/minijack Type B MIDI out
- Headphone Amp, powered from PC USB Port - Works but some noise issues in some circumstances. Need further test with clean power source
- with Headphone Amp deactivated/skipped by jumpers, works as intended / no noise issue found so far

04/11/2023:

- fixed a clear screen/refresh issue when calling virtual keyboard on remote console from main menu
- added short instructions how to convert MDT pcb for resistive touch display to "new" capacitive touch

03/11/2023:

- work on updated pcb, routing adding amp with resistors, buttons etc.
- updated schematics
- updated main build instruction pictures

30/10/2023:

- Web remote : fix the rendering for the volmeters

29/10/2023:

- Web remote : complete rewrite of the rendering engine with WEBGL (p5.js): now all antialias artefacts are gone and display is sharper with better colors
- Web remote : fix color management
- Web remote : now uses a web font (WOFF2) instead of drawing chars pixel by pixel
- Web remote : keyboard shortcuts added for the header buttons
- Web remote : big code refactoring/cleaning

- Fix background colors for some texts for the rendering on web remote

25/10/2023:

- Started working on updating build instructions for new capacitive touch version
- Continue updating pcb
- Continue updating case/enclosure

20/10/2023:

- Main Menu now has back-touch-button on all sub-menus
- Most pages, modern or "2 Line Text" now also have a touch back button
- Physical Left/Back button will remain in all cases - touch back button is always to see as an alternative to go back (for example you do not have encoders available, yet)
- UI Touch icons in pages, where they were unusable while being in the page, are now hidden
- fixed many back from page screen update/clear issues
- updated binaries

18/10/2023:

- Release 1.5.9
- Web Remote: most USB audio glitches gone
- Web Remote: countless drawing/code optimizations
- Web Remote: Screensavers nearly fully functional, Info Page working for the first time on remote
- Small UI fixes

16/10/2023:

- Release 1.5.8
- Drawing optimization to MDT and web remote (update needed for both to work)
- pixel adjustments in dexed voice

12/10/2023:

- Release 1.5.6
- Button presses now are edge driven. Press and hold keeps button pressed and does inhibit toggling
- Virtual keyboard code does no more need any gui slowdown since also edge driven
- Binary version clean up - remote console is auto-enabled in all builds. Removed/added useful/unnecessary Versions

22/09/2023:

- In the Song view, added the Teensy-internal Micro USB Connector as a MIDI Destination for your DAW with 16 separate channels. This allows MIDI recording your MD output to your DAW on multiple tracks, at once - as MIDI data.

- If you want to record notes from TrackType Drums, you have to temporarily change the Tracktype to Instrument (no data will be harmed, you can change it back anytime). You also could just reload the song after your MIDI export - or just reboot without saving.

- The MIDI labeling in the Song view is not as clear as i like it to be but for the moment this it is: USB = USB HOST DIN = MiniJack MIDI (with optional adapter to DIN MIDI) INT = Micro USB Port of Teensy

20/09/2023:

- to give a better overview about upcoming changes and things already available i started a page/wiki for the next version with capacitive touch.

https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/wiki/MicroDexed-Capacitive-Touch

17/09/2023:

- Working on an Hardware update with better display but at a similar price. This display offers capacitive touch and is MUCH more responsive as the current default display. However, so far only one source of this display type is available and the order amount seems to be limited to one screen only per order. https://www.aliexpress.com/item/1005005926026997.html?spm=a2g0o.cart.0.0.4c6e4ae4FvwMuX&mp=1 Note: It is possible to modify the current MDT pcb to fit this display. However this requires cutting 2 traces that are below the display connector on the MDT pcb. I do not suggest making this modification if you do not have some advanced skill in desoldering and soldering components with multiple pins.

- It will take some time to figure out software and hardware changes and the waiting for the arrival of a new pcb test version. I estimate this can take several weeks or even months, so progress on this topic is estimated towards the end of 2023.

03/09/2023:

- release 1.5.5
- fixed screensaver bug
- added swing and triplet function to sequencer play modes

02/08/2023:

- release 1.5.4 with all mentioned additions for song time signatures / patterns from 8-16 steps
- Download link, binaries are in folder "release" https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/releases/tag/v1.5.4
- dexed voice: when scrolling though presets on pool, bank or voice level, the voice transpose setting was not refreshed on screen correctly
- microsynth: when virtual keyboard was enabled and switching between both instances, not all parameters were refreshed on screen correctly

01/08/2023:

- working on a feature for triplet and other more unusual time signatures / shorter patterns than 16 steps.
- Currently this is thought of as a global setting for a song. So for example, if you want a song using tripet timing, you can change the pattern steps from 16 to 12 and everything should work out as intended.
- reducing the pattern length will not drop or otherwise change the content of the patterns above the last step. Everything still will be saved/loaded with the full 16 steps in place. However, to make it more clear what is playing and what not, in pattern editor, in grid view, pianoview etc, all disabled steps will be toned down by a darker gray color to make it obvious what will be played and what will be skipped
- working on some final touches that live-playback display will update correctly on screen, whatever pattern length you have set. All length from 8-16 steps will be available so that should cover a lot of the more unusual time signatures for your songs
- setting will be saved per song - not per pattern or per track (and can be changed/expanded without any data-loss)
- default value will continue to stay at 16 steps since that is the most common used value, 4/4 measure with 16 steps per pattern so no changes to your song/pattern should be required to do if you do not want to look into this feature

25/07/2023:

- release 1.5.3
- added a copy/paste function in Song Editor
- copy function can also be used to quickly clear out large areas by copying from an empty part
- both is demonstrated in a short video at : https://youtu.be/bRSscUWsitU
- clear loop function now is visually easier to see and more clearly to understand (clears only loop points, no data)
- small ui and bug fixes

13/07/2023:

- release 1.5.2
- Favorite Icons do come up at the correct but also at a wrong display position at certain circumstances - fixed
- toggle/current status of Fav during scrolling and changing instances improved
- added new (alpha) screensaver
- returning from screensaver, when you push ENC_L for volume settings, now will behave as a back-from-screensaver key
- when returning from a screensaver and you previously were on dexed voice, ePiano, braids etc. page, your previous menu item will still be selected as it was and not reset it's cursor position
- changes to screensaver, specially from OFF to another mode, now should apply directly without the need for a reboot
- added .stl files and updated build guide including the enclosure lid mod for easier sd card access

- if you feel something gone wrong in the latest release, switch back to an earlier release on: https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/releases We will keep the last 10+ releases there so there so you do not need to manage a history by your own. Further, there will never be an issue that you can not go back to older version. The releases downloads covers always the full state of that time, including SD card files without any exception.

Also let us know in discord: https://discord.gg/XCYk5P8GzF or on: https://codeberg.org/positionhigh/MicroDexed-touch/issues if you think to have found and new issue and what is needed to reproduce it.

10/07/2023:

- small fix coming up in next release:
- Favorite Icons do come up at the correct but also at a wrong display position at certain circumstances - fixed
- toggle/current status of Fav during scrolling and changing instances improved

06/07/2023:

- release v1.5.1
- simplified version numbering
- added boot screen checks / advice when default content is missing at boot and offer solutions to fix it

03/06/2023: dev notes (work in progress):

- bit crusher/sample rate modifier on master (and maybe individual instruments, or even on single drum samples)
- new screen saver
- new screen saver options: random, global off, individual saver selectable by name
- small chance to introduce drum sample envelopes (with decay and release values for each sample)

21/05/2023:

- fixed dexed pitch bend settings not applying correctly or not at all
- other MIDI side effects might be cured by fixing the pitch bend

20/05/2023:

- new binary release 1.5.0b22
- Sequencer BPM now can be directly viewed and modified on dexed voice screen

13/05/2023: dev notes (work in progress):

I managed to get the sample editor to not directly crash any more, when editing loop starts, ends and loop-modes. This mainly happens when a sample is still playing in the background (even though it might have been not audible). However, it is required that MDT stops all sample playback, while editing the loop parameters. Conveniently, MDT will take care of that in the future, automatically.

Having this issue cleared, I still found it extremely difficult to find valid and good sounding loop points. I will try out how much it will help when creating an "auto-zero-crossing detection" function. So when you are scrolling through the loop start + end points, only samples at zero (or near zero) should be selected. I hope that it might improve this process a bit.

Playing together with the sequencer with looped, live multisamples might become possible to a degree. At least I got it working for several minutes, then it crashed when the engine already had all sample slots in use and I tried to add chords on top of it with my own samples. Since in this case, CPU/Flash usage was already well over 95% without any manual playing (meaning 2 instances of dexed + 8 samples + effects already running), it will depend on your sequenced parts and what instruments they are playing, how much you can lay on top when you want to play samples live.

Notice: These limitations apply in general only to samples. It is usually not an issue to play braids, dexed, ePiano or other voices live, while the sequencer is running. Polyphony of these instruments are 8-16 voices each and they do not create any burden on the flash chip, only on CPU and that is comparable low.

PS: let me know in discord if dev notes like this are helpful, interesting or superfluous to you.

13/05/2023:

- global delay#2 was not setting the send value of dexed instance#2 when loading a performance or booting - fixed
- transpose value and MIDI channel value in dexed voice scrolled too fast - changed to single step increments
- when screensaver is active, it now can be stopped by external MIDI note-on (or by touchscreen or encoder movement or push)

09/05/2023:

- smartFilter. This was there before but got broken at some point when menus were restructured. Now it is back!

- activate or deactivate smartFilter in Sequencer menu or in MainMenu - Drums.
- While smartFilter is active and you are browsing through samples in MIDI Mapper or in Drums Menu, all non used sounds from the current performance will be skipped during the browsing. This makes the search for the sample and it's parameter editing MUCH quicker.
- At boot, smartFilter is always deactivated so that new users do not get confused, why they can not find all the preset samples

07/05/2023:

- reverted variable_playback to known, more stable version
- fixed display refresh when starting master effects page
- master volume control change in master effects page handling improved

05/05/2023:

- fixed graphic clash in dexed voice - release 1.5.0b16
- new binary release 1.5.0b15
- the custom MIDI channel of drums is now saved + loaded with performance. It should NOT go to OMNI, when you have not saved a custom channel in a performance. If this ever happens, please let us know in discord chat.
- when triggering samples from FLASH from an external MIDI Sequencer (or even by playing remotely) it sooner or later locked up the device when the sample was still playing from another slot. This issue seems to only have occured when using FLASH and not samples loading from PROGMEM

30/04/2023:

- improve volmeters management on MDT
- improve volmeters management on web remote
- fix band compressor volmeters on web remote

28/04/2023:

- hide "._" Mac files in file manager
- hide "._" Mac files in web remote file manager
- moved AI bank generator in web remote according to the new folder structure on SD
- better UI for AI bank generator in web remote

27/04/2023:

- found and fixed a big memory related overwrite bug for files/RAM for all kind of issues
- release 1.5.0b14
- if you have not changed the dexed files locations recently, please notice:
- Folder structure needed some changes. You can copy over the content from addon/SD to your SD Card or move the previous folders 0-99 from /DEXED/ to /DEXED/0/
- If you have spent some time selecting your favorite Sounds before, make sure you do not miss moving also the Folder FAVCFG from: /DEXED/FAVCFG to /DEXED/0/FAVCFG. If you do so, all your previous selected favorites will remain

23/04/2023:

- new binary Release 1.5.0b12
- dexed now has more space for presets. Another abstraction layer has been added, called pools
- all what was previously available is called pool zero (0) and will behave as it did before.
- You can add up 99 additional pools
- Every pool contains up to 100 banks with 32 voices, each
- Folder structure needed some changes. You can copy over the content from addon/SD to your SD Card or move the previous folders 0-99 from /DEXED/ to /DEXED/0/
- To illustrate the change, the picture DEXED_Folder_Structure.jpg is provided in folder addon/SD
- Favorites will work as before but are stored for each pool, individually
- If you have spent some time selecting your favorite Sounds before, make sure you do not miss moving also the Folder FAVCFG from: /DEXED/FAVCFG to /DEXED/0/FAVCFG. If you do so, all your previous selected favorites will remain
- muted the RED selection color a bit down so it is not so bright as before
- Favorites search modes continue to work as before. But they will not go across pools. At end of a pool, it will continue searching at beginning of the same pool
- Search modes for ALL, only Favorites, only non-Favorites, tested but there might be issues when pool is not completly filled with banks
- Design of dexed voice with parameter selections, spacing, FAV select/deselect button made more consistent and clear
- optimized drawing of Touch Button for Favorites in dexed voice
- for Pool 1, added some "AI/random" generated example bank with https://www.thisdx7cartdoesnotexist.com/

22/04/2023:

- new binary Release V1.5.0b10

- Song: Loop mode improved. Loop is now erased by scrolling up in the loop steps and hitting CLEAR (and not by picking the same start- and endstep of the previous set loop)
- Song: New Loop points will always get registered, no matter what steps were selected previously
- Song: Drawing to remote console should be improved further
- Master Volume: When changing volume in Dexed Voice, Braids, ePiano, microsynth etc. you will return to the previously selected menu item (and not jump back to the default value when entering the page from the main menu)
- All: Display values with negative values now should be displayed with correct spacing and presign
- other small fixes

15/04/2023:

- improvements to song page regarding data sending to remote console
- fixed dexed note-off not working correctly when located in main menus There are other MIDI channel/device mapping issues, currently not solved. Work in progress.

14/04/2023:

- In main menu, updated submenu texts, home icon is now gone but text should be more easy to understand where you are
- main menu should work faster with remote console
- back button text optimized internally
- back button is now drawn correctly when opening touch keyboard in main-menu - sub menu and closing it
- added additional pages to system start like main mixer, ePiano, braids, sysinfo etc.
- when Sysinfo is set as the start page, it goes straight to main menu after playing welcome sound

13/04/2023:

- remote console versions are gone, now auto detected
- improved colour scheme

11/04/2023:

- fixed sd sample preview in sample editor
- updated all binaries
- updated releases to current state

10/04/2023:

- Enhanced web remote console. Serial Interface is dumped and replaced with MIDI. Much more reliable
- Browsers previously not working might be worth rechecking. Firefox on Mac now seems to be working, not only Chrome
- web console on Mac with Chrome is connecting far more reliable as it did before
- MSP with opt. flash chip can now play looped samples live in forward and pingpong mode
- Loops for MSP samples can be set in sample editor
- sample editor UI enhanced, overview window should now be more accurate
- general display in sample editor should not show wrong or false data
- Sample preview/playback for MSP, Flash and SD Files in sample editor, small issues with SD remaining

05/04/2023:

- fixed drawing in microsynth when enabling and disabling virtual keyboard
- fixed remote console getting stuck in drawing when in info page in certain conditions
- remote console in Chrome on Mac stability improved (meaning it is working several hours without issues)
- info page enhancements: showing dexed cpu load and cpu temp

03/04/2023:

- RELEASE 1.5
- startup issues with some sd cards should be solved
- bootup time should be decreased to 1-2 seconds
- updated all binaries

02/04/2023:

- fixed loading delay effect settings when using higher delay times with PSRAM chip

- set performance load selection speed back to single steps to get more precise input

- removed outdated and obsolete stuff at bootup for SD Card like searching for it on the Teensy Audio Adaptor.

I don't expect anything to change but if you have problems with an SD Card: Please format it FAT32 (not FATex), copy the ADDON/SD folder freshly , upload the matching binary from folder /Release and let me know if there is any change.

- updated binaries

01/04/2023:

- MSP UI improvements (no zone number column, bigger filenames, main volume bar)
- fix double performance loading
- fix MIDI channels control: happens only at performance loading
- fix text color after performance saving is done

31/03/2023:

- MSP (MultiSamplePlayer) now has pitch adjustment for every single sample/zone
- MSP: matched audio levels to fit in more with other instruments in MDT
- added new MDT configuration with Hardware Buttons/Keys in addition to Encoders
- updated binaries (as always, in folder release)

30/03/2023:

- fix multisample page when editing zones

28/03/2023:

- pattern editor: Fixed remote console when in pianoroll editor
- pattern editor: Fixed remote console not updating velocity bars correctly
- updated binaries

25/03/2023:

- working on a prototype pcb with capacitive touch for the last 3 days. First version is submitted to PCBWAY:

- the 4 resistors and the diode are swapped for SMD components and in the future should be possible to be ordered by PCBWAY assembly service (as an option)

- i haven't changed the optocoupler since as a SMD component it isn't cheaper nor it is smaller. Also the availability of the "oldschool" DIP package seems to be much better so you still have to get that, from a source of your choice

- The high density display connector can not really be soldered by a soldering amateur. After i get it working (at all), i will see to offer an option, to get the pcb with just this connector (so you can put the other SMD parts by yourself if you prefer to do so)

22/03/2023:

- fixed braids filter mode when it is not set to lowpass
- updated binaries

21/03/2023:

- added fixes for web remote on mac with chrome
- toned down y-movement speed in song-mode. It was fast but difficult to land on the desired song step. That is now slower but more precise to only scroll 1 line at a time
- song view does now some caching to improve rendering speed. this might introduce some new display issues,(or not)

17/03/2023:

- binaries updated, new binary release
- improvements in dexed voice page

14/03/2023:

- binaries updated, new binary release, v1.4.9b9
- small fix: midi channels page for remote console
- dexed voice: direct jump touch button to dexed voice editor
- small code improvements in dexed voice

13/03/2023:

- MIDI Channel Update !
- This update will notice you about uncommon issues in MIDI setup (and could lead to strange problems) :
- (Multiple) Channels set to OMNI will get a warning that it might lead to unforeseen consequences (tm)
- Multiple instruments, set to an identical Channel will give you a "notice" - you can ignore this if you set it up this way on purpose - i will see to put in an option to nag you no more than once about that. Currently it is handled like the OMNI case
- removed unnecessary parameter screen flashing of other values, when changing one value
- screen font size issue in MIDI channel page fixed, when scrolling very fast
- preset pattern update is work in progress, so you should not get all these nag screens after they get an update (soon)
- until then, make sure to follow the suggested changes and then (re)save your performance - the messages should be gone and also MIDI related problems you might have experienced (or not, yet) should also all be solved :_)
- All Binaries updated. Dev Code and public repository will be updated at a later time.

12/03/2023:

- sysinfo fixes
- updated binaries

08/03/2023:

- extended the code optimization to ePiano and microsynth (localhero)
- improved value-input display-flicker-fix on braids, ePiano, microsynth, more to come
- new binaries with current changes expected to come next weekend

07/03/2023:

- internal code optimization : Started rewriting pages so that only one line of code is necessary for every page value. Work in progress - So far only Braids page is fully converted to new syntax for internal testing

23/02/2023:

- removed some ugly delay commands and rewrite with timers in sysinfo
- added audio chime to sysinfo page
- added information texts to PSRAM test
- updated binary/hex files

16/02/2023:

- some code cleanup
- made binary release and added short installation instructions

15/02/2023:

Microsynth (MS):

- fixed issue that volume of 0 was still barely audible (very quiet but it was there)
- internal re-routing. Volume for OSC + Noise are now independent. Meaning you can now control noise volume, even when OSC is set to 0 volume
- enhanced decay and release values and volume levels for MS OSC and Noise (might be louder than before)
- audio clicks while changing volumes or other parameters should make no or less noise/clicks
- Reverb is now sent after the volume control (post-fader). So there should now be no reverb tail, when volume is set to silent
- updated binaries for latest changes
- to-do: Add control for dedicated reverb send to Noise OSC

13/02/2023:

- fixed ePiano page settings not working/updating
- fixed braids page settings not working/updating
- added/enhanced screensavers
- braids voices now stop correctly when stopping sequencer and while playing
- updated binaries
- fixed for virtual keyboard with wrong MIDI notes off

09/02/2023:

- released binaries of (most) upcoming changes
- small improvement in dexed voice

08/02/2023:

- upcoming enhancements/features (work in progress):

- Removed screen flicker when browsing parameters + changing values in Dexed Voice
- Removed screen flicker when browsing parameters + changing values in ePiano
- Removed screen flicker when browsing parameters + changing values in microsynth
- Removed screen flicker when browsing parameters + changing values in braids
- New filter effect for both delay-chains (low/band/high pass)
- Added support for PSRAM Chip, allowing long delay times like 10 seconds per delay
- 1 or 2 sidechain compressor effect(s), usable by dexed,ePiano,ms,braids. Triggered by selectable drum sample

05/02/2023:

- Switch to platformIO
- Build 5 HEX files
- Versioning and automating
- Arduino IDE compatibility
- HEX files copied to "release" folder

04/02/2023:

- updated binaries

29/01/2023:

- SD file manager : allows uploading for SYX files
- SD file manager : allows renaming WAV/SYX files

24/01/2023:

- fix braids reverb chain going wrong
- fixed broken text output of PSRAM test
- fixed dexed instance reversed numbering for effects
- merged in upcoming state of sidechain (not functional, yet)

22/01/2023:

- SD file manager for web remote
- browse content
- upload/download JSON/WAV
- delete WAV files
- play WAV files

19/12/2022:

- localhero: Fix MIDI internal commands + Serial init
- dronus: removed unnecessary USE_defines

17/12/2022:

- enhancements virtual keyboard with step recording:
- virtual buttons now show correct colors, cyan for inactive and red for active
- step input now should work while in pattern editor as well as in velocity editor
- step input method should now display and clear only when virtual keyboard is active
- step input should not display extra buttons for virtual keyboard, when it is not active
- velocity input should now work in pattern editor as well as velocity editor
- most? of visual glitches together with step input and virtual keyboard should be resolved

12/12/2022:

- fixed broken screensaver, showing main menu instead

- fixes from dronus for touchscreen input race condition

- Possible solution for boot bug without pc serial attached

- Pattern editor (while in step-input mode):

1. Fixed display for Instrument/Chord Tracks showing data for drum track
2. removed "text glitch" from "Latched" to normal note
3. When in Instrument mode and step-input active, piano roll display is updated correctly for that step
4. When scrolling past last item of velocity editor, screen should not flash/redraw the same content again
5. When scrolling past first/last option of content type of pattern, screen should not flash/redraw the same content again

6. Fixed velocity input value from step-input. Input velocity now should be correctly displayed and stored
- updated binaries
- updated release
- updated binaries 1.4.8.5
- updated release 1.4.8.5

11/12/2022:

- Fix touch and buttons for web remote
- Replace legacy dexed audio menu tree options with a single page UI.
- fix drum editor volume
- Integrate the legacy Dexed -> MIDI menu option tree into Dexed -> Setup editor page (just a few editors).
- started with sidechain/volume automation
- fix web remote to be synchronized with MDT sequencer

10/12/2022:

- LOG management (for developers only and dual serial)
- updated/prepared code for Adafruit display as an future option. Work in progress.
- Announcement: Some form of sidechain compression / volume automation will be coming to dexed, microsynth and braids.

8/12/2022:

- merged code from dronus: Convert UI and param_editor structs to classes ("Editor" and "UI").
- work in progress: update pcb schematics, 3d model to reflect current state of MDT with the goal to provide a mostly pre-assembled board by PCBWAY
- work on the new adafruit display - i will have to wait to receive an adaptor to work with the "display-only" version of the display with the tiny ribbon connector, without the attached pcb. The goal is to make some kind of adaptor for the current MDT pcb with only a few modifications and better fit the default enclosure.

4/12/2022:

- as you might have noticed in discord chat, we are looking at : https://www.adafruit.com/product/1947 as a replacement / display upgrade

Display itself is simple to replace but there are some issues with the touch screen. It is not connected by SPI as is the current display, but by I2C. We do have it working in general and with touch but it will need some time to polish the code and figure out build issues.

- pros:
- Much better touchscreen, ultra precise. Similar to your modern smartphone.
- Display content looks a bit better in contrast/clarity
- Display top looks cleaner, no visible wires/cables etc.
- cons:
- Requires some modifications to pcb, including 2 manual wires and cutting 2 traces.
- Requires some cutting of connector pins on display and manual wiring and soldering.
- Enclosure lid might need some modifications to fit.
- Adafruit Display is much more expensive then default noname display

1/12/2022:

- fixed active borders in file manager with web remote console
- deleted unnecessary screen clears in file manager
- reduced unnecessary touch button drawings in file manager
- (probably) fixed font size issue in microsynth when touch keyboard is on and changing waves
- Release 1.4.8.2
- Binaries updated

30/11/2022:

- fixed visual glitch in filemanager when deleting file from SD card

29/11/2022:

- added localheros "File Manager with files sorted + UI improvements + fixes + MSP"
- fixed some visual glitches in file manager during "copy presets"

28/11/2022:

- Output of delay1 now can be routed to input of delay2
- Output of delay2 now can be routed to input of delay1

This allows for various new delay possibilities or stereo delay effects since you can control both delays individually in time, level and pan. Be careful with this feature - settings the send levels too high can cause endless-feedback-loops quickly. Do not break the matrix! :-)

- Synced delay times were only updated while the sequencer was running. This should be fixed, you now can change delay times in idle mode to all possible time synced values like 1/8, 1/8t etc.
- Added help texts how to switch between manual time and BPM synced delay times. Also there will be a message when the audio memory is not large enough to fit the requested synced delay time like 1/1 or 1/2 (max delay time currently is 500ms)
- When delay is in synced mode, it now will also show the calculated delay time in milliseconds. That might be helpful to set values on other effect devices, where you can only enter values in ms.

27/11/2022:

- release 1.4.8
- fixed delay2 issues with feedback and output levels
- feedback level was increased. Demo performances or your own performances might have higher/lower delay feedback, as before. You can adjust it on the instrument or master effect page.
- ePiano now has working delay 1 + delay 2
- braids delay improvements
- ePiano pitch / tuning issue fixed. It might be that you have stored performances with wrong pitch: go to ePiano and set "TUNE" to 0 to fix any offset.
- ePiano UI rework
- Master Effects: Now output of delay 1 + delay 2 can be routed to reverb as reverb send effects. You can still send instruments directly to reverb, this is an optional parameter to send the delay chains to reverb.
- binaries updated

26/11/2022:

- updated binaries/firmware
- updated binaries help text
- fixed some out of bounds values for braids and microsynth delay/reverb settings
- removed some superfluous variables
- corrected some typos in value assignments

25/11/2022:

- dronus: Replace the Dexed > Setup menu tree by a single page editor

- added navigation from song page to seq.settings and back by option-up/down.

- BPM is preselected, when using this jump command

- realignment menu numbers for gamepad keys

- Added graphical touch screen calibration. (System - "Calibrate Touch") Touch upper left crosshair and lower right crosshair after that. Then you can continue to the touch test page with ENC_R.

- Manual touch screen adjustments: It seems not every touch screen works equally good. I have a very good/precise and a very bad unit. On the good unit, the graphical calibration is nearly perfect. On the other unit, no matter what you do, the result is very unsatisfactory. A lot of noise and it gets very bad to the side/borders. If you have one of the last kind, to give you more options, in System - Misc. Settings you can modify all 4 values for calibration manually. The only other option is to replace the touchscreen with a (hopefully) better working one.

Calibration is so far not tested with screen rotation. Feedback is welcome. The only advice i can give is that the upper left corner must be the physical zero point of the touchscreen, otherwise it will not work.

24/11/2022:

changes from dronus:

This branch replaces the whole Dexed > Controllers menu tree by a single page editor.

Cons: -Quite ugly right now, needs layout tuning. -Sending and receiving SysEx is untested so far in the current lack of a real counterpart device. Does someone owning a DX7 or something check that?

Pros: -Easier to adjust all the controller sensitivity and modes in one place. -Shares its instance selector with the Dexed Voice Editor, future code can use that. -Introduces a generic long-button-press and alternative-left-encoder-function code future development can use and already fixes the Dexed Voice Editor. No need to change remote code parts if an UI page is using long presses anymore! -A lot of code removed. Maybe some day we can compile with "fast" instead of "small" optimization.

changes from positionhigh:

- fixed wrong number of drumsamples (displayed numbering still wrong, should begin with 1, not 0)
- temporary fix for double increments of encoder speed (need to check with dronus)
- visual enhancement in master effects
- reassignment for gamepad for 2 line menus (since menu slimmed down again)
- display speed doubled. Should feel much more responsive now, maybe also faster in remote console
- removed some of the most unnecessary #defines in code
- updated all binaries, version: 1.4.7.5
- new release version on codeberg
- scope update speed increased x4

23/11/2022:

changes from dronus:

- Removed the Drums submenu tree in favor of a single page integrated parameter editor
- Drums editor works but need some layout work and details..
- Uses a new generic UI editor page class that now also provides the Dexed Voice Editor page. This page is a little bit regressed, eg. no left encoder operator selection anymore, some regressions to the "instance" selector.

positionhigh:

- fixed reversed control of up/down key in remote console or game pad in dexed voice editor
- fixed visual glitch when using shift/option + left key from pattern editor to song mode
- all previous available delay and reverb functionality should now work in master effects
- Filemanager: Long push ENC_L will move one directory up from SD CARD
- Filemanager: When you are already in root of SD, long push ENC_L moves cursor to the top
- fixed gamepad/native key issues because of menu renumbering

21/11/2022:

- small fix in dexed editor, instance selection via top menu line was not updating screen properly
- added current state of global effects page - only showing all values on one page, no editing so far
- added variables to send delay A + delay B out to global reverb. Not implemented, yet

19/11/2022:

Big update for web remote

- autodetect serial port, no need to select a COM port
- gamepad deleted, welcome keypad
- touch events added
- no serial message sent, only MIDI CCs to control MDT
- custom key mapping
- fix icons rendering
- optimize rendering for strings
- sample preview in file manager now should work properly

- touch "play sample" on screen and push ENC_R to preview. It should work for samples from SD and from FLASH
- fixed issue when compiled for PROGMEM
- move dexed banks into /DEXED on SD card
- move dexed favourites into /DEXED on SD card

15/11/2022:

- added first version of dexed voice editor (thank you dronus)

First implementation of Dexed voice editor. Quite rough, but working.

See option "Dexed" -> "Edit Voice".

Edited patches can be saved by the already existing "Save Voice" option. Which is quite useful now. Switching patches will erase all edits unless saved.

No name editor so far.

- added long push to dexed editor for instance selection
- added some help text
- removed some unnecessary screen redraws

14/11/2022:

- update and release 1.4.7.1
- fixed delay returns: dexed instance 1+2 returns are now separated from global delay returns
- fixed delay panorama settings not saving/loading with the performance
- midi cc changes to delay level now should work correctly
- some work on dexed chorus and filter but currently wip
- updated binaries to 1.4.7.1
- updated bom

13/11/2022:

- updated binaries

10/11/2022-12/11/2022:

- fixed display issues in page Delay - Seq. Sync.
- moved both dexed delays to global instances, now located in Master Effects
- delay returns panorama positions are now user settable (Master Effects - Delay - Panorama)
- dexed - audio - effects - delay menu replaced by just one page for delay levels in dexed for both instances
- microsynth now has delay send to delay A, delay B or both at the same time (in both instances)
- braids now has delay send to delay A, delay B or both at the same time

09/11/2022:

- fixed/enhanced dexed delay menus
- dexed instances delay intensity can be now controlled from newer dexed voice page
- for more in depth delay settings, like feedback, delay sync, MIDI sync, you still go to dexed - audio - effects - delay
- added better help texts how to operate in time sync./midi sync./delay time in milliseconds and switch between them
- updated binaries (1.4.6.24)

07/11/2022:

- added "clear patterns" and "clear all" to sequencer menu

06/11/2022:

- general code cleanup, removed some ifdefs
- removed custom colors, nobody even mentioned it, during the last year

05/11/2022:

- fixed potential crash while using remote console

- updated binaries

04/11/2022:

- improved/removed audio artifacts while navigating in braids and microsynth
- filter in braids replaced for better results with lfo cutoff, work in progress
- braids with lfo filter is complicated to understand but starting to get usable

01/11/2022:

- small fix in midi channels page for wrong activity display
- updated binaries

29/10/2022:

- 1.4.6.19 This build is highly experimental, don't go for it if you want a stable system
- SPI FLASH memory displayed values are not updated correctly. Not sure if this is a recent issue but i just noticed it now. Values seem to be correct, after a reboot. Needs investigation.
- First version of Processing Remote Console with File Transfer from Teensy to PC
- Files with 39MB or less can be copied from Teensy to PC in File Manager (safety issue, limit might be removed later)
- Will only work in PROCESSING Remote Console. If it can be done on the Web, no idea, may need Weeks or Months to do it, do not ask for it until it is developed, tested and ready ! Current status = 0 % and we will keep you updated if there is progress !
- Files will be copied to the same directory as Progressing Code is located. Currently it only works for single files. Not for directories. If you want to copy multiple files after another, it does work but take your time and do not click too fast or you will get errors in processing.
- Early Feedback about File integrity would be welcome, I tested with 30MB+ files and it seems to be working correctly.
- Once more: DO NOT ask for the web console to have file transfer. If it is possible, we will do it. But this will take time!

28/10/2022:

- MIDI note mapping for UI Control now works also with special keys, like select.
- gamepad input now belongs to default configuration since all the other newer input methods, except original 2 encoders, more or less use the same code. Means #USB_GAMEPAD does NOT to be included in config.h anymore
- When you use OPTIONAL input methods : PC KEYPAD/USB_KEYBOARD or ONBOARD_BUTTON_Interface then now you have to add it MANUALLY, also remote console will NOT activate them
- enabling remote console now ONLY adds #USB_AUDIO automatically, not other UI controls
- When you use MIDI note mapping for UI Control, be aware that it currently works for EVERY MIDI channel. That can lead to unwanted effects, not only when playing notes from your MIDI device but also when playing notes from the sequencer.

If possible, it is preferred to use default MIDI CC control for UI, these do NOT need to be mapped but come preinstalled.

(However, they also can be remapped!) The MIDI note mapping feature should only be used, when you can't use MIDI CC from your device. It might be an idea to use an own MIDI channel for it, in the future

26/10/2022:

- number of patterns increased to 32

25/10/2022:

- you can now order a tested 3d printed SLA / Resin enclosure at: https://www.pcbway.com/project/shareproject/MicroDexed_Touch_MDT_SLA_printed_enclosure_LID_BOTTOM_CASE_317c88e1.html You can choose color, resin type - currently tested are:
- Resin Standard white material (UTR 8360)

- Resin UTR-8100 (transparent)

23/10/2022:

- added recovery boot option. When autoloading performance has issues (device is not booting) you can try to hold ENC_R or ENC-L at boot. Should also work for native keys. This will skip the loading of the performance. Since nothing of the performance will be loaded, there are no MIDI channels loaded. They then will be set to default MDT values.
- added MIDI CCs to control MDT by MIDI

22/10/2022:

- no progress, today. I wasted 3+ hours into a recovery-safe-boot feature and it itself worked but made several new problems including a lot of crashes after using it. After 4 clean attempts, I give up for now.

21/10/2022:

- native keys and gamepad autolearn keys enabled at the same time had some issues. Should be now resolved.

20/10/2022:

- Velocity editor: fixed broken pattern select
- Velocity editor: while pattern change active, red indication of the value like in pattern editor
- Velocity editor: reduction of unnecessary screen drawing
- Velocity editor: clearing some left over chars from previous sample names/other values when navigating around
- Updated noob guide with still valid information from MicroDexed, generation 1

19/10/2022:

- worked on some pixel issues from various draw-line functions - should be ok now in processing remote, web remote i think will follow up very soon
- fix MSP zones alignements
- fix MSP panbar for web remote
- web remote UI improvements and javascript code rewritten

18/10/2022:

- small touch improvements in mute matrix. input 30 times faster than before. To make sure a touch gets recognized, just push and hold a touch screen button. It will not flip its condition, until you release it. Touch reliability should be very high now, 99,9 % ?
- added touch screen test page, draw pixels on the screen to see if it matches the touch input

17/10/2022:

- pan bar fix for remote console in msp

16/10/2022:

- release 1.4.6.15
- changed colors in msp to old colors with slight modifications
- note value checks in msp to not get out of bounds, keys have to be between C1-C#8
- screen drawing in msp enhanced
- enhancements in drawing in processing remote console
- sys config save icon improvement
- fixed scrolling with encoders in voice select
- updated binaries

15/10/2022:

- new misc. settings menu:

Gamepad/Native Key speed

Screensaver idle time start

Display rotation

Touch Screen rotation

Reverse UI (Encoders / Device reversed, Encoder on top)

- fixed min/max values for rotation of touch
- adjusted gamepad speed values
- small ui changes in misc. settings
- updated FAQ

13/10/2022:

- fixed some pixel level drawing issues in teensy + processing code at screen borders
- fixed some stray pixels in voice select after opening and closing virtual keyboard

12/10/2022:

- fixed keyboard state when going from main menu to dexed voice - both are now independent
- When the keyboard in the main menu was activated, going to another page and returning, part of the menu was overdrawn.
- fixed background not clearing properly of instrument name in touch keyboard in remote console
- fixed touch keyboard button redrawing
- when keyboard is enabled in main menu, BACK help text is not drawn on to the top of keyboard keys
- keyboard OFF button now returns properly on the menu when keyboard was activated previously and coming back from another page
- offsets of touch input from remote console now alligns perfectly with virtual keyboard. However there are issues with the real touch screen, having offsets or not matching the touch point well enough. We will try if a calibration tool can sort out at least part of these issues. My feeling is that the current touch screen is not accurate enough, to work 100% reliable for note input, on the virtual keyboard. Making the keys bigger will not help much, since it is the stray values at beginning of touch, where the problem occurs. This is a hardware issue, i am not sure we can do much about it other than changing to a higher quality touchscreen.
- mouse input in the remote console for touch buttons is now much more reliable. If you find issues anywhere, please let us know

10-11/10/2022:

- new audio analysers for web remote console
- remote console on web and on processing now starts up with the full main menu, no matter where you were navigated to
- in remote console now you can push touch buttons via mouse (not 100% reliable, yet, sometimes slow response)
- native key input and gamepad input and remote console input now is better separated in code
- when you activate the remote console, it automatically adds keyboard, gamepad and remote usb audio by itself.
- Keyboard and Gamepad can now be used at the same time as your input devices

09/10/2022:

- moved step sequencer recording parameter out of the way in pattern editor
- relocated step rec. parameter to sequencer settings
- enhancements to fast navigation, now showing also velocity editor and consistent placement of navigation bar
- updated binaries
- fix rendering for level meters

08/10/2022:

- optimized drawing speed of small MIDI level meters for both remote consoles
- reduced unnecessary screen writes in microsynth
- complex drawing like circles, lines and coloured meters are now done from the webclient-side
- upcoming new release with binaries at end of this week
- audio analysers added to web remote console

06/10/2022:

- web remote console stability improvements and cosmetic layout changes
- web remote console now displays a page at connection and the current key mappings
- web remote console : preparation for the custom key mappings

05/10/2022:

- fixed small visual glitch on song page with short song names
- gamepad/keys/remote-console control in pattern editor and velocity editor should now not be reversed, either if you are going there by menu or fast-navigation, both now work correctly in all directions
- using fast-navigation (key-combos) in remote-console now should be more reliable

- when in velocity editor, you now also can use fast-navigation

04/10/2022:

- the web remote console now supports on screen buttons for direction, a, b, start + select buttons, will be public soon.
- input handling for remote console keys now working (a bit slow sometimes, but working)
- to enable remote console with keyboard input, audio, no other option now has to be added manually. Just add a remote console. it will activate keyboard, remote audio etc. itself, for all needed features

02/10/2022:

- Fix Multisamples browsing samples on Flash while sequencer is running (you have to copy again the third party libraries from the repo to your Arduino libraries folder as some libraries have been modified)
- Fixed flickering of algorithm display on dexed voice select
- Drawing improved on MSP page
- Added clear zone function in MSP

01/10/2022:

- On Song Page, USB MIDI and JACK MIDI channel label are now displayed while editing instrument
- MSP #00 and MSP #01 are now selectable from the correct ammount of configured multisamples
- Highlighting of Chain and Transpose columns is now more focused, dimming the currently not edited field and column
- updated binaries
- Fix MIDI OMNI for Dexed and MSP
- Update web remote with new chars used in MSP play mode
- Remote Console with WebBrowser + Audio is now working: https://positionhigh.codeberg.page/

29/09/2002:

- Improved encoder input speed in MicroSynth and corrected several large parameter values to an easier to read format
- Some work on the newbie guide
- Added warnings and more precise information how to shop for correctly working display types for MDT in the bom

28/09/2022:

- Main Menu: Sequencer status was not updated from Gamepad Start Button or Encoder L Long Push
- MSP: Improved volume adjustment for Encoders
- MSP: Improved Reverb Send adjustment for Encoders
- Mixer: Fixed not selectable Master Volume Adjustment
- small bug fixes

27/09/2022:

- improvements on gamepad/native key support. Keys now behave with acceleration while pressed
- input speed in all menus should be equal when using gamepad/native keys
- All /nearly all functions/pages should have correct key mappings
- updated noob Guide
- other small UI fixes

25/09/2022:

- Samples in MSP now can be played from start to end, like before, but also can be triggered by noteon and noteoff, meaning you can stop the playback when releasing the key. (on live input) . From the sequencer, this also will work, if you want the sample to play over multiple steps, it will react to the latch function.
- The "PM" PlayMode indicates if it is playing from start to finish or to play only while the key is held
- The USB gamepad and mappings to native teensy pins for buttons, now should behave identical. It is already possible to navigate with buttons/keys to various menus.
- For song, chain and patterns there are quick shortcuts, LSDJ style - while pressing and holding select, you can navigate to pages more quickly with right and left keys.

25/09/2022:

- Fix filename length for samples in Flash (several wav files were not playing for Drums)

24/09/2022:

- MIDI channels added for MSP 1 and 2, that allows playing MSP live and with sequencer
- reorder the instruments on MIDI channels page

23/09/2022:

- Braids and MSP level meters and level control now working in the mixer page.

22/09/2022:

- still working on the mixer page. Some input handling and volume issues are fixed, but not everything. work in progress.

21/09/2022:

- improvements mixer page: all sound sources now available and volume can be changed on one single page
- volume changes to ePiano now apply instantly, in mixer page
- MSP now has a global volume setting, currently defaults to 100%. Needs further work.

20/09/2022:

- new MIDI channels page
- fixed Braids MIDI routing

19/09/2022:

- fixed system crash in file manager, when compiled for flash, while playing from flash chip
- fixed level bug in mixer
- ePiano and Braids added in mixer
- more free ram
- fixed bug in Braids page

18/09/2022:

- when exiting a page while in editing mode, it will be now stopped, automatically
- improvements to gamepad input, some scrolling directions fixed, editing and input speed more optimized

17/09/2022:

- main branch updated to V1.4.6.2
- Colors of Menu Items in select/edit mode now behave more consistent in ePiano, braids and MSP
- Gamepad navigation speed corrected for several pages like ePiano, MSP and braids
- Gamepad navigation in some of the special menus with x/y movement improved
- Gamepad editing of many of the black/white menu pages improved (modify direction is not longer inverted)
- release V1.4.6
- under the hood code / memory improvements
- updated json library and code fixes for Arduino IDE 2.0 usage
- first version of the gamepad UI preview, testers are welcome.
- updated binary releases

10/09/2022:

- new generic scrollbar, for pages and menus

09/09/2022:

- added bare bones support for USB HOST (Computer) Keyboard/Keypads

04/09/2022:

- release V1.4.4
- more improvements for the DIY 3d print case
- Sequencer has now Pattern probability and velocity probability functions
- fixed some more font-size issues in the pattern editor tool menu that occured for tracktype drums and only while pattern is currently running.

01/09/2022:

- added Euclidean arp modes

14/08/2022:

- got rid of the chord_dexed_inst selection in Adv.Settings - Dexed Chord Instr. is now simply selected in Song Editor

- chord/arp Velocity in Adv.Settings however will stay, since otherwise there is no expression/velocity for Dexed in Chord/Arp mode. This parameter also affects Braids Volume when in chord/Arp mode.

13/08/2022:

- Now Braids understands TrackType Arp and Chords, Volume is a mix of its own Inst. Volume + Chord Vol. in Adv.Seq.Settings
- Release 1.4
- Added Euclidean Arpeggiator mode
- Updated binary distribution files

12/08/2022:

- improved external MIDI note-off handling when seq. is stopped - for instr., chord and arps
- small fix in build instructions

11/08/2022:

- fixed wrong MIDI channel when playing chords/arps on external MIDI gear

10/08/2022:

- Release of improved case version with threaded inserts and M3 screws
- Updated BOM

04/08/2022:

Pattern Editor:

- cursor position is more visible while playing and while not playing sequence
- code cleanup in pattern editor and velocity editor
- started upgrading the default sequences

02/08/2022:

Pattern Editor:

- New feature : pattern hunting

In the pattern editor you can switch with a touch button between regular song play and pattern play. The pattern play will loop the currently playing pattern endlessly.

After pressing the button again, it will continue in the song.

Now, there is an addition touch button: PATTERN HUNTING

When this is activated, and you are playing in pattern mode, it will do the following:

1. search for the first occurance of the currently active pattern in pattern editor in the song
2. jump and stick to that song step
3. find the first chain step, the active pattern is first played on and start the playback at this chain step
4. search all other tracks - if they as long or longer than the found pattern, also jump to the chain step from the found pattern
5. if they are only 1 step long, start and repeat them as their only step
6. if they are not longer or equal to the length of the found pattern, mute the track. This leads to tracks that might be muted, if they have other lengths than the found pattern and are not only 1 step long. However, it should be better than playing other tracks in context with the found pattern, with wrong notes. In the worst case, you will only hear the sound of your currently selected pattern.

- Tool jump now jumps to the correct offset when track type is instrument or chord
- fixed wrong screen offsets in copy, transpose, exchange, fill functions
- fixed wrong screen updates after a pattern has swapped with a different content type as the first one
- fixed note-name browser flickering in content type instrument
- fixed some screen spaces not clearing after a display change
- when in transpose mode for an instrument pattern, pianoroll will now preview all notes correctly during making the change

- after loading a new performance, the play-mode will revert to regular song play

30/07/2022:

- release 1.3.9

- Dexed Voice:

1. When virtual keyboard is on, you now can change instance, sound + volume + transpose for dexed
2. Favorite sounds no longer are selected/unselected by long push ENC-L but now with a touch button. This allows to use the standard behavior of ENC-L to start/stop the sequencer now also in dexed voice as in most other screens
3. Various parameters of Dexed voice now can be accessed directly from its screen. You do not have to dive into the menu for the most common options like pan, volume, MIDI channel etc.
4. Long push ENC-R now switches between the instances instead of switching between voice and bank. Since this is not obvious to know, now the instance can also be selected from the parameter list as the first option.

- Pattern Editor:

1. When browsing the Note/Sample/Function Menu or using the pattern selector, now it is visible by color that you are currently editing the parameter.
2. other small UI fixes

- Braids:

1. Braids now has a simple but effective Flanger/Phaser. The speed and the "stereo spread" can be controlled from the main braids screen. Be careful with the stereo spread, that can cause a lot of audio cancellation when you switch to a mono-device for listening, like a cellphone or a kitchen radio (just as examples). The stereo spread is an offset that gets added to one stereo side only and speeds up the flanging. The speed can go from insanely slow and ridiculous high speeds.

- Sample Editor:

1. Samples can now the previewed by a touch button

26/07/2022:

- rendering of all the FM algorithms, for the next version of the Dexed voice screen :)

24/07/2022:

- release 1.3.82
- Menu speed increased, especially when using remote console
- expanded menu from 4 to 6 lines
- faster and better scroll bar

23/07/2022:

- release 1.3.81 fixed all so far known UI issues
- release 1.3.8
- started adding a navigation bar in the menu. It still has known issues - we are working on it :_)

22/07/2022:

- fixed fine tuning for microsynth

21/07/2022:

- fixed wrong display output of empty patterns/steps in pattern editor
- fixed wrong display output of empty patterns/steps in mute matrix
- fixed wrong display output of empty patterns/steps in song editor
- fixed wrong display output of empty patterns/steps in tracker view/editor
- added more information to system information page for debugging user issues
- debugging features that are enabled but not intended for regular usage are highlighted
- added eye candy/new logo to system information

18/07/2022:

- UI fixes, faster Volume response, especially with Remote Console
- reduced pixel drawing for spaces

17/07/2022:

- Updated FAQ and Sequencer Wiki
- working on alternative Case design with quicker access to SD-Card but some compromises in looks and less intuitive user experience

14/07/2022:

- Multiband settings are now loaded/saved with the current performance
- started updating demo performances with all current features, including Multiband

13/07/2022:

- fixed some sample names for flash
- changed multiband from default compressor to multiband limiter, much easier to get good results
- fixed iteration of instruments
- replaced out of tune piano multisample

11/07/2022:

- added web remote, no need for Processing to see the display, capture image, record video...

10/07/2022:

- added very basic recording of audio to stereo-raw-file. It should work with and without the multiband. The raw file can be opened for example with Audacity.
- improved record audio, now you can select from 254 target slots for the filename.
- updated FAQ

09/07/2022:

- updated texts
- fixed (most) screensaver issues
- 3d print case files tested
- current PCB build tested
- fixed some module dependencies
- worked on some issues in remote console in web browser for mac

29/06/2022:

- improved memory management to free up RAM, after a lot of trial and error :) (so currently all modules fit into teensy memory at once)
- refactoring of MIDI code to remove duplicates
- small UI / Display issues fixed
- some progress on multiband compressor
- updated texts

27/06/2022:

- Improved Virtual Keyboard Button position
- Fixed Menu Touch UI Input switching delays
- Font Size bug in Braids should be now fixed
- fixed missing booleans

25/06/2022:

- Braids can now be played by USB MIDI (serial MIDI untested) with 8 voices polyphony
- Braids now handles Envelopes start/ends correctly, even when playing polyphonic (live or by sequencer)
- Braids now saves /loads it's state, together with a performance
- Touch Keyboard is now working on Braids page and can be selected as the playing instrument
- Fixed Microsynth Noise OSC not playing correctly
- Notice : The Code now defaults to compile for PCM5102. If you still want to use the Teensy Audio Board, change it in config.h
- If you have unusual crashes when playing from external USB MIDI Devices, check if your power supply is sufficient. A Power Adaptor / USB Power Bank with 1A is enough, however a standard USB2 PC Port with only 500mA might not work stable with additional, external devices connected to Microdexed.
- Updated FAQ

24/06/2022: Testing with the newly arrived (but already outdated) PCB that features the PCM5102 was successful. Also the external SPI Flash module is working as intended. We will switch to this configuration since as an audio appliance, it makes sense to get rid of all avoidable noise issues.

- Braids is now working with 8 voices polyphony
- added Envelopes and filters to Braids
- tested external SPI Flash module
- tested purple PCM5102 board
- updated STL files

- updated BOM and Instructions

21/06/2022:

- After a lot of trial, some of the Mutable Instruments Braids Oscillator Models are working in Microdexed. Still a lot to be done there. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WFc2IrTSYDQ

20/06/2022:

- fixed some small array and UI issues (for example volume meter now shows the scope when seq. is running)

19/06/2022:

- Started modularization of the code. Every User has different opinions about what is important to have in an audio device. Memory on the Teensy however is limited, so you can not have everything at once, what we can think of. Currently, this restructure is far from complete, but it is a start.
  Also you now have the option to change your DAC to the (most likely) next preferred DAC, the PCM 5102.

About the modularization:

Core	Modules	Effects	Polyphony/Tracks
Dexed1		✓	16 voices
Dexed2		✓	16 voices
+	Electric Piano	✓	16 voices
+	Microsynth	✓	2 Mono Instances
+	SamplePlayer + Multisamples	✓	8 voices
+	Sample Editing		in alpha
+	Reduced Version of Braids	unknown	unknown
+	Song / Sequencing / Arp		8 tracks

15/06/2022:

- testing with other options for dynamic sample management like qspi, sd-card with other library.

12/06/2022:

- prepared code changes from Teensy audio board to generic PCM5102
- added DAC mute/unmute test menu
- reassigned generic pin 4 for the purpose of hardware soft-muting PCM5102
- a lot of testing and resoldering - software controlled mute now is working
- started redesign PCB for new DAC

08/06/2022:

- Updated Build Instructions
- Updated Hardware Status
- Updated BOM

There are noise issues with the Teensy audio board while there is activity coming from the display/encoders.

We are aware of this problem and working on a solution that might drop the audio board as a main component and go with an alternative DAC like the low-cost PCM5102 and an extension breakout board with a flash chip already attached, instead.

This also would eliminate the hassle to solder the very small SMD component and use standard dupont spacing/pins instead, for easy soldering.

First tests indicate that with these changes applied, all noise issues are gone and it will be even cheaper to build. The current noise floor with the Teensy audio board is not really that loud but it can be noticed - when you are searching for it explicitly.

It will take a few months to get the replacement parts, redesign the PCB or an adapter board, so we will stick with the teensy audio board for now, since many Teensy owners will have that at their disposal, anyway.

06/06/2022:

- fix save performance
- repaired/improved demo patterns for playing from flash
- real time display of MicroSynth Filter fixed
- merged latest dexed engine with better sysex support

05/06/2022:

- updated sequencer instructions
- updated build instructions and images
- PCB now can be ordered from PCBWAY

04/06/2022:

- load/save JSON multi-sample presets (10 presets with 8 zones each)
- added knob.stl as template for printing your own encoder knobs
- added naming/renaming of multi-sample presets
- updated build instructions

03/06/2022:

- custom/user multi-samples playing from SPI FLASH:

1. samples can be exchanged /loaded during runtime
2. samples can be addressed as Instruments from the sequencer
3. also you can play them in a "live-view-mode" with a preset like structure
4. you can have up to 8 Zones in a multi-sample
5. The zones are "auto-mapped" but can also be changed manually

- since the playback of samples is limited from the hardware/CPU, currently 8 samples can be played at the same time: The logic when samples have to be stopped has improved in a way that you do not get out of free samples to play, as far as that is possible.
- added placeholder page for features currently only for FLASH and not possible/working from SD-Card

01/06/2022:

- fill multisample zone with root note detection from filename when browsing the flash chip

30/05/2022:

- started working on the Multisample engine, playing from Flash

29/05/2022:

- fix SerialFlash wav playback
- fix some warnings
- further 3d case enhancement and test prints
- added simple Multi-Sample live-play for testing samples from SerialFlash

27/05/2022:

- Added Song CLEAR function
- Added Chain/Chain Transpose CLEAR function
- "New" Build Instructions online
- STLs updated and testing in progress
- BOM updated

26/05/2022:

- Building and testing a variation with pin sockets instead of the IC sockets, 3d modifications
1. Device height reduced 3mm: Faster 3d print times, a little less bulky looking device
2. no double / stacked special connector for the display, replaced by 1 standard connector.
3. much stronger pin binding for teensy and audio board
4. no more pin bending tricks required, pin locations are exactly where they are supposed to be

25/05/2022:

- fix usbMidi send sysex bank
- fix Midi channel displayed
- quicker boot to display
- improved step sequencer

23/05/2022:

- added basic step sequencer input
- updated sequencer wiki

22/05/2022:

- updated build instructions
- updated Release
- made PCB changes and ordered a new small batch for testing
- added graphical touch keyboard icon instead of text only.

21/05/2022:

- improved STL Files for printing, flash and file manager improvements
- updated PCB and PCB images
- small UI fixes

20/05/2022:

- updated Build instructions and BOM

18/05/2022:

- basic tracker edit mode ready

17/05/2022:

- started rebuilding/rewriting the tracker view/editor for the new display

15/05/2022:

- fixed performance loading while playing
- Updated STL files

various fixes from localhero: Fix bank/voice name + usbMidi sysex

- Fix UI_func_save_voice
- Fix UI_func_sysex_send_bank
- Fix bank/voice name if error
- Fix SD card detection + warnings
- Minor changes